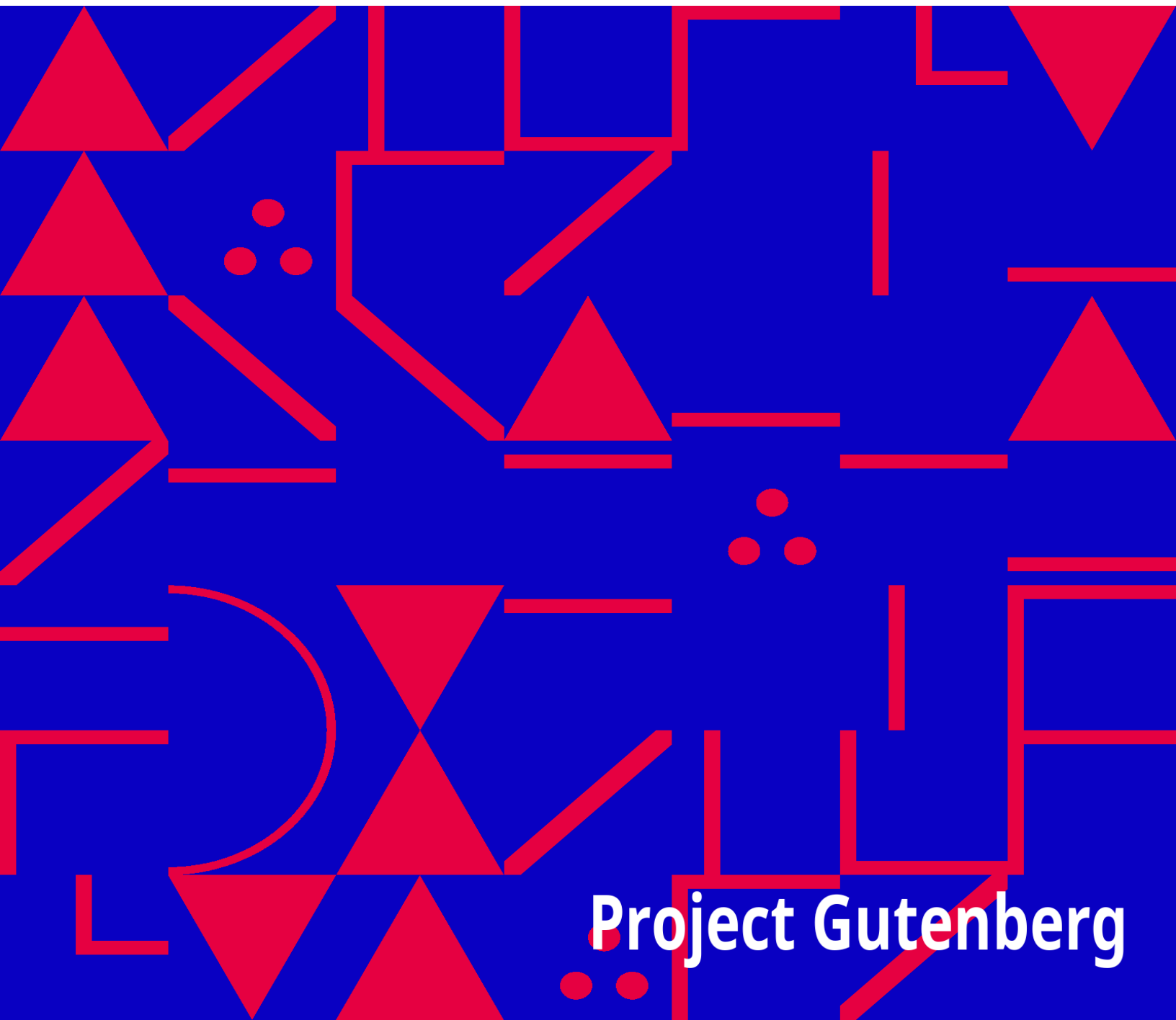


Anglo-Saxon Grammar and Exercise Book

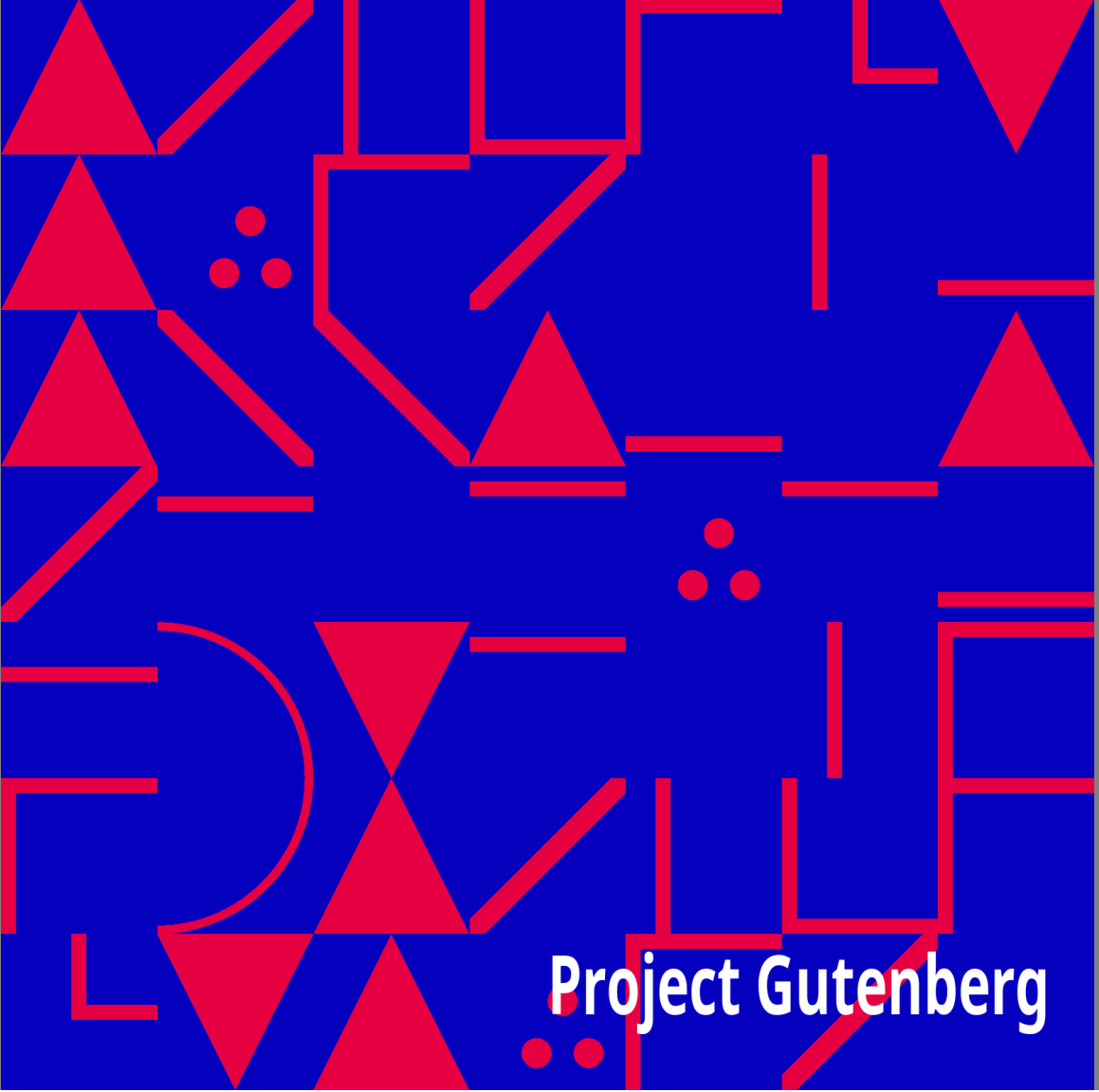
C. Alphonso Smith

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C. Alphonso Smith

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK ANGLO-SAXON
GRAMMAR AND EXERCISE BOOK ***

This text includes characters that require UTF-8 (Unicode) file encoding:

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Ęę Qq (e and o with ogonek)

If any of these characters do not display properly—in particular, if the diacritic does not appear directly above the letter—or if the apostrophes and quotation marks in this paragraph appear as garbage, you may have an incompatible browser or unavailable fonts. First, make sure that the browser’s “character set” or “file encoding” is set to Unicode (UTF-8). You may also need to change your browser’s default font.

See the [Poetry](#) section for potential problems specific to that section.

In references to numbered Sections, “Note” may mean either an inset Note or a footnote. Links in this e-text lead to the beginning of the section.

In the prose reading selections (pages 99-121), the original line breaks have been preserved for use with the linenotes and Glossary. In the verse selections, line numbers in the notes have been replaced with the line numbers from the original texts, printed in brackets as shown. In both, annotated passages are linked to their Notes; these links are intended to be unobtrusive. The distinction between linenotes and numbered footnotes is in the original.

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ANGLO-SAXON GRAMMAR AND EXERCISE BOOK

WITH INFLECTIONS, SYNTAX, SELECTIONS
FOR READING, AND GLOSSARY

BY

C. ALPHONSO SMITH, PH.D., LL.D.

LATE PROFESSOR OF ENGLISH IN THE
UNITED STATES NAVAL ACADEMY



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PREFACE.



THE scope of this book is indicated in § 5. It is intended for beginners, and in writing it, these words of Sir Thomas Elyot have not been forgotten: “Grammer, beinge but an introduction to the understandinge of autors, if it be made to longe or exquisite to the lerner, it in a maner mortifieth his corage: And by that time he cometh to the most swete and pleasant redinge of olde autors, the sparkes of fervent desire of lernynge are extincte with the burdone of grammer, lyke as a lyttell fyre is sone quenched with a great heape of small stickes.”—*The Governour*, Cap. X.

Only the essentials, therefore, are treated in this work, which is planned more as a foundation for the study of Modern English grammar, of historical English grammar, and of the principles of English etymology, than as a general introduction to Germanic philology.

The Exercises in translation will, it is believed, furnish all the drill necessary to enable the student to retain the forms and constructions given in the various chapters.

The Selections for Reading relate to the history and literature of King Alfred’s day, and are sufficient to give the student a first-hand, though brief, acquaintance with the native style and idiom of Early West Saxon prose in its golden age. Most of the words and constructions contained in them will

be already familiar to the student through their intentional employment in the Exercises.

For the inflectional portion of this grammar, recourse has been had chiefly to Sievers' *Abriss der angelsächsischen Grammatik* (1895). Constant reference has been made also to the same author's earlier and larger *Angelsächsische Grammatik*, translated by Cook. A more sparing use has been made of Cosijn's *Altwestsächsische Grammatik*.

For syntax and illustrative sentences, Dr. J. E. Wülfing's *Syntax in den Werken Alfreds des Grossen, Part I.* (Bonn, 1894) has proved indispensable. Advance sheets of the second part of this great work lead one to believe that when completed the three parts will constitute the most important contribution to the study of English syntax that has yet been made. Old English sentences have also been cited from Sweet's *Anglo-Saxon Reader*, Bright's *Anglo-Saxon Reader*, and Cook's *First Book in Old English*.

The short chapter on the Order of Words has been condensed from my *Order of Words in Anglo-Saxon Prose* (Publications of the Modern Language Association of America, New Series, Vol. I, No. 2).

Though assuming sole responsibility for everything contained in this book, I take pleasure in acknowledging the kind and efficient assistance that has been so generously given me in its preparation. To none do I owe more than to Dr. J. E. Wülfing, of the University of Bonn; Prof. James A. Harrison, of the University of Virginia; Prof. W. S. Currell, of Washington and Lee University; Prof. J. Douglas Bruce, of Bryn Mawr College; and Prof. L. M. Harris, of the University of Indiana. They have each rendered material aid, not only in the tedious task of detecting typographical errors in the proof-sheets, but by the valuable criticisms and suggestions which they have made as this work was passing through the press.

C. ALPHONSO SMITH.

LOUISIANA STATE UNIVERSITY,
BATON ROUGE, September, 1896.

PREFACE TO THE SECOND EDITION.



IN preparing this enlarged edition, a few minor errors in the first edition have been corrected and a few sentences added. The chief difference between the two editions, however, consists in the introduction of more reading matter and the consequent exposition of Old English meter. Both changes have been made at the persistent request of teachers and students of Old English.

Uniformity of treatment has been studiously preserved in the new material and the old, the emphasis in both being placed on syntax and upon the affinities that Old English shares with Modern English.

Many obligations have been incurred in preparing this augmented edition. I have again to thank Dr. J. E. Wülfing, Prof. James A. Harrison, Prof. W. S. Currell, and Prof. J. Douglas Bruce. To the scholarly criticisms also of Prof. J. M. Hart, of Cornell; Prof. Frank Jewett Mather, Jr., of Williams College; and Prof. Frederick Tupper, Jr., of the University of Vermont, I am indebted for aid as generously given as it is genuinely appreciated.

C. ALPHONSO SMITH.

August, 1898.

PREFACE TO THE FOURTH EDITION.



AMONG those who have kindly aided in making this edition free from error, I wish to thank especially my friend Dr. John M. McBryde, Jr., of Hollins Institute, Virginia.

C. ALPHONSO SMITH.

UNIVERSITY OF NORTH CAROLINA,
Chapel Hill, February, 1903.

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OLD ENGLISH

GRAMMAR AND EXERCISES



OLD ENGLISH GRAMMAR AND EXERCISE BOOK.



PART I.



INTRODUCTION.



CHAPTER I.

HISTORY.

1. The history of the English language falls naturally into three periods; but these periods blend into one another so gradually that too much significance must not be attached to the exact dates which scholars, chiefly for convenience of treatment, have assigned as their limits. Our language, it is true, has undergone many and great changes; but its continuity has never been broken, and its individuality has never been lost.

2. The first of these periods is that of OLD ENGLISH, or ANGLO-SAXON,¹ commonly known as the period of *full inflections*. E.g. **stān-as**, *stones*; **car-u**, *care*; **will-a**, *will*; **bind-an**, *to bind*; **help-að** (= **ath**), *they help*.

It extends from the arrival of the English in Great Britain to about one hundred years after the Norman Conquest,—from A.D. 449 to 1150; but there are no literary remains of the earlier centuries of this period. There were four² distinct dialects spoken at this time. These were the Northumbrian, spoken north of the river Humber; the Mercian, spoken in the midland region between the Humber and the Thames; the West Saxon,

spoken south and west of the Thames; and the Kentish, spoken in the neighborhood of Canterbury. Of these dialects, Modern English is most nearly akin to the Mercian; but the best known of them is the West Saxon. It was in the West Saxon dialect that King Alfred (849-901) wrote and spoke. His writings belong to the period of Early West Saxon as distinguished from the period of Late West Saxon, the latter being best represented in the writings of Abbot Ælfric (955?-1025?).

3. The second period is that of MIDDLE ENGLISH, or the period of *leveled inflections*, the dominant vowel of the inflections being **e**. *E.g.* **ston-es**, **car-e**, **will-e**, **bind-en** (or **bind-e**), **help-eth**, each being, as in the earlier period, a dissyllable.

The Middle English period extends from A.D. 1150 to 1500. Its greatest representatives are Chaucer (1340-1400) in poetry and Wiclif (1324-1384) in prose. There were three prominent dialects during this period: the Northern, corresponding to the older Northumbrian; the Midland (divided into East Midland and West Midland), corresponding to the Mercian; and the Southern, corresponding to the West Saxon and Kentish. London, situated in East Midland territory, had become the dominant speech center; and it was this East Midland dialect that both Chaucer and Wiclif employed.

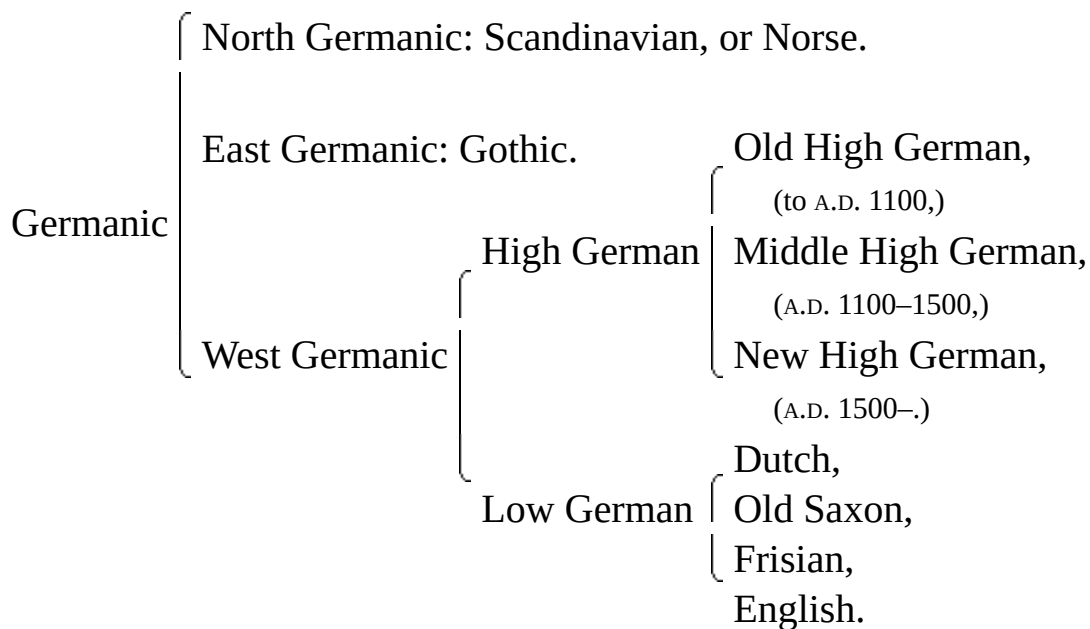
NOTE.—It is a great mistake to think that Chaucer shaped our language from crude materials. His influence was conservative, not plastic. The popularity of his works tended to crystalize and thus to perpetuate the forms of the East Midland dialect, but that dialect was ready to his hand before he began to write. The speech of London was, in Chaucer's time, a mixture of Southern and Midland forms, but the Southern forms (survivals of the West Saxon dialect) had already begun to fall away; and this they continued to do, so that "Chaucer's language," as Dr. Murray says, "is more Southern than standard English eventually became." See also Morsbach, *Ueber den Ursprung der neuenglischen Schriftsprache* (1888).

4. The last period is that of MODERN ENGLISH, or the period of *lost inflections*. *E.g.* **stones**, **care**, **will**, **bind**, **help**, each being a monosyllable. Modern English extends from A.D. 1500 to the present time. It has witnessed comparatively few grammatical changes, but the vocabulary of our language has been vastly increased by additions from the classical languages. Vowels, too, have shifted their values.

5.

It is the object of this book to give an elementary knowledge of Early West Saxon, that is, the language of King Alfred. With this knowledge, it will not be difficult for the student to read Late West Saxon, or any other dialect of the Old English period. Such knowledge will also serve as the best introduction to the structure both of Middle English and of Modern English, besides laying a secure foundation for the scientific study of any other Germanic tongue.

NOTE.—The Germanic, or Teutonic, languages constitute a branch of the great Aryan, or Indo-Germanic (known also as the Indo-European) group. They are subdivided as follows:



1. This unfortunate nomenclature is due to the term *Angli Saxones*, which Latin writers used as a designation for the English Saxons as distinguished from the continental or Old Saxons. But Alfred and Ælfric both use the term *Englisc*, not Anglo-Saxon. The Angles spread over Northumbria and Mercia, far outnumbering the other tribes. Thus *Englisc* (= *Angel* + *isc*) became the general name for the language spoken.

2. As small as England is, there are six distinct dialects spoken in her borders to-day. Of these the Yorkshire dialect is, perhaps, the most peculiar. It preserves many Northumbrian survivals. See Tennyson's *Northern Farmer*.



CHAPTER II.

SOUNDS.

Vowels and Diphthongs.

6. The long vowels and diphthongs will in this book be designated by the macron (—). Vowel length should in every case be associated by the student with each word learned: quantity alone sometimes distinguishes words meaning wholly different things: **fōr**, *he went*, **for**, *for*; **gōd**, *good*, **God**, *God*; **mān**, *crime*, **man**, *man*.

Long vowels and diphthongs:

ā as in father: **stān**, *a stone*.

ǣ as in man (prolonged): **slǣpan**, *to sleep*.

ē as in they: **hēr**, *here*.

ī as in machine: **mīn**, *mine*.

ō as in note (pure, not diphthongal): **bōc**, *book*.

ū as in rule: **tūn**, *town*.

ȳ as in German grün, or English green (with lips rounded): ¹ **brȳd**, *bride*.

The diphthongs, long and short, have the stress upon the first vowel. The second vowel is obscured, and represents approximately the sound of *er* in *sooner*, *faster* (= *soon-uh*, *fast-uh*). The long diphthongs (**ǣ** is not a diphthong proper) are **ēo**, **īe**, and **ēa**. The sound of **ēo** is approximately reproduced in *mayor* (= *mā-uh*); that of **īe** in the dissyllabic pronunciation of *fear* (= *fē-uh*). But **ēa** = *ǣ-uh*. This diphthong is hardly to be distinguished from *ea* in *pear*, *bear*, etc., as pronounced in the southern section of the United States (= *bæ-uh*, *pæ-uh*).

7. The short sounds are nothing more than the long vowels and diphthongs shortened; but the student must at once rid himself of the idea that Modern English *red*, for example, is the shortened form of *reed*, or that *mat* is the

shortened form of *mate*. Pronounce these long sounds with increasing rapidity, and *reed* will approach *rid*, while *mate* will approach *met*. The Old English short vowel sounds are:

- a** as in artistic: **habban**, *to have*.
- æ** as in mankind: **dæg**, *day*.
- e, ƿ** as in let: **stelan**, *to steal*, **settan**, *to set*.
- i** as in sit: **hit**, *it*.
- o** as in broad (but shorter): **God**, *God*.
- ƿ** as in not: **lƿmb**, *lamb*.
- u** as in full: **sunu**, *son*.
- y** as in miller (with lips rounded) ¹: **gylden**, *golden*.

NOTE.—The symbol ƿ is known as *umlaut-e* (§ 58). It stands for Germanic *a*, while **e** (without the cedilla) represents Germanic *e*. The symbol ƿ is employed only before **m** and **n**. It, too, represents Germanic *a*. But Alfred writes **manig** or **monig**, *many*; **lamb** or **lomb**, *lamb*; **hand** or **hond**, *hand*, etc. The cedilla is an etymological sign added by modern grammarians.

The letters ƿ and ƿ were printed as shown in this e-text. The diacritic is not a cedilla (open to the left) but an ogonek (open to the right).

Consonants.

8. There is little difference between the values of Old English consonants and those of Modern English. The following distinctions, however, require notice:

The digraph **th** is represented in Old English texts by **ð** and **þ**, no consistent distinction being made between them. In the works of Alfred, **ð** (capital, **Ð**) is the more common: **ðās**, *those*; **ðæt**, *that*; **bindeð**, *he binds*.

The consonant **c** had the hard sound of *k*, the latter symbol being rare in West Saxon: **cýning**, *king*; **cwēn**, *queen*; **cūð**, *known*. When followed by a palatal vowel sound,—*e*, *i*, *æ*, *ea*, *eo*, long or short,—a vanishing *y* sound was doubtless interposed (*cf.* dialectic *kʸind* for *kind*). In Modern English the combination has passed into *ch*: **cealc**, *chalk*; **cīdan**, *to chide*; **læce**, *leech*; **cild**, *child*; **cēowan**, *to chew*. This change (*c* > *ch*) is known as Palatalization. The letter **g**, pronounced as in Modern English *gun*, has also a palatal value before the palatal vowels (*cf.* dialectic *gʸirl* for *girl*).

The combination **cg**, which frequently stands for **gg**, had probably the sound of *dge* in Modern English *edge*: **ęcg**, *edge*; **seęgan**, *to say*; **brycg**, *bridge*. Initial **h** is sounded as in Modern English: **habban**, *to have*; **hālga**, *saint*. When closing a syllable it has the sound of German *ch*: **slōh**, *he slew*; **hēah**, *high*; **ðurh**, *through*.

9. An important distinction is that between voiced (or sonant) and voiceless (or surd) consonants. ² In Old English they are as follows:

VOICED.	VOICELESS.
g	h, c
d	t
ð, þ (as in <i>though</i>)	ð, þ (as in <i>thin</i>)
b	p
f (= <i>v</i>)	f
s (= <i>z</i>)	s

It is evident, therefore, that **ð** (**þ**), **f**, and **s** have double values in Old English. If voiced, they are equivalent to *th* (in *though*), *v*, and *z*. Otherwise, they are pronounced as *th* (in *thin*), *f* (in *fin*), and *s* (in *sin*). The syllabic environment will usually compel the student to give these letters their proper values. When occurring between vowels, they are always voiced: **ōðer**, *other*; **ofer**, *over*; **rīsan**, *to rise*.

NOTE.—The general rule in Old English, as in Modern English, is, that voiced consonants have a special affinity for other voiced consonants, and voiceless for voiceless. This is the law of Assimilation. Thus when *de* is added to form the preterit of a verb whose stem ends in a voiceless consonant, the **d** is unvoiced, or assimilated, to **t**: **seętan**, *to set*, **seętte** (but **tręddan**, *to tread*, has **trędde**); **slępan**, *to sleep*, **slępte**; **dręncan**, *to drench*, **dręncte**; **cyssan**, *to kiss*, **cyste**. See § 126, Note 1.

Syllables.

10. A syllable is usually a vowel, either alone or in combination with consonants, uttered with a single impulse of stress; but certain consonants may form syllables: *oven* (= *ov-n*), *battle* (= *bæt-l*); (*cf.* also the vulgar pronunciation of *elm*).

A syllable may be (1) weak or strong, (2) open or closed, (3) long or short.

(1) A weak syllable receives a light stress. Its vowel sound is often different from that of the corresponding strong, or stressed, syllable. Cf. weak and strong *my* in “I want my *lárge* hat” and “I want *mý* hat.”

(2) An open syllable ends in a vowel or diphthong: **dē-man**, *to deem*; **ðū**, *thou*; **sca-can**, *to shake*; **dæ-ges**, *by day*. A closed syllable ends in one or more consonants: **ðing**, *thing*; **gōd**, *good*; **glæd**, *glad*.

(3) A syllable is long (a) if it contains a long vowel or a long diphthong: **drī-fan**, *to drive*; **lū-can**, *to lock*; **slā-pan**, *to sleep*; **cēo-san**, *to choose*; (b) if its vowel or diphthong is followed by more than one consonant: **cræft**, *strength*; **heard**, *hard*; **lib-ban**, *to live*; **feal-lan**, *to fall*. Otherwise, the syllable is short: **ðe**, *which*; **be-ran**, *to bear*; **ðæt**, *that*; **gie-fan**, *to give*.

NOTE 1.—A single consonant belongs to the following syllable: **hā-lig**, *holy* (not **hāl-ig**); **wri-tan**, *to write*; **fæ-der**, *father*.

NOTE 2.—The student will notice that the syllable may be long and the vowel short; but the vowel cannot be long and the syllable short.

NOTE 3.—Old English short vowels, occurring in open syllables, have regularly become long in Modern English: **we-fan**, *to weave*; **e-tan**, *to eat*; **ma-cian**, *to make*; **na-cod**, *naked*; **a-can**, *to ache*; **o-fer**, *over*. And Old English long vowels, preceding two or more consonants, have generally been shortened: **brēost**, *breast*; **hǣlð**, *health*; **slǣpte**, *slept*; **lǣdde**, *led*.

Accentuation.

11. The accent in Old English falls usually on the radical syllable, never on the inflectional ending: **bríngan**, *to bring*; **stānas**, *stones*; **bérende**, *bearing*; **ídelnes**, *idleness*; **fréondscipe**, *friendship*.

But in the case of compound nouns, adjectives, and adverbs the first member of the compound (unless it be **ge-** or **be-**) receives the stronger stress: **héofon-ríce**, *heaven-kingdom*; **ǫnd-giet**, *intelligence*; **sōð-fæst**, *truthful*; **gód-cund**, *divine*; **éall-unga**, *entirely*; **blíðe-líce**, *blithely*. But **be-hāt**, *promise*; **ge-béd**, *prayer*; **ge-féalīc**, *joyous*; **be-sōne**, *immediately*.

Compound verbs, however, have the stress on the radical syllable: **for-gíefan**, *to forgive*; **of-línnan**, *to cease*; **ā-cnāwan**, *to know*; **wið-stǫndan**, *to withstand*; **on-sácan**, *to resist*.

NOTE.—The tendency of nouns to take the stress on the prefix, while verbs retain it on the root, is exemplified in many Modern English words: *préference*, *préfér*; *cóntract* (noun), *contráct* (verb); *ábstinence*, *abstaín*; *pérfume* (noun), *perfúme* (verb).

1. Vowels are said to be round, or rounded, when the lip-opening is rounded; that is, when the lips are thrust out and puckered as if preparing to pronounce *w*. Thus *o* and *u* are round vowels: add *-ing* to each, and phonetically you have added *-wing*. *E.g.* *go^wing*, *su^wing*.
2. A little practice will enable the student to see the appropriateness of calling these consonants voiced and voiceless. Try to pronounce a voiced consonant,—*d* in *den*, for example, but without the assistance of *en*,—and there will be heard a gurgle, or *vocal* murmur. But in *t*, of *ten*, there is no sound at all, but only a feeling of tension in the organs.
3. Taken separately, every syllable ending in a single consonant is long. It may be said, therefore, that all closed syllables are long; but in the natural flow of language, the single final consonant of a syllable so often blends with a following initial vowel, the syllable thus becoming open and short, that such syllables are not recognized as prevailing long. *Cf.* Modern English *at all* (= *a-tall*).



CHAPTER III.

INFLECTIONS.

Cases.

12. There are five cases in Old English: the nominative, the genitive, the dative, the accusative, and the instrumental. ¹ Each of them, except the

nominative, may be governed by prepositions. When used without prepositions, they have, in general, the following functions:

- (a) The nominative, as in Modern English, is the case of the subject of a finite verb.
- (b) The genitive (the possessive case of Modern English) is the case of the possessor or source. It may be called the *of* case.
- (c) The dative is the case of the indirect object. It may be called the *to* or *for* case.
- (d) The accusative (the objective case of Modern English) is the case of the direct object.
- (e) The instrumental, which rarely differs from the dative in form, is the case of the means or the method. It may be called the *with* or *by* case.

The following paradigm of **mūð**, *the mouth*, illustrates the several cases (the article being, for the present, gratuitously added in the Modern English equivalents):

	<i>Singular.</i>	<i>Plural.</i>
N.	mūð = <i>the mouth</i> .	mūð-as = <i>the mouths</i> .
G.	mūð-es ² = <i>of the mouth (= the mouth's)</i> .	mūð-a = <i>of the mouths (= the mouths')</i> .
D.	mūð-e = <i>to or for the mouth</i> .	mūð-um = <i>to or for the mouths</i> .
A.	mūð = <i>the mouth</i> .	mūð-as = <i>the mouths</i> .
I.	mūðe = <i>with or by means of the mouth</i> .	mūð-um = <i>with or by means of the mouths</i> .

Gender.

13. The gender of Old English nouns, unlike that of Modern English, depends partly on meaning and partly on form, or ending. Thus **mūð**, *mouth*, is masculine; **tunge**, *tongue*, feminine; **ēage**, *eye*, neuter.

No very comprehensive rules, therefore, can be given; but the gender of every noun should be learned with its meaning. Gender will be indicated in the vocabularies by the different gender forms of the definite article, **sē** for the masculine, **sēo** for the feminine, and **ðæt** for the neuter: **sē mūð**, **sēo tunge**, **ðæt ēage** = *the mouth, the tongue, the eye*.

All nouns ending in **-dōm**, **-hād**, **-scipe**, or **-ere** are masculine (*cf.* Modern English *wisdom*, *childhood*, *friendship*, *worker*). Masculine, also, are nouns ending in **-a**.

Those ending in **-nes** or **-ung** are feminine (*cf.* Modern English *goodness*, and gerundial forms in *-ing*: *seeing* is *believing*).

Thus **sē wīsdōm**, *wisdom*; **sē cildhād**, *childhood*; **sē frēondscipe**, *friendship*; **sē fiscere**, *fisher(man)*; **sē hunta**, *hunter*; **sēo gelīcnes**, *likeness*; **sēo leornung**, *learning*.

Declensions.

14. There are two great systems of declension in Old English, the Vowel Declension and the Consonant Declension. A noun is said to belong to the Vowel Declension when the final letter of its stem is a vowel, this vowel being then known as the *stem-characteristic*; but if the stem-characteristic is a consonant, the noun belongs to the Consonant Declension. There might have been, therefore, as many subdivisions of the Vowel Declension in Old English as there were vowels, and as many subdivisions of the Consonant Declension as there were consonants. All Old English nouns, however, belonging to the Vowel Declension, ended their stems originally in **a**, **ō**, **i**, or **u**. Hence there are but four subdivisions of the Vowel Declension: **a**-stems, **ō**-stems, **i**-stems, and **u**-stems.

The Vowel Declension is commonly called the Strong Declension, and its nouns Strong Nouns.

NOTE.—The terms Strong and Weak were first used by Jacob Grimm (1785-1863) in the terminology of verbs, and thence transferred to nouns and adjectives. By a Strong Verb, Grimm meant one that could form its preterit out of its own resources; that is, without calling in the aid of an additional syllable: Modern English *run*, *ran*; *find*, *found*; but verbs of the Weak Conjugation had to borrow, as it were, an inflectional syllable: *gain*, *gained*; *help*, *helped*.

15. The stems of nouns belonging to the Consonant Declension ended, with but few exceptions, in the letter **n** (*cf.* Latin *homin-em*, *ration-em*, Greek ποιμέν-α). They are called, therefore, **n**-stems, the Declension itself being

known as the **n**-Declension, or the Weak Declension. The nouns, also, are called Weak Nouns.

16. If every Old English noun had preserved the original Germanic stem-characteristic (or final letter of the stem), there would be no difficulty in deciding at once whether any given noun is an **a**-stem, **ō**-stem, **i**-stem, **u**-stem, or **n**-stem; but these final letters had, for the most part, either been dropped, or fused with the case-endings, long before the period of historic Old English. It is only, therefore, by a rigid comparison of the Germanic languages with one another, and with the other Aryan languages, that scholars are able to reconstruct a single Germanic language, in which the original stem-characteristics may be seen far better than in any one historic branch of the Germanic group (§ 5, Note).

This hypothetical language, which bears the same ancestral relation to the historic Germanic dialects that Latin bears to the Romance tongues, is known simply as *Germanic* (Gmc.), or as *Primitive Germanic*. Ability to reconstruct Germanic forms is not expected of the students of this book, but the following table should be examined as illustrating the basis of distinction among the several Old English declensions (O.E. = Old English, Mn.E. = Modern English):

I. Strong or Vowel Declensions	{	(1) a -stems	{ Gmc. <i>staina-z</i> , O.E. stān , Mn.E. <i>stone</i> .
		(2) ō -stems	{ Gmc. <i>hallō</i> , O.E. heall , Mn.E. <i>hall</i> .
		(3) i -stems	{ Gmc. <i>bōni-z</i> , O.E. bēn , Mn.E. <i>boon</i> .
		(4) u -stems	{ Gmc. <i>sunu-z</i> , O.E. sunu , Mn.E. <i>son</i> .

II. Consonant Declensions	(1) n -stems (Weak Declension)	{	Gmc. <i>tungōn-iz</i> , O.E. tung-an , Mn.E. <i>tongue-s</i> .
	(2) Remnants of other Consonant Declensions	(a) {	Gmc. <i>fōt-iz</i> , O.E. fēt , Mn.E. <i>feet</i> .
		(b) {	Gmc. <i>frijōnd-iz</i> , O.E. frīend , Mn.E. <i>friend-s</i> .
		(c) {	Gmc. <i>brōðr-iz</i> , O.E. brōðor , Mn.E. <i>brother-s</i> .

NOTE.—“It will be seen that if Old English **ēage**, *eye*, is said to be an **n**-stem, what is meant is this, that at some former period the kernel of the word ended in **-n**, while, as far as the Old English language proper is concerned, all that is implied is that the word is inflected in a certain manner.” (Jespersen, *Progress in Language*, § 109).

This is true of all Old English stems, whether Vowel or Consonant. The division, therefore, into **a**-stems, **ō**-stems, etc., is made in the interests of grammar as well as of philology.

Conjugations.

17. There are, likewise, two systems of conjugation in Old English: the Strong or Old Conjugation, and the Weak or New Conjugation.

The verbs of the Strong Conjugation (the so-called Irregular Verbs of Modern English) number about three hundred, of which not one hundred remain in Modern English (§ 101, Note). They form their preterit and frequently their past participle by changing the radical vowel of the present stem. This vowel change or modification is called *ablaut* (pronounced *áhp-lowt*): Modern English *sing, sang, sung; rise, rose, risen*. As the radical vowel of the preterit plural is often different from that of the preterit singular, there are four *principal parts* or *tense stems* in an Old English strong verb, instead of the three of Modern English. The four principal parts in the conjugation of a strong verb are (1) the present indicative, (2) the

preterit indicative singular, (3) the preterit indicative plural, and (4) the past participle.

Strong verbs fall into seven groups, illustrated in the following table:

PRESENT.	PRET. SING.	PRET. PLUR.	PAST PARTICIPLE.
I. Bītan, <i>to bite</i>: Ic bīt-e, <i>I bite or shall bite.</i> ³	Ic bāt, <i>I bit.</i>	Wē bit-on, <i>we bit.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge⁴-biten, <i>I have bitten.</i>
II. Bēodan, <i>to bid</i>: Ic bēod-e, <i>I bid or shall bid.</i>	Ic bēad, <i>I bade.</i>	Wē bud-on, <i>we bade.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge-boden, <i>I have bidden.</i>
III. Bindan, <i>to bind</i>: Ic bind-e, <i>I bind or shall bind.</i>	Ic bōnd, <i>I bound.</i>	Wē bund-on, <i>we bound.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge-bunden, <i>I have bound.</i>
IV. Beran, <i>to bear</i>: Ic ber-e, <i>I bear or shall bear.</i>	Ic bær, <i>I bore.</i>	Wē bær-on, <i>we bore.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge-bor-en, <i>I have borne.</i>
V. Metan, <i>to measure</i>: Ic met-e, <i>I measure or shall measure.</i>	Ic mæt, <i>I measured.</i>	Wē mæt-on, <i>we measured.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge-met-en, <i>I have measured.</i>
VI.			

Faran, to go: Ic far-e, I go or shall go. VII. Feallan, to fall: Ic feall-e, I fall or shall fall.	Ic fōr, I went.	Wē fōr-on, we went.	Ic eom ⁵ ge-far-en, I have (am) gone.
	Ic fēoll, I fell.	Wē fēoll-on, we fell.	Ic eom ⁵ ge-feall-en, I have (am) fallen.

18. The verbs of the Weak Conjugation (the so-called Regular Verbs of Modern English) form their preterit and past participle by adding to the present stem a suffix ⁶ with *d* or *t*: Modern English *love, loved; sleep, slept*.

The stem of the preterit plural is never different from the stem of the preterit singular; hence these verbs have only three distinctive tense-stems, or principal parts: viz., (1) the present indicative, (2) the preterit indicative, and (3) the past participle.

Weak verbs fall into three groups, illustrated in the following table:

PRESENT.	PRETERIT.	PAST PARTICIPLE.
I. Frēmman, to perform: Ic frēm-m-e, I perform or shall perform.	Ic frēm-ede, I performed.	Ic hæbbe ge-frēm-ed, I have performed.
II. Bodian, to proclaim: Ic bodi-e, I proclaim or shall proclaim.	Ic bod-ode, I proclaimed.	Ic hæbbe ge-bod-od, I have proclaimed.
III. Habban, to have:		

Ic hæbbe , <i>I have or shall have.</i>	Ic hæf-de , <i>I had.</i>	Ic hæbbe ge-hæf-d , <i>I have had.</i>
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19. There remain a few verbs (chiefly the Auxiliary Verbs of Modern English) that do not belong entirely to either of the two conjugations mentioned. The most important of them are, **Ic mæg** *I may*, **Ic mihte** *I might*; **Ic cōn** *I can*, **Ic cūðe** *I could*; **Ic mōt** *I must*, **Ic mōste** *I must*; **Ic sceal** *I shall*, **Ic sceolde** *I should*; **Ic eom** *I am*, **Ic wæs** *I was*; **Ic wille** *I will*, **Ic wolde** *I would*; **Ic dō** *I do*, **Ic dyde** *I did*; **Ic gā** *I go*, **Ic ēode** *I went*.

All but the last four of these are known as Preterit-Present Verbs. The present tense of each of them is *in origin* a preterit, *in function* a present. Cf. Modern English *ought* (= *owed*).

1. Most grammars add a sixth case, the vocative. But it seems best to consider the vocative as only a *function* of the nominative *form*.
2. Of course our “apostrophe and s” (= ’s) comes from the Old English genitive ending **-es**. The *e* is preserved in *Wednesday* (= Old English **Wōdnes dæg**). But at a very early period it was thought that *John’s book*, for example, was a shortened form of *John his book*. Thus Addison (*Spectator*, No. 135) declares ’s a survival of *his*. How, then, would he explain the *s* of *his*? And how would he dispose of *Mary’s book*?
3. Early West Saxon had no distinctive form for the future. The present was used both as present proper and as future. Cf. Modern English “I go home tomorrow,” or “I am going home tomorrow” for “I shall go home tomorrow.”
4. The prefix **ge-** (Middle English *y-*), cognate with Latin *co* (*con*) and implying completeness of action, was not always used. It never occurs in the past participles of compound verbs: **op-feallan**, *to fall off*, past participle **op-feallen** (not **op-gefeallen**). Milton errs in prefixing it to a present participle:

“What needs my Shakespeare, for his honour’d bones,
The labour of an age in piled stones?
Or that his hallow’d reliques should be hid
Under a star-ypointing pyramid.”

—*Epitaph on William Shakespeare.*

And Shakespeare misuses it in “Y-ravished,” a preterit (*Pericles* III, *Prologue* l. 35).

It survives in the archaic *y-clept* (Old English **ge-clypod**, called). It appears as *a* in *aware* (Old English **ge-wær**), as *e* in *enough* (Old English **ge-nōh**), and as *i* in *handiwork* (Old English **hand-ge-weorc**).

5. With intransitive verbs denoting *change of condition*, the Old English auxiliary is usually some form of *to be* rather than *to have*. See § 139.

6. The theory that *loved*, for example, is a fused form of *love-did* has been generally given up. The dental ending was doubtless an Indo-Germanic suffix, which became completely specialized only in the Teutonic languages.



CHAPTER IV.

ORDER OF WORDS.

20. The order of words in Old English is more like that of Modern German than of Modern English. Yet it is only the Transposed order that the student will feel to be at all un-English; and the Transposed order, even before the period of the Norman Conquest, was fast yielding place to the Normal order.

The three divisions of order are (1) Normal, (2) Inverted, and (3) Transposed.

(1) Normal order = subject + predicate. In Old English, the Normal order is found chiefly in independent clauses. The predicate is followed by its modifiers: **Sē hwæl bið micle læssa þonne oðre hwalas**, *That whale is much smaller than other whales*; **Qnd hē geseah twā scipu**, *And he saw two ships*.

(2) Inverted order = predicate + subject. This order occurs also in independent clauses, and is employed (a) when some modifier of the predicate precedes the predicate, the subject being thrown behind. The words most frequently causing Inversion in Old English prose are **þā** *then*, **þonne** *then*, and **þær** *there*: **Ðā fōr hē**, *Then went he*; **Ðonne ærnað hȳ ealle tōweard þām fēo**, *Then gallop they all toward the property*; **ac þær bið medo genōh**, *but there is mead enough*.

Inversion is employed (b) in interrogative sentences: **Lufast ðū mē?** *Lovest thou me?* and (c) in imperative sentences: **Cume ðīn rīce**, *Thy kingdom come*.

(3) Transposed order = subject ... predicate. That is, the predicate comes last in the sentence, being preceded by its modifiers. This is the order observed in dependent clauses: ¹ **Ðonne cymeð sē man sē þæt swiftoste hors hafað**, *Then comes the man that has the swiftest horse* (literally, *that the swiftest horse has*); **Ne mētte hē ær nān gebūn land, siþþan hē froom his āgnum hām fōr**, *Nor did he before find any cultivated land, after he went from his own home* (literally, *after he from his own home went*).

21. Two other peculiarities in the order of words require a brief notice.

(1) Pronominal datives and accusatives usually precede the predicate: **Hē hine oferwann**, *He overcame him* (literally, *He him overcame*); **Dryhten him andwyrde**, *The Lord answered him*. But substantival datives and accusatives, as in Modern English, follow the predicate. The following sentence illustrates both orders: **Hȳ genāmon Ioseph, qnd hine gesealdon cīpemōnnum, qnd hȳ hine gesealdon in Ēgypta lōnd**, *They took Joseph, and him gave to the servants of his lord, and they him gave in Egypt the land*.

and sold him to merchants, and they sold him into Egypt (literally, They took Joseph, and him sold to merchants, and they him sold into Egyptians' land).

NOTE.—The same order prevails in the case of pronominal nominatives used as predicate nouns: **Ic hit eom**, *It is I* (literally, *I it am*); **Ðū hit eart**, *It is thou* (literally, *Thou it art*).

(2) The attributive genitive, whatever relationship it expresses, usually precedes the noun which it qualifies: **Breoton is gārsecges īgland**, *Britain is an island of the ocean* (literally, *ocean's island*); **Swilce hit is ēac berende on wēcga ōrum**, *Likewise it is also rich in ores of metals* (literally, *metals' ores*); **Cyninga cyning**, *King of kings* (literally, *Kings' king*); **Gē witon Godes rīces gerȳne**, *Ye know the mystery of the kingdom of God* (literally, *Ye know God's kingdom's mystery*).

A preposition governing the word modified by the genitive, precedes the genitive: **2 On ealdra manna sægenum**, *In old men's sayings*; **Æt ðāra strāta endum**, *At the ends of the streets* (literally, *At the streets' ends*); **For ealra ðīnra hālgena lufan**, *For all thy saints' love*. See, also, § 94, (5).

1. But in the *Voyages of Ohthere and Wulfstan*, in which the style is apparently more that of oral than of written discourse, the Normal is more frequent than the Transposed order in dependent clauses. In his other writings Alfred manifests a partiality for the Transposed order in dependent clauses, except in the case of substantival clauses introduced by **pæt**. Such clauses show a marked tendency to revert to their Normal *oratio recta* order. The norm thus set by the indirect affirmative clause seems to have proved an important factor in the ultimate disappearance of Transposition from dependent clauses. The influence of Norman French helped only to consummate forces that were already busily at work.

2. The positions of the genitive are various. It frequently follows its noun: **pā bearn pāra Aðeniensa**, *The children of the Athenians*. It may separate an adjective and a noun: **Ān lȳtel sæs earm**, *A little arm of (the) sea*. The genitive may here be

construed as an adjective, or part of a compound = *A little sea-arm*; **Mid mōnegum Godes gifum**, *With many God-gifts* = *many divine gifts*.



CHAPTER V.

PRACTICAL SUGGESTIONS.

22. In the study of Old English, the student must remember that he is dealing not with a foreign or isolated language but with the earlier forms of his own mother tongue. The study will prove profitable and stimulating in proportion as close and constant comparison is made of the old with the new. The guiding principles in such a comparison are reducible chiefly to two. These are (1) the regular operation of phonetic laws, resulting especially in certain Vowel Shiftings, and (2) the alterations in form and syntax that are produced by Analogy.

(1) “The former of these is of physiological or *natural* origin, and is perfectly and inflexibly regular throughout the same period of the same language; and even though different languages show different phonetic habits and predilections, there is a strong general resemblance between the changes induced in one language and in another; many of the particular laws are true for many languages.

(2) “The other principle is psychical, or mental, or *artificial*, introducing various more or less capricious changes that are supposed to be emendations; and its operation is, to some extent, uncertain and fitful.” ¹

(1) Vowel-Shiftings.

23. It will prove an aid to the student in acquiring the inflections and vocabulary of Old English to note carefully the following shiftings that

have taken place in the gradual growth of the Old English vowel system into that of Modern English.

(1) As stated in § 3, the Old English inflectional vowels, which were all short and unaccented, weakened in early Middle English to *e*. This *e* in Modern English is frequently dropped:

OLD ENGLISH. MIDDLE ENGLISH. MODERN ENGLISH.

stān-as	ston-es	stones
sun-u	sun-e	son
sun-a	sun-e	sons
ox-an	ox-en	oxen
swift-ra	swift-er	swifter
swift-ost	swift-est	swiftest
lōc-ode	lok-edē	looked

(2) The Old English long vowels have shifted their phonetic values with such uniform regularity that it is possible in almost every case to infer the Modern English sound; but our spelling is so chaotic that while the student may infer the modern sound, he cannot always infer the modern symbol representing the sound.

OLD ENGLISH. MODERN ENGLISH.

ā	<i>o</i> (as in <i>no</i>) ²	{ nā = <i>no</i> ; stān = <i>stone</i> ; bān = <i>bone</i> ; rād = <i>road</i> ; āc = <i>oak</i> ; hāl = <i>whole</i> ; hām = <i>home</i> ; sāwan = <i>to sow</i> ; gāst = <i>ghost</i> .
ē	<i>e</i> (as in <i>he</i>)	{ hē = <i>he</i> ; wē = <i>we</i> ; ðē = <i>thee</i> ; mē = <i>me</i> ; gē = <i>ye</i> ; hēl = <i>heel</i> ; wērig = <i>weary</i> ; gelēfan = <i>to believe</i> ; gēs = <i>geese</i> .
ī (ȳ)	<i>i (y)</i> (as in <i>mine</i>)	{ mīn = <i>mine</i> ; ðīn = <i>thine</i> ; wīr = <i>wire</i> ; mȳs = <i>mice</i> ; rīm = <i>rime</i> (wrongly spelt <i>rhyme</i>); lȳs = <i>lice</i> ; bī = <i>by</i> ; scīnan = <i>to shine</i> ; stig-rāp = <i>sty-rope</i> (shortened to <i>stirrup</i> , stīgan meaning <i>to mount</i>).
ō	<i>o</i> (as in <i>do</i>)	{ dō = <i>I do</i> ; tō = <i>too, to</i> ; gōs = <i>goose</i> ; tōð = <i>tooth</i> ; mōna = <i>moon</i> ; ðōm = <i>doom</i> ; mōd = <i>mood</i> ; wōgian = <i>to woo</i> ; slōh = <i>I slew</i> .
ū	<i>ou (ow)</i> (as in <i>thou</i>)	{ ðū = <i>thou</i> ; fūl = <i>foul</i> ; hūs = <i>house</i> ; nū = <i>now</i> ; hū = <i>how</i> ; tūn = <i>town</i> ; ūre = <i>our</i> ; ūt = <i>out</i> ; hlūd = <i>loud</i> ; ðūsēnd = <i>thousand</i> .

		ǣ : sǣ = sea; mǣl = meal; dǣlan = to deal; clǣne = clean; grǣdig = greedy.
ǣ, ēa, ēo	<i>ea</i> (as in sea)	{ ēa : ēare = ear; ēast = east; drēam = dream; gēar = year; bēatan = to beat.
		ēo : ðrēo = three; drēorig = dreary; sēo = she, hrēod = reed; dēop = deep.

(2) Analogy.

24. But more important than vowel shifting is the great law of Analogy, for Analogy shapes not only words but constructions. It belongs, therefore, to Etymology and to Syntax, since it influences both form and function. By this law, minorities tend to pass over to the side of the majorities. “The greater mass of cases exerts an assimilative influence upon the smaller.”³ The effect of Analogy is to simplify and to regularize. “The main factor in getting rid of irregularities is group-influence, or Analogy—the influence exercised by the members of an association-group on one another.... Irregularity consists in partial isolation from an association-group through some formal difference.”⁴

Under the influence of Analogy, entire declensions and conjugations have been swept away, leaving in Modern English not a trace of their former existence. There are in Old English, for example, five plural endings for nouns, **-as**, **-a**, **-e**, **-u**, and **-an**. No one could well have predicted⁵ that **-as** (Middle English **-es**) would soon take the lead, and become the norm to which the other endings would eventually conform, for there were more **an**-plurals than **as**-plurals; but the **as**-plurals were doubtless more often employed in everyday speech. *Oxen* (Old English **oxan**) is the sole pure survival of the hundreds of Old English **an**-plurals. No group of feminine nouns in Old English had **-es** as the genitive singular ending; but by the close of the Middle English period all feminines formed their genitive singular in **-es** (or **-s**, Modern English **'s**) after the analogy of the Old English masculine and neuter nouns with **es**-genitives. The weak preterits in **-ode** have all been leveled under the **ed**-forms, and of the three hundred strong verbs in Old English more than two hundred have become weak.

These are not cases of derivation (as are the shifted vowels): Modern English -s in *sons*, for example, could not possibly be derived from Old English -a in **suna**, or Middle English -e in *sune* (§ 23, (1)). They are cases of replacement by Analogy.

A few minor examples will quicken the student's appreciation of the nature of the influence exercised by Analogy:

(a) The intrusive *l* in *could* (Chaucer always wrote *coud* or *coude*) is due to association with *would* and *should*, in each of which *l* belongs by etymological right.

(b) *He need not* (for *He needs not*) is due to the assimilative influence of the auxiliaries *may*, *can*, etc., which have never added -s for their third person singular (§ 137).

(c) *I am friends with him*, in which *friends* is a crystalized form for *on good terms*, may be traced to the influence of such expressions as *He and I are friends*, *They are friends*, etc.

(d) Such errors as are seen in *runned*, *seed*, *gooses*, *badder*, *hisself*, *says I* (usually coupled with *says he*) are all analogical formations. Though not sanctioned by good usage, it is hardly right to call these forms the products of "false analogy." The grammar involved is false, because unsupported by literary usages and traditions; but the analogy on which these forms are built is no more false than the law of gravitation is false when it makes a dress sit unconventionally.

1. Skeat, *Principles of English Etymology*, Second Series, § 342.

But Jespersen, with Collitz and others, stoutly contests "the theory of sound laws and analogy sufficing between them to explain everything in linguistic development."

2. But Old English **ā** preceded by **w** sometimes gives Modern English *o* as in *two*: **twā** = *two*; **hwā** = *who*; **hwām** = *whom*.

3. Whitney, *Life and Growth of Language*, Chap. IV.

4. Sweet, *A New English Grammar*, Part I., § 535.

5. As Skeat says (§ 22, (2)), Analogy is “fitful.” It enables us to explain many linguistic phenomena, but not to anticipate them. The multiplication of books tends to check its influence by perpetuating the forms already in use. Thus Chaucer employed nine *en*-plurals, and his influence served for a time to check the further encroachment of the *es*-plurals. As soon as there is an acknowledged standard in any language, the operation of Analogy is fettered.

PART II.



ETYMOLOGY AND SYNTAX.



THE STRONG OR VOWEL DECLENSIONS OF NOUNS.

THE **a**-DECLENSION.



CHAPTER VI.

(*a*) Masculine *a*-Stems.

[O.E., M.E., and Mn.E. will henceforth be used for Old English, Middle English, and Modern English. Other abbreviations employed are self-explaining.]

25. The **a**-Declension, corresponding to the Second or *o*-Declension of Latin and Greek, contains only (*a*) masculine and (*b*) neuter nouns. To this declension belong most of the O.E. masculine and neuter nouns of the Strong Declension. At a very early period, many of the nouns belonging properly to the **i**- and **u**-Declensions began to pass over to the **a**-Declension.

This declension may therefore be considered the *normal declension* for all masculine and neuter nouns belonging to the Strong Declension.

26. Paradigms of *sē mūð*, *mouth*; *sē fiscere*, *fisherman*; *sē hwæl*, *whale*; *sē mearh*, *horse*; *sē finger*, *finger*:

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	mūð	fiscer-e	hwæl	mearh	finger
<i>G.</i>	mūð-es	fiscer-es	hwæl-es	mēar-es	fingr-es
<i>D.I.</i>	mūð-e	fiscer-e	hwæl-e	mēar-e	fingr-e
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	mūð-as	fiscer-as	hwal-as	mēar-as	fingr-as
<i>G.</i>	mūð-a	fiscer-a	hwal-a	mēar-a	fingr-a
<i>D.I.</i>	mūð-um	fiscer-um	hwal-um	mēar-um	fingr-um

NOTE.—For meanings of the cases, see § 12. The dative and instrumental are alike in all nouns.

27. The student will observe (1) that nouns whose nominative ends in **-e** (**fiscere**) drop this letter before adding the case endings; (2) that **æ** before a consonant (**hwæl**) changes to **a** in the plural; ¹ (3) that **h**, preceded by **r** (**mearh**) or **l** (**seolh**, *seal*), is dropped before an inflectional vowel, the stem diphthong being then lengthened by way of compensation; (4) that dissyllables (**finger**) having the first syllable long, usually syncopate the vowel of the second syllable before adding the case endings. ²

28. Paradigm of the Definite Article ³ *sē*, *sēo*, *ðæt* = *the*:

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Feminine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
<i>Sing. N.</i>	sē (se)	sēo	ðæt
<i>G.</i>	ðæs	ðære	ðæs
<i>D.</i>	ðæm (ðām)	ðære	ðæm (ðām)
<i>A.</i>	ðone	ðā	ðæt
<i>I.</i>	ðȳ, ðon	—	ðȳ, ðon
<i>All Genders.</i>			
<i>Plur. N.A.</i>	ðā		
<i>G.</i>	ðāra		
<i>D.</i>	ðæm (ðām)		

29. VOCABULARY. ⁴

sē bōcere, *scribe* [bōc].

sē cyning, *king*.

sē dæg, *day*.

sē ɛnde, *end*.
sē ɛngel, *angel* [angelus].
sē frēodōm, *freedom*.
sē fugol (G. sometimes **fugles**), *bird* [fowl].
sē gār, *spear* [gore, gar-fish].
sē heofon, *heaven*.
sē hierde, *herdsman* [shep-herd].
ɔnd (and), *and*.
sē secg, *man, warrior*.
sē seolh, *seal*.
sē stān, *stone*.
sē wealh, *foreigner, Welshman* [wal-nut].
sē weall, *wall*.
sē wīsdōm, *wisdom*.
sē wulf, *wolf*.

30.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Ðāra wulfa mūðas. 2. Ðæs fisceres fingras. 3. Ðāra Wēala cyninge. 4. Ðæm ɛnglum ɔnd ðæm hierdum. 5. Ðāra daga ɛnde. 6. Ðæm bōcerum ɔnd ðæm secgum ðæs cyninges. 7. Ðæm sēole ɔnd ðæm fuglum. 8. Ðā stānas ɔnd ðā gāras. 9. Hwala ɔnd mēara. 10. Ðāra ɛngla wīsdōm. 11. Ðæs cyninges bōceres frēodōm. 12. Ðāra hierda fuglum. 13. Ðȳ stāne. 14. Ðæm wealle.

II. 1. For the horses and the seals. 2. For the Welshmen's freedom. 3. Of the king's birds. 4. By the wisdom of men and angels. 5. With the spear and the stone. 6. The herdsman's seal and the warriors' spears. 7. To the king of heaven. 8. By means of the scribe's wisdom. 9. The whale's mouth and the foreigner's spear. 10. For the bird belonging to (= of) the king's scribe. 11. Of that finger.

1. Adjectives usually retain **æ** in closed syllables, changing it to **a** in open syllables: **hwæt** (*active*), **glæd** (*glad*), **wær** (*wary*) have G. **hwates**, **glades**, **wares**; D. **hwatum**, **gladum**, **warum**; but A. **hwætne**, **glædne**, **wærne**. Nouns, however, change to **a** only in

open syllables followed by a guttural vowel, **a** or **u**. The **æ** in the open syllables of the singular is doubtless due to the analogy of the N.A. singular, both being closed syllables.

2. Cf. Mn.E. *drizz'ling*, *rememb'ring*, *abysmal* (*abysm* = *abiz^um*), *sick'ning*, in which the principle of syncopation is precisely the same.

3. This may mean four things: (1) *The*, (2) *That* (demonstrative), (3) *He, she, it*, (4) *Who, which, that* (relative pronoun). Mn.E. demonstrative *that* is, of course, the survival of O.E. neuter **ðæt** in its demonstrative sense. Professor Victor Henry (*Comparative Grammar of English and German*, § 160, 3) sees a survival of dative plural demonstrative **ðāem** in such an expression as *in them days*. It seems more probable, however, that *them* so used has followed the lead of *this* and *these*, *that* and *those*, in their double function of pronoun and adjective. There was doubtless some such evolution as, *I saw them. Them what? Them boys.*

An unquestioned survival of the dative singular feminine of the article is seen in the *-ter* of *Atterbury* (= **æt ðære byrig**, *at the town*); and **ðāem** survives in the *-ten* of *Attenborough*, the word *borough* having become an uninflected neuter. Skeat, *Principles*, First Series, § 185.

4. The brackets contain etymological hints that may help the student to discern relationships otherwise overlooked. The genitive is given only when not perfectly regular.



CHAPTER VII.

(b) Neuter *a*-Stems.

31. The neuter nouns of the **a**-Declension differ from the masculines only in the N.A. plural.

32. Paradigms of **ðæt hof**, *court, dwelling*; **ðæt bearn**, *child*; **ðæt bān**, *bone*; **ðæt rīce**, *kingdom*; **ðæt spere**, *spear*; **ðæt werod**, *band of men*; **ðæt tungol**, *star*:

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	hof	bearn	bān	rīc-e	sper-e	werod	tungol
<i>G.</i>	hof-es	bearn-es	bān-es	rīc-es	sper-es	werod-es	tungl-es
<i>D.I.</i>	hof-e	bearn-e	bān-e	rīc-e	sper-e	werod-e	tungl-e
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	hof-u	bearn	bān	rīc-u	sper-u	werod	tungl-u
<i>G.</i>	hof-a	bearn-a	bān-a	rīc-a	sper-a	werod-a	tungl-a
<i>D.I.</i>	hof-um	bearn-um	bān-um	rīc-um	sper-um	werod-um	tungl-um

33. The paradigms show (1) that monosyllables with short stems (**hof**) take **-u** in the N.A. plural; (2) that monosyllables with long stems (**bearn**, **bān**) do not distinguish the N.A. plural from the N.A. singular; ¹ (3) that dissyllables in **-e**, whether the stem be long or short (**rīce**, **spere**), have **-u** in the N.A. plural; (4) that dissyllables ending in a consonant and having the first syllable short ² (**werod**) do not usually distinguish the N.A. plural from the N.A. singular; (5) that dissyllables ending in a consonant and having the first syllable long (**tungol**) more frequently take **-u** in the N.A. plural.

NOTE.—Syncopation occurs as in the masculine **a**-stems. See § 27, (4).

34. Present and Preterit Indicative of **habban**, *to have*:

PRESENT.

- Sing.* 1. **Ic hæbbe**, *I have, or shall have.* ³
 2. **ðū hæfst** (**hafast**), *thou hast, or wilt have.*
 3. **hē, hēo, hit hæfð** (**hafað**), *he, she, it has, or will have.*
Plur. 1. **wē habbað**, *we have, or shall have.*
 2. **gē habbað**, *ye have, or will have.*
 3. **hīe habbað**, *they have, or will have.*

PRETERIT.

- Sing.* 1. **Ic hæfde** *I had.*
 2. **ðū hæfdest**, *thou hadst.*
 3. **hē, hēo, hit hæfde**, *he, she, it had.*
Plur. 1. **wē hæfdon**, *we had.*
 2. **gē hæfdon**, *ye had.*
 3. **hīe hæfdon**, *they had.*

NOTE.—The negative **ne**, *not*, which always precedes its verb, contracts with all the forms of **habban**. The negative loses its **e**, **habban** its **h**. **Ne** + **habban** = **nabban**; **Ic ne hæbbe** = **Ic næbbe**; **Ic ne hæfde** = **Ic næfde**, etc. The negative forms may be got, therefore, by simply substituting in each case **n** for **h**.

35.

VOCABULARY.

ðæt dæl, *dale*.

ðæt dēor, *animal* [deer ⁴].

ðæt dor, *door*.

ðæt fæt, *vessel* [vat].

ðæt fȳr, *fire*.

ðæt gēar, *year*.

ðæt geoc, *yoke*.

ðæt geset, *habitation* [settlement].

ðæt hēafod, *head*.

ðæt hūs, *house*.

ðæt līc, *body* [lich-gate].

ðæt lim, *limb*.

on (with dat.) *in*.

ðæt spor, *track*.

ðæt wāpen, *weapon*.

ðæt wīf, *wife, woman*.

ðæt wīte, *punishment*.

ðæt word, *word*.

36.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Hē hafað ðæs cyninges bearn. 2. Ðā Wēalas habbað ðā speru. 3. Ðā wīf habbað ðāra sēcga wāpnu. 4. Ðū hæfst ðone fugol qnd ðæt hūs ðæs hierdes. 5. Hæfð ⁵ hēo ðā fatu ⁶? 6. Hæfde hē ðæs wīfes līc on ðæm hofe? 7. Hē næfde ðæs wīfes līc; hē hæfde ðæs dēores hēafod. 8. Hæfð sē cyning gesetu on ðæm dæle? 9. Sē bōcere hæfð ðā sēolas on ðæm hūse. 10. Gē habbað frēodōm.

II. 1. They have yokes and spears. 2. We have not the vessels in the house. 3. He had fire in the vessel. 4. Did the woman have (= Had the woman) the children? 5. The animal has the body of the woman's child. 6. I shall have

the heads of the wolves. 7. He and she have the king's houses. 8. Have not (= **Nabbað**) the children the warrior's weapons?

1. Note the many nouns in Mn.E. that are unchanged in the plural. These are either survivals of O.E. long stems, *swine, sheep, deer, folk*, or analogical forms, *fish, trout, mackerel, salmon*, etc.

2. Dissyllables whose first syllable is a prefix are, of course, excluded. They follow the declension of their last member: **gebed**, *prayer*, **gebedu**, *prayers*; **gefeoht**, *battle*, **gefeoht**, *battles*.

3. See § 17, Note 1. Note that (as in **hwæl**, § 27, (2)) **æ** changes to **a** when the following syllable contains **a**: **hæbbe**, but **hafast**.

4. The old meaning survives in Shakespeare's "Rats and mice and such small deer," *King Lear*, III, iv, 144.

5. See § 20, (2), (b).

6. See § 27, (2).



CHAPTER VIII.

THE **ō**-DECLENSION.

37. The **ō**-Declension, corresponding to the First or *ā*-Declension of Latin and Greek, contains only feminine nouns. Many feminine **i**-stems and **u**-stems soon passed over to this Declension. The **ō**-Declension may, therefore, be considered the *normal declension* for all strong feminine nouns.

38. Paradigms of **sēo giefu**, *gift*; **sēo wund**, *wound*; **sēo rōd**, *cross*; **sēo leornung**, *learning*; **sēo sāwol**, *soul*:

<i>Sing. N.</i>	gief-u	wund	rōd	leornung	sāwol
<i>G.</i>	gief-e	wund-e	rōd-e	leornung-a (e)	sāwl-e

D.I.	gief-e	wund-e	rōd-e	leornung-a (e)	sāwl-e
A.	gief-e	wund-e	rōd-e	leornung-a (e)	sāwl-e
Plur. N.A.	gief-a	wund-a	rōd-a	leornung-a	sāwl-a
G.	gief-a	wund-a	rōd-a	leornung-a	sāwl-a
D.I.	gief-um	wund-um	rōd-um	leornung-um	sāwl-um

39. Note (1) that monosyllables with short stems (**giefu**) take **u** in the nominative singular; (2) that monosyllables with long stems (**wund, rōd**) present the unchanged stem in the nominative singular; (3) that dissyllables are declined as monosyllables, except that abstract nouns in **-ung** prefer **a** to **e** in the singular.

NOTE.—Syncope occurs as in masculine and neuter **a**-stems. See § 27, (4).

40. Present and Preterit Indicative of **bēon (wesan)** to be:

PRESENT (first form).		PRESENT (second form).		PRETERIT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic eom	1. Ic bēom		1. Ic wæs	
2.	ðū eart	2. ðū bist		2. ðū wære	
3.	hē is	3. hē bið		3. hē wæs	
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	1. wē	} bēoð	1. wē	} wæron
2.	gē	2. gē		2. gē	
3.	hīe	3. hīe		3. hīe	
		} sind(on), sint			

NOTE 1.—The forms **bēom, bist**, etc. are used chiefly as future tenses in O.E. They survive to-day only in dialects and in poetry. Farmer Dobson, for example, in Tennyson's *Promise of May*, uses *be* for all persons of the present indicative, both singular and plural; and *there be* is frequent in Shakespeare for *there are*. The Northern dialect employed **aron** as well as **sindon** and **sind** for the present plural; hence Mn.E. *are*.

NOTE 2.—Fusion with **ne** gives **neom, neart, nis** for the present; **næs, nære, næron** for the preterit.

NOTE 3.—The verb *to be* is followed by the nominative case, as in Mn.E.; but when the predicate noun is plural, and the subject a neuter pronoun in the singular, the verb agrees in number with the predicate noun. The neuter singular **ðæt** is frequently employed in this construction: **Ðæt wæron eall Finnas**, *They were all Fins*; **Ðæt sind englas**, *They are angels*; **Ðæt wæron engla gāstas**, *They were angels' spirits*.

Notice, too, that O.E. writers do not say *It is I, It is thou*, but *I it am, Thou it art*: **Ic hit eom, ðū hit eart**. See § 21, (1), Note 1.

41. VOCABULARY.

sēo brycg, *bridge*.

sēo costnung, *temptation*.

sēo cwalu, *death* [quail, quell].
sēo fōr, *journey* [faran].
sēo frōfor, *consolation, comfort*.
sēo geoguð, *youth*.
sēo glōf, *glove*.
sēo hālignes ¹, *holiness*.
sēo heall, *hall*.
hēr, *here*.
hwā, *who?*
hwær, *where?*
sēo lufu, *love*.
sēo mearc, *boundary* [mark, marches ²].
sēo mēd, *meed, reward*.
sēo mildheortnes, *mild-heartedness, mercy*.
sēo stōw, *place* [stow away].
ðær, *there*.
sēo ðearf, *need*.
sēo wylf, *she wolf*.

42.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Hwær is ðære brycge ende? 2. Hēr sind ðāra rīca mearca. 3. Hwā hæfð þā glōfa? 4. Ðær bið ðām cyninge frōfre ðearf. 5. Sēo wund is on ðære wylfe hēafde. 6. Wē habbað costnunga. 7. Hīe nāron on ðære healle. 8. Ic hit neom. 9. Ðæt wāron Wēalas. 10. Ðæt sind ðæs wīfes bearn.

II. 1. We shall have the women's gloves. 2. Where is the place? 3. He will be in the hall. 4. Those (**Ðæt**) were not the boundaries of the kingdom. 5. It was not I. 6. Ye are not the king's scribes. 7. The shepherd's words are full (**full** + gen.) of wisdom and comfort. 8. Where are the bodies of the children? 9. The gifts are not here. 10. Who has the seals and the birds?

1. All words ending in **-nes** double the **-s** before adding the case endings.

2. As in *warden of the marches*.



CHAPTER IX.

THE **i**-DECLENSION AND THE **u**-DECLENSION.

The *i*-Declension. (See § 58.)

43. The **i**-Declension, corresponding to the group of *i*-stems in the classical Third Declension, contains chiefly (*a*) masculine and (*b*) feminine nouns. The N.A. plural of these nouns ended originally in **-e** (from older **i**).

(*a*) Masculine *i*-Stems.

44. These stems have almost completely gone over to the **a**-Declension, so that **-as** is more common than **-e** as the N.A. plural ending, whether the stem is long or short. The short stems all have **-e** in the N.A. singular.

45. Paradigms of **sē wȳrm**, *worm*; **sē wine**, *friend*.

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	wȳrm	win-e
<i>G.</i>	wȳrm-es	win-es
<i>D.I.</i>	wȳrm-e	win-e
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	wȳrm-as	win-as (e)
<i>G.</i>	wȳrm-a	win-a
<i>D.I.</i>	wȳrm-um	win-um

Names of Peoples.

46. The only **i**-stems that regularly retain **-e** of the N.A. plural are certain names of tribes or peoples used only in the plural.

47. Paradigms of **ðā ƿngle**, *Angles*; **ðā Norðymbre**, *Northumbrians*; **ðā lēode**, *people*:

<i>Plur. N.A.</i>	ƿngle	Norðymbre	lēode
<i>G.</i>	ƿngla	Norðymbra	lēoda

(b) Feminine *i*-Stems.

48. The short stems (**frēm-u**) conform entirely to the declension of short **ō**-stems; long stems (**cwēn**, **wyrt**) differ from long **ō**-stems in having no ending for the A. singular. They show, also, a preference for **-e** rather than **-a** in the N.A. plural.

49. Paradigms of **sēo frēm-u**, *benefit*; **sēo cwēn**, *woman, queen* [quean]; **sēo wyrt**, *root* [wort]:

<i>Sing. N.</i>	frēm-u	cwēn	wyrt
<i>G.</i>	frēm-e	cwēn-e	wyrt-e
<i>D.I.</i>	frēm-e	cwēn-e	wyrt-e
<i>A.</i>	frēm-e	cwēn	wyrt
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	frēm-a	cwēn-e (a)	wyrt-e (a)
<i>G.</i>	frēm-a	cwēn-a	wyrt-a
<i>D.I.</i>	frēm-um	cwēn-um	wyrt-um

The *u*-Declension.

50. The **u**-Declension, corresponding to the group of **u**-stems in the classical Third Declension, contains no neuters, and but few (*a*) masculines and (*b*) feminines. The short-stemmed nouns of both genders (**sun-u**, **dur-u**) retain the final **u** of the N.A. singular, while the long stems (**feld**, **hṡnd**) drop it. The influence of the masculine **a**-stems is most clearly seen in the long-stemmed masculines of the **u**-Declension (**feld**, **feld-es**, etc.).

NOTE.—Note the general aversion of all O.E. long stems to final **-u**: cf. N.A. plural **hof-u**, but **bearn**, **bān**; N. singular **gief-u**, but **wund**, **rōd**; N. singular **frēm-u**, but **cwēn**, **wyrt**; N.A. singular **sun-u**, **dur-u**, but **feld**, **hṡnd**.

(a) Masculine *u*-Stems.

51. Paradigms of **sē sun-u**, *son*; **sē feld**, *field*:

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	sun-u	feld
<i>G.</i>	sun-a	feld-a (es)
<i>D.I.</i>	sun-a	feld-a (e)

<i>Plur N.A.</i>	sun-a	feld-a (as)
<i>G.</i>	sun-a	feld-a
<i>D.I.</i>	sun-um	feld-um

(b) Feminine *u*-Stems.

52. Paradigms of **sēo dur-u**, *door*; **sēo hōnd**, *hand*:

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	dur-u	hōnd
<i>G.</i>	dur-a	hōnd-a
<i>D.I.</i>	dur-a	hōnd-a
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	dur-a	hōnd-a
<i>G.</i>	dur-a	hōnd-a
<i>D.I.</i>	dur-um	hōnd-um

53. Paradigm of the Third Personal Pronoun, **hē**, **hēo**, **hit** = *he, she, it*:

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Feminine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
<i>Sing. N.</i>	hē	hēo	hit
<i>G.</i>	his	hiere	his
<i>D.</i>	him	hiere	him
<i>A.</i>	hine, hiene	hīe	hit
<i>All Genders.</i>			
<i>Plur. N.A.</i>		hīe	
<i>G.</i>		hiera	
<i>D.</i>		him	

54. VOCABULARY.

(i-STEMS.)

sē cierr, *turn, time* [char, chare, chore].

sēo dǣd, *deed*.

sē dǣl, *part* [a great deal].

ǣa Dene, *Danes*.

sē frēondscipe, *friendship*.

sēo hȳd, *skin, hide*.

ǣa lōndlēode, *natives*.

ǣa Mierce, *Mercians*.

ǣa Rōmware, *Romans*.

ǣa Seaxe, *Saxons*.

sē stede, *place* [in-stead of].

(**u**-STEMS.)

sēo flōr, *floor*.

sēo nosu, *nose*.

sē sumor (*G. sumeres, D. sumera*), *summer*.

sē winter (*G. wintres, D. wintra*), *winter*.

sē wudu, *wood, forest*.

NOTE.—The numerous masculine nouns ending in **-hād**,—**cildhād** (*childhood*), **wīfhād** (*womanhood*),—belong to the **u**-stems historically; but they have all passed over to the **a**-Declension.

55.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Ðā Seaxe habbað ðæs dēores hȳd on ðæm wuda. 2. Hwā hæfð ðā giefā? 3. Ðā Mierce hīe ¹ habbað. 4. Hwær is ðæs Wēales fugol? 5. Ðā Dene hiene habbað. 6. Hwær sindon hiera winas? 7. Hīe sindon on ðæs cyninges wuda. 8. Ðā Rōmware qnd ðā Seaxe hæfdon ðā gāras qnd ðā geocu. 9. Hēo is on ðæm hūse on wintra, qnd on ðæm feldum on sumera. 10. Hwær is ðæs hofes duru? 11. Hēo ² (= sēo duru) nis hēr.

II. 1. His friends have the bones of the seals and the bodies of the Danes. 2. Art thou the king's son? 3. Has she her ³ gifts in her ³ hands? 4. Here are the fields of the natives. 5. Who had the bird? 6. I had it. ² 7. The child had the worm in his ³ fingers. 8. The Mercians were here during (the) summer (**on** + dat.).

1. See § 21, (1).

2. Pronouns agree in gender with the nouns for which they stand.

Hit, however, sometimes stands for inanimate things of both masculine and feminine genders. See Wūlfing (*l.c.*) I, § 238.

3. See § 76 (last sentence).



CHAPTER X.

PRESENT INDICATIVE ENDINGS OF STRONG VERBS.

56. The unchanged stem of the present indicative may always be found by dropping **-an** of the infinitive: **feall-an**, *to fall*; **cēos-an**, *to choose*; **bīd-an**, *to abide*.

57. The personal endings are:

Sing. 1.	-e	Plur. 1.	} -aǥ
2.	-est	2.	
3.	-eǥ	3.	

i-Umlaut.

58. The 2d and 3d singular endings were originally not **-est** and **-eǥ**, but **-is** and **-iǥ**; and the **i** of these older endings has left its traces upon almost every page of Early West Saxon literature. This **i**, though unaccented and soon displaced, exerted a powerful back influence upon the vowel of the preceding accented syllable. This influence, a form of regressive assimilation, is known as **i-umlaut** (pronounced *oóm-lowt*). The vowel **i** or **j** (= *y*), being itself a palatal, succeeded in palatalizing every guttural vowel that preceded it, and in imposing still more of the **i**-quality upon diphthongs that were already palatal. ¹ The changes produced were these:

a	became	ę (æ):	męnn (< *mann-iz), <i>men</i> .
ā	“	ǣ	ǣnig (< *ān-ig), <i>any</i> .
u	“	y	wyllen (< *wull-in), <i>woollen</i> .
ū	“	ȳ	mȳs (< *mūs-iz), <i>mice</i> .
o	“	ę	dęhter (< *dohtr-i), <i>to or for the daughter</i> .
ō	“	ē	fēt (< *fōt-iz), <i>feet</i> .
ea	“	ie	wiexǥ (< *weax-iǥ), <i>he grows</i> (weaxan = <i>to grow</i>).
ēa	“	īe	hīewǥ (< *hēaw-iǥ), <i>he hews</i> (hēawan = <i>to hew</i>).
eo	“	ie	wiercan (< *weorc-jan), <i>to work</i> .
ēo	“	īe	līehtan (< *lēoht-jan), <i>to light</i> .

The Unchanged Present Indicative.

59. In the Northumbrian and Mercian dialects, as well as in the dialect of Late West Saxon, the 2d and 3d singular endings were usually joined to the present stem without modification either of the stem itself or of the personal endings. The complete absence of umlauted forms in the present indicative of Mn.E. is thus accounted for.

In Early West Saxon, however, such forms as the following are comparatively rare in the 2d and 3d singular:

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic feall-e (<i>I fall</i>)	cēos-e (<i>I choose</i>)	bīd-e (<i>I abide</i>)
2.	ðū feall-est	cēos-est	bīd-est
3.	hē feall-eð	cēos-eð	bīd-eð
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} feall-að cēos-að bīd-að	
2.	gē		
3.	hīe		

The Present Indicative with i-Umlaut and Contraction.

60. The 2d and 3d persons singular are distinguished from the other forms of the present indicative in Early West Saxon by (1) **i**-umlaut of the vowel of the stem, (2) syncope of the vowel of the ending, giving **-st** and **-ð** for **-est** and **-eð**, and (3) contraction of **-st** and **-ð** with the final consonant or consonants of the stem.

Contraction.

61. The changes produced by **i**-umlaut have been already discussed. By these changes, therefore, the stems of the 2d and 3d singular indicative of such verbs as (1) **stōndan** (= **standan**), *to stand*, (2) **cuman**, *to come*, (3) **grōwan**, *to grow*, (4) **brūcan**, *to enjoy*, (5) **blāwan**, *to blow*, (6) **feallan**, *to fall*, (7) **hēawan**, *to hew*, (8) **weorpan**, *to throw*, and (9) **cēosan**, *to choose*, become respectively (1) **stēnd-**,² (2) **cym-**, (3) **grēw-**, (4) **brȳc-**, (5) **blāw-**, (6) **fiell-**, (7) **hīew-**, (8) **wierp-**, and (9) **cīes-**.

If the unchanged stem contains the vowel **e**, this is changed in the 2d and 3d singular to **i** (**ie**): **cweðan** *to say*, stem **cwið-**; **beran** *to bear*, stem **bier-**. But this mutation³ had taken place long before the period of O.E., and belongs

to the Germanic languages in general. It is best, however, to class the change of **e** to **i** or **ie** with the changes due to umlaut, since it occurs consistently in the 2d and 3d singular stems of Early West Saxon, and outlasted almost all of the umlaut forms proper.

If, now, the syncopated endings **-st** and **-ð** are added directly to the umlauted stem, there will frequently result such a massing of consonants as almost to defy pronunciation: **cwið-st**, *thou sayest*; **stend-st**, *thou standest*, etc. Some sort of contraction, therefore, is demanded for the sake of euphony. The ear and eye will, by a little practice, become a sure guide in these contractions. The following rules, however, must be observed. They apply only to the 2d and 3d singular of the present indicative:

(1) If the stem ends in a double consonant, one of the consonants is dropped:

- | | | |
|------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. feall-e (<i>I fall</i>) | 1. winn-e (<i>I fight</i>) | 1. swimm-e (<i>I swim</i>) |
| 2. fiel-st | 2. win-st | 2. swim-st |
| 3. fiel-ð | 3. win-ð | 3. swim-ð |

(2) If the stem ends in **-ð**, this is dropped:

- | | |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------|
| 1. cweð-e (<i>I say</i>) | 1. weorð-e (<i>I become</i>) |
| 2. cwi-st | 2. wier-st |
| 3. cwi-ð | 3. wier-ð |

(3) If the stem ends in **-d**, this is changed to **-t**. The **-ð** of the ending is then also changed to **-t**, and usually absorbed. Thus the stem of the 2d singular serves as stem and ending for the 3d singular:

- | | | | |
|---|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. stōnd-e (= stand-e) (<i>I stand</i>) | 1. bind-e (<i>I bind</i>) | 1. bīd-e (<i>I abide</i>) | 1. rīd-e (<i>I ride</i>) |
| 2. stent-st | 2. bint-st | 2. bīt-st | 2. rīt-st |
| 3. stent | 3. bint | 3. bīt (-t) | 3. rīt (-t) |

(4) If the stem ends already in **-t**, the endings are added as in (3), **-ð** being again changed to **-t** and absorbed:

- | | | |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. brēot-e (<i>I break</i>) | 1. feoht-e (<i>I fight</i>) | 1. bīt-e (<i>I bite</i>) |
| 2. brīet-st | 2. fieht-st | 2. bīt-st |
| 3. brīet (-t) | 3. fieht | 3. bīt (-t) |

(5) If the stem ends in **-s**, this is dropped before **-st** (to avoid **-sst**), but is retained before **-ð**, the latter being changed to **-t**. Thus the 2d and 3d

singulars are identical: 4

- | | |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------|
| 1. cēos-e (<i>I choose</i>) | 1. rīs-e (<i>I rise</i>) |
| 2. cīe-st | 2. rī-st |
| 3. cīes-t | 3. rīs-t |

62.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Sē cyning fielð. 2. Ðā wīf cēosað ðā giefa. 3. Ðū stentst on ðæm hūse. 4. Hē wierpð ðæt wæpen. 5. Sē secg hīewð ðā līc. 6. Ðæt sād grēwð qnd wiexð (*Mark iv. 27*). 7. Ic stonde hēr, qnd ðū stentst ðær. 8. “Ic hit eom,” cwið hē. 9. Hīe berað ðæs wulfes bān. 10. Hē hīe bint, qnd ic hine binde. 11. Ne rītst ðū?

II. 1. We shall bind him. 2. Who chooses the child’s gifts? 3. “He was not here,” says she. 4. Wilt thou remain in the hall? 5. The wolves are biting (= bite) the fishermen. 6. He enjoys ⁵ the love of his children. 7. Do you enjoy (= Enjoyest thou) the consolation and friendship of the scribe? 8. Will he come? 9. I shall throw the spear, and thou wilt bear the weapons. 10. The king’s son will become king. 11. The army (**werod**) is breaking the doors and walls of the house.

1. The *palatal* vowels and diphthongs were long or short **æ, e, i, (ie), y, ea, eo**; the *guttural* vowels were long or short **a, o, u**.

2. The more common form for stems with **a** is **æ** rather than **ę**: **faran**, *to go*, 2d and 3d singular stem **fær-**; **sacan**, *to contend*, stem **sæc-**. Indeed, **a** changes to **ę** via **æ** (Cosijn, *Altwestsächsische Grammatik*, I, § 32).

3. Umlaut is frequently called Mutation. Metaphony is still another name for the same phenomenon. The term Metaphony has the advantage of easy adjectival formation (metaphonic). It was proposed by Professor Victor Henry (*Comparative Grammar of English and German*, Paris, 1894), but has not been naturalized.

4. This happens also when the infinitive stem ends in **st**:

1. berst-e (*I burst*)
2. bier-st

3. bierst.

5. **Brūcan**, *to enjoy*, usually takes the genitive case, not the accusative. It means “to have joy of any thing.”



CHAPTER XI.

THE CONSONANT DECLENSIONS OF NOUNS.

The Weak or *n*-Declension.

63. The **n**-Declension contains almost all of the O.E. nouns belonging to the Consonant Declensions. The stem characteristic **n** has been preserved in the oblique cases, so that there is no difficulty in distinguishing **n**-stems from the preceding vowel stems.

The **n**-Declension includes (a) masculines, (b) feminines, and (c) neuters. The masculines far outnumber the feminines, and the neuters contain only **ēage**, *eye* and **ēare**, *ear*. The masculines end in **-a**, the feminines and neuters in **-e**.

64. Paradigms of (a) **sē hunt-a**, *hunter*; (b) **sēo tung-e**, *tongue*; (c) **ðæt ēage**, *eye*:

<i>Sing. N.</i>	hunt-a	tung-e	ēag-e
<i>G.D.I.</i>	hunt-an	tung-an	ēag-an
<i>A.</i>	hunt-an	tung-an	ēag-e
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	hunt-an	tung-an	ēag-an
<i>G.</i>	hunt-ena	tung-ena	ēag-ena
<i>D.I.</i>	hunt-um	tung-um	ēag-um

65. VOCABULARY.

sē adesa, *hatchet, adze*.

sē āmetta, *leisure* [empt-iness].

sē bōna (**bana**), *murderer* [bane].
sēo cirice, *church* [Scotch kirk].
sē cnapa (later, **cnafa**), *boy* [knave].
sē cuma, *stranger* [comer].
ðæt ēare, *ear*.
sēo eorðe, *earth*.
sē gefēra, *companion* [co-farer].
sē guma, *man* [bride-groom ¹].
sēo heorte, *heart*.
sē mōna, *moon*.
sēo nādre, *adder* [a nadder > an adder ²].
sē oxa, *ox*.
sē scēowyrhta, *shoe-maker* [shoe-wright].
sēo sunne, *sun*.
sē tēona, *injury* [teen].
biddan (with dat. of person and gen. of thing ³), *to request, ask for*.
cwelan, *to die* [quail].
gescieppan, *to create* [shape, land-scape, friend-ship].
giefan (with dat. of indirect object), *to give*.
healdan, *to hold*.
helpan (with dat.), *to help*.
scēððan ⁴ (with dat.), *to injure* [scathe].
wiðstōndan (-standan) (with dat.), *to withstand*.
wrītan, *to write*.

66.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Sē scēowyrhta brȳcð his æmettan. 2. Ðā guman biddað ðām cnapan ðæs adesan. 3. Hwā is sē cuma? 4. Hielpst ðū ðām bōnan? 5. Ic him ne helpe. 6. Ðā bearn scēððað ðæs bōnan ēagum qnd ēarum. 7. Sē cuma cwielð on ðære cirican. 8. Sē hunta wiðstent ðām wulfum. 9. Ðā oxan berað ðæs cnapan gefēran. 10. Sē mōna qnd ðā tunglu sind on ðām heofonum. 11. Ðā huntan healdað ðære nādran tungan. 12. Hē here giefð ðā giefra. 13. Ðā werod scēððað ðæs cyninges feldum.

II. 1. Who will bind the mouths of the oxen? 2. Who gives him the gifts? 3. Thou art helping him, and I am injuring him. 4. The boy's companion is dying. 5. His nephew does not enjoy his leisure. 6. The adder's tongue injures the king's companion. 7. The sun is the day's eye. 8. She asks the strangers for the spears. 9. The men's bodies are not here. 10. Is he not (**Nis hē**) the child's murderer? 11. Who creates the bodies and the souls of men? 12. Thou withstandest her. 13. He is not writing.

1. The *r* is intrusive in *-groom*, as it is in *cart-r-idge*, *part-r-idge*, *vag-r-ant*, and *hoa-r-se*.

2. The *n* has been appropriated by the article. Cf. *an apron* (< *a napron*), *an auger* (< *a nauger*), *an orange* (< *a norange*), *an umpire* (< *a numpire*).

3. In Mn.E. we say "I request a favor of you"; but in O.E. it was "I request you (dative) of a favor" (genitive). Cf. *Cymbeline*, III, vi, 92: "We'll mannerly demand thee of thy story." See Franz's *Shakespeare-Grammatik*, § 361 (1900).

4. **Sceððan** is conjugated through the present indicative like **frēmman**. See § 129.



CHAPTER XII.

Remnants of Other Consonant Declensions.

67. The nouns belonging here are chiefly masculines and feminines. Their stem ended in a consonant other than **n**. The most important of them may be divided as follows: (1) The *foot* Declension, (2) **r**-Stems, and (3) **nd**-Stems. These declensions are all characterized by the prevalence, wherever possible, of **i**-umlaut in certain cases, the case ending being then dropped.

68. (1) The nouns belonging to the *foot* Declension exhibit umlaut most consistently in the N.A. plural.

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	<i>sē fōt</i> (<i>foot</i>)	<i>sē mōn</i> (<i>man</i>)	<i>sē tōð</i> (<i>tooth</i>)	<i>sēo cū</i> (<i>cow</i>)
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	<i>fēt</i>	<i>mēn</i>	<i>tēð</i>	<i>cȳ</i>

NOTE.—The dative singular usually has the same form as the N.A. plural. Here belong also **sēo bōc** (*book*), **sēo burg** (*borough*), **sēo gōs** (*goose*), **sēo lūs** (*louse*), and **sēo mūs** (*mouse*), all with umlauted plurals. Mn.E. preserves only six of the *foot* Declension plurals: *feet*, *men*, *teeth*, *geese*, *lice*, and *mice*. The *c* in the last two is an artificial spelling, intended to preserve the sound of voiceless *s*. Mn.E. *kine* (= *cy-en*) is a double plural formed after the analogy of weak stems; Burns in *The Twa Dogs* uses *kye*.

No umlaut is possible in **sēo niht** (*night*) and **sē mōnað** (*month*), plural **niht** and **mōnað** (preserved in Mn.E. *twelvemonth* and *fortnight*).

- (2) The **r**-Stems contain nouns expressing kinship, and exhibit umlaut of the dative singular.

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	<i>sē fæder</i>	<i>sē brōðor</i>	<i>sēo mōdor</i>	<i>sēo dohtor</i>	<i>sēo swuster</i>
	(<i>father</i>)	(<i>brother</i>)	(<i>mother</i>)	(<i>daughter</i>)	(<i>sister</i>)
<i>D.</i>	<i>fæder</i>	<i>brēðer</i>	<i>mēder</i>	<i>dēhter</i>	<i>swyster</i>

NOTE.—The N.A. plural is usually the same as the N.A. singular. These umlaut datives are all due to the presence of a former *i*. Cf. Lat. dative singular *patri*, *frātri*, *mātri*, *sorori* (< **sosori*), and Greek θυγατρί.

- (3) The **nd**-Stems show umlaut both in the N.A. plural and in the dative singular:

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	<i>sē frēond</i> (<i>friend</i>)	<i>sē fēond</i> (<i>enemy</i>)
<i>D.</i>	<i>frīend</i>	<i>fīend</i>
<i>Plur. N.A.</i>	<i>frīend</i>	<i>fīend</i>

NOTE.—Mn.E. *friend* and *fiend* are interesting analogical spellings. When *s* had been added by analogy to the O.E. plurals **frīend** and **fīend**, thus giving the double plurals *friends* and *fiends*, a second singular was formed by dropping the *s*. Thus *friend* and *fiend* displaced the old singulars *frend* and *fend*, both of which occur in the M.E. *Ormulum*, written about the year 1200.

Summary of O.E. Declensions.

69. A brief, working summary of the O.E. system of declensions may now be made on the basis of gender.

All O.E. nouns are (1) masculine, (2) feminine, or (3) neuter.

(1) The masculines follow the declension of **mūð** (§ 26), except those ending in **-a**, which are declined like **hunta** (§ 64):

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	mūð	<i>N.</i>	hunta
<i>G.</i>	mūðes	<i>G.D.A.</i>	huntan
<i>D.I.</i>	mūðe	<i>I.</i>	huntan
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	mūðas		huntan
<i>G.</i>	mūða		huntena
<i>D.I.</i>	mūðum		huntum

(2) The short-stemmed neuters follow the declension of **hof** (§ 32); the long-stemmed, that of **bearn** (§ 32):

<i>Sing. N.A.</i>	hof	bearn
<i>G.</i>	hofes	bearnes
<i>D.I.</i>	hofe	bearne
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	hofu	bearn
<i>G.</i>	hofa	bearna
<i>D.I.</i>	hofum	bearnum

(3) The feminines follow the declensions of **giefu** and **wund** (§ 38) (the only difference being in the N. singular), except those ending in **-e**, which follow the declension of **tunge** (§ 64):

<i>Sing. N.</i>	giefu	wund	tunge
<i>G.</i>	giefe	wunde	tungan
<i>D.I.</i>	giefe	wunde	tungan
<i>A.</i>	giefe	wunde	tungan
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	giefu	wunda	tungan
<i>G.</i>	giefu	wunda	tungena
<i>D.I.</i>	giefum	wundum	tungum

70.

VOCABULARY.

ac, *but*.

būtan (with dat.), *except, but, without*.

sē Crīst, *Christ*.

sē eorl, *earl, alderman, warrior*.

ðæt Eᅅglaᅇnd, *England* [Angles' land].

faran, *to go* [fare].

findan, *to find*.

sē God, *God*.

hātan, *to call, name.*

sē hlāford, *lord [hlāf-weard].*

mid (with dat.), *with.*

on (with acc.), *on, against, into.*

tō (with dat.), *to.*

uton (with infin.), *let us.*

NOTE.—O.E. **mōn** (**man**) is frequently used in an indefinite sense for *one, people, they*. It thus takes the place of a passive construction proper: **And man nam þā gebrotu þe þār belifon, twelf cýpan fulle**, *And there were taken up of fragments that remained there twelve baskets full*; but more literally, *And one (or they) took the fragments, etc.*; **Qnd Hæstenes wíf qnd hīs suna twēgen mōn brōhte tō ðāem cyninge**, *And Hæsten's wife and his two sons were brought to the king.*

71.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Mōn hine hæt Ælfred. 2. Uton faran on ðæt scip. 3. God is cyninga cyning qnd hlāforda hlāford. 4. Sē eorl ne giefð giefra his fīend. 5. Ic næs mid his frīend. 6. Sēo mōdor færð mid hiere dehter on ðā burg. 7. Fintst ðū ðæs bōceres bēc? 8. Hē bint ealle (all) ðā dēor būtan ðāem wulfum. 9. Ðū eart Crīst, Godes sunu. 10. “Uton bindan ðæs bōnan fēt,” cwið hē.

II. 1. Christ is the son of God. 2. Let us call him Cædmon. 3. He throws his spear against the door. 4. Thou art not the earl's brother. 5. He will go with his father to England, but I shall remain (abide) here. 6. Gifts are not given to murderers. 7. Who will find the tracks of the animals? 8. They ask their lord for his weapons (§ 65, Note 3).



CHAPTER XIII.

PRONOUNS.

(1) Personal Pronouns.

72. Paradigms of **ic**, *I*; **ðū**, *thou*. For **hē**, **hēo**, **hit**, see § 53.

<i>Sing. N.</i>	ic	ðū
<i>G.</i>	mīn	ðīn
<i>D.</i>	mē	ðē
<i>A.</i>	mē (mec)	ðē (ðec)
<i>Dual N.</i>	wit (<i>we two</i>)	git (<i>ye two</i>)
<i>G.</i>	uncer (<i>of us two</i>)	incer (<i>of you two</i>)
<i>D.</i>	unc (<i>to or for us two</i>)	inc (<i>to or for you two</i>)
<i>A.</i>	unc (<i>us two</i>)	inc (<i>you two</i>)
<i>Plur N.</i>	wē	gē
<i>G.</i>	ūser (ūre)	ēower
<i>D.</i>	ūs	ēow
<i>A.</i>	ūs (ūsic)	ēow (ēowic)

NOTE 1.—The dual number was soon absorbed by the plural. No relic of it now remains. But when two and only two are referred to, the dual is consistently used in O.E. An example occurs in the case of the two blind men (*Matthew ix. 27-31*): **Gemiltsa unc, Davīdes sunu!** *Pity us, (thou) Son of David!* **Sie inc æfter incrum gelēafan,** *Be it unto you according to your faith.*

NOTE 2.—Mn.E. *ye* (< **gē**), the nominative proper, is fast being displaced by *you* (< **ēow**), the old objective. The distinction is preserved in the King James's version of the Bible: *Ye in me, and I in you* (*John xiv. 20*); but not in Shakespeare and later writers.

(2) Demonstrative Pronouns.

73. Paradigm of **ðēs, ðēos, ðis, this**. For the Definite Article as a demonstrative, meaning *that*, see § 28, Note 3.

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Feminine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
<i>Sing. N.</i>	ðēs	ðēos	ðis
<i>G.</i>	ðisses	ðisse	ðisses
<i>D.</i>	ðissum	ðisse	ðissum
<i>A.</i>	ðisne	ðās	ðis
<i>I.</i>	ðȳs	—	ðȳs
	<i>All Genders.</i>		
<i>Plur. N.A.</i>	ðās		
<i>G.</i>	ðissa		
<i>D.</i>	ðissum		

(3) The Interrogative Pronoun.

74. Paradigm of **hwā, hwæt, who, what?**

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
Sing. N.	hwā	hwæt
G.	hwæs	hwæs
D.	hwæm	hwæm
A.	hwone	hwæt
I.	—	hwȳ

NOTE 1.—The derivative interrogatives, **hwæðer** (< *hwā-ðer), *which of two?* and **hwilc** (< *hwā-lic), *which?* are declined as strong adjectives (§§ 79-82).

NOTE 2.—The instrumental case of **hwā** survives in Mn.E. *why* = *on what account*; the instrumental of the definite article is seen in the adverbial *the*: *The sooner, the better* = *by how much sooner, by so much better*.

NOTE 3.—How were the Mn.E. relative pronouns, *who* and *which*, evolved from the O.E. interrogatives? The change began in early West Saxon with **hwæt** used in indirect questions (Wūlfing, *l.c.* § 310, β): **Nū ic wāt eall hwæt ðū woldest**, *Now I know all that thou desiredst*. The direct question was, **Hwæt woldest ðū?** But the presence of **eall** shows that in Alfred's mind **hwæt** was, in the indirect form, more relative than interrogative.

(4) Relative Pronouns.

75. O.E. had no relative pronoun proper. It used instead (1) the Indeclinable Particle **ðe**, *who, whom, which, that*, (2) the Definite Article (§ 28), (3) the Definite Article with the Indeclinable Particle, (4) the Indeclinable Particle with a Personal Pronoun.

The Definite Article agrees in gender and number with the antecedent. The case depends upon the construction. *The bird which I have* may, therefore, be:—

- (1) **Sē fugol ðe ic hæbbe;**
- (2) **Sē fugol ðone ic hæbbe;**
- (3) **Sē fugol ðone ðe (= the which) ic hæbbe;**
- (4) **Sē fugol ðe hine ic hæbbe.**

NOTE.—O.E. **ðe** agrees closely in construction with Mn.E. relative *that*: (1) Both are indeclinable. (2) Both refer to animate or inanimate objects. (3) Both may be used with phrasal value: **ðȳ ylcan dæge ðe hī hine tō ðæm āde beran wyllað**, *On the same day that (= on which) they intend to bear him to the funeral pile*. (4) Neither can be preceded by a preposition.

(5) Possessive Pronouns.

76. The Possessive Pronouns are **mīn**, *mine*; **ðīn**, *thine*; **ūre**, *our*; **ēower**, *your*; [**sīn**, *his, her, its*]; **uncer**, *belonging to us two*; **incer**, *belonging to you two*. They are declined as strong adjectives. The genitives of the Third Personal Pronoun, **his**, *his*, **hiere**, *her*, **hiera**, *their*, are indeclinable.

(6) Indefinite Pronouns.

77. These are **ælc**, *each, every*; **ān**, *a, an, one*; **ænig** (< **ān-ig**), *any*; **nænig** (< **ne-ænig**), *none*; **ōðer**, *other*; **sum**, *one, a certain one*; **swilc**, *such*. They are declined as strong adjectives.

NOTE.—O.E. had three established methods of converting an interrogative pronoun into an indefinite: (1) By prefixing **ge**, (2) by prefixing **æg**, (3) by interposing the interrogative between **swā ... swā**: (1) **gehwā**, *each*; **gehwæðer**, *either*; **gehwilc**, *each*; (2) **æghwā**, *each*; **æghwæðer**, *each*; **æghwilc**, *each*; (3) **swā hwā swā**, *whosoever*; **swā hwæðer swā**, *whichever of two*; **swā hwilc swā**, *whosoever*.



CHAPTER XIV.

ADJECTIVES, STRONG AND WEAK.

78. The declension of adjectives conforms in general to the declension of nouns, though a few pronominal inflections have influenced certain cases. Adjectives belong either to (1) the Strong Declension or to (2) the Weak Declension. The Weak Declension is employed when the adjective is preceded by **sē** or **ðēs**, *the, that, or this*; otherwise, the Strong Declension is employed: **ðā gōdan cyningas**, *the good kings*; **ðēs gōda cyning**, *this good king*; but **gōde cyningas**, *good kings*.

NOTE.—The Weak Declension is also frequently used when the adjective is employed in direct address, or preceded by a possessive pronoun: **Dryhten, ælmihtiga God ... ic bidde ðē for ðīnre miclan mildheortnesse**, *Lord, almighty God, I pray thee, for thy great mercy*.

(1) Strong Declension of Adjectives.

(a) Monosyllables.

79. The strong adjectives are chiefly monosyllabic with long stems: **gōd**, *good*; **eald**, *old*; **lōng**, *long*; **swift**, *swift*. They are declined as follows.

80. Paradigm of **gōd**, *good*:

	Masculine.	Feminine.	Neuter.
Sing. N.	gōd	gōd	gōd
G.	gōdes	gōdre	gōdes
D.	gōdum	gōdre	gōdum
A.	gōdne	gōde	gōd
I.	gōde	—	gōde
Plur N.A.	gōde	gōda	gōd
G.	gōdra	gōdra	gōdra
D.I.	gōdum	gōdum	gōdum

81. If the stem is short, **-u** is retained as in **giefu** (§ 39, (1)) and **hofu** (§ 33, (1)). Thus **glæd** (§ 27, Note 1), *glad*, and **til**, *useful*, are inflected:

	Masculine.	Feminine.	Neuter.
Sing. N.	{ glæd til	{ gladu tilu	{ glæd til
Plur N.A.	{ glade tile	{ glada tila	{ gladu tilu

(b) Polysyllables.

82. Polysyllables follow the declension of short monosyllables. The most common terminations are **-en**, *-en*; **-fæst**, *-fast*; **-full**, *-ful*; **-lēas**, *-less*; **-līc**, *-ly*; **-ig**, *-y*: **hæð-en** (**hæð** = *heath*), *heathen*; **stēde-fæst** (**stēde** = *place*), *steadfast*; **sorg-full** (**sorg** = *sorrow*), *sorrowful*; **cyst-lēas** (**cyst** = *worth*), *worthless*; **eorð-līc** (**eorðe** = *earth*), *earthly*; **blōd-ig** (**blōd** = *blood*), *bloody*. The present and past participles, when inflected and not as weak adjectives, may be classed with the polysyllabic adjectives, their inflection being the same.

Syncopation occurs as in **a**-stems (§ 27, (4)). Thus **hālig**, *holy*, **blīðe**, *blithe*, **berende**, *bearing*, **geboren**, *born*, are thus inflected:

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Feminine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
<i>Sing. N.</i>	hālig	hālgū	hālig
	blīðe	blīðu	blīðe
	berende	berende	berende
	geboren	geborenu	geboren
<i>Plur N.A.</i>	hālge	hālga	hālgū
	blīðe	blīða	blīðu
	berende	berenda	berendu
	geborene	geborena	geborenu

(2) Weak Declension of Adjectives.

83. The Weak Declension of adjectives, whether monosyllabic or polysyllabic, does not differ from the Weak Declension of nouns, except that **-ena** of the genitive plural is usually replaced by **-ra** of the strong adjectives.

	<i>Masculine.</i>	<i>Feminine.</i>	<i>Neuter.</i>
84. <i>Sing. N.</i>	gōda	gōde	gōde
<i>G.</i>	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan
<i>D.I.</i>	gōdan	gōdan	gōdan
<i>A.</i>	gōdan	gōdan	gōde
	<i>All Genders.</i>		
<i>Plur. N.A.</i>	gōdan		
<i>G.</i>	gōdra (gōdena)		
<i>D.I.</i>	gōdum		

85. RULE OF SYNTAX.

Adjectives agree with their nouns in gender, number, and case; but participles, when used predicatively, may remain uninflected (§ 139, § 140).

86. VOCABULARY.

dēad, *dead*.

eall, *all*.

hāl, ¹ *whole, hale*.

heard, *hard*.

ðæt hors, *horse*.
lēof, *dear* [as *lief*].
lȳtel, *little*.
micel, *great, large*.
mōnig, *many*.
niman, *to take* [nimble, numb].
nīwe, *new*.
rīce, *rich, powerful*.
sōð, *true* [sooth-sayer].
stælwierðe, ² *serviceable* [stalwart].
swīðe, *very*.
sē tūn, *town, village*.
sē ðegn, *servant, thane, warrior*.
ðæt ðing, *thing*.
sē weg, *way*.
wīs, *wise*.
wið (with acc.), *against*, in a hostile sense [with-stand].
sē ilca, *the same* [of that ilk].

87.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Ðās scipu ne sind swīðe swift, ac hīe sind swīðe stælwierðu. 2. Sēo gōde cwēn giefð ælcum ðegne mōniga giefra. 3. Ðēs wīsa cyning hæfð mōnige mīcele tūnas on his rīce. 4. Nænig mōn is wīs on eallum ðingum. 5. Ðȳ ilcan dæge (§ 98, (2)) mōn fōnd (found) ðone ðegn ðe mīnes wines bēc hæfde. 6. Ealle ðā sēcgas ðā ðe swift hors habbað rīdað wið ðone bōnan. 7. Ðīne fīend sind mīne frīend. 8. Sē micela stān ðone ðe ic on mīnum hōndum hæbbe is swīðe heard. 9. Hīe scēððað ðām ealdum horsum. 10. Uton niman ðās tilan giefra qnd hīe beran tō ūrum lēofum bearnum.

II. 1. These holy men are wise and good. 2. Are the little children very dear to the servants (dat. without **tō**)? 3. Gifts are not given (§ 70, Note 1) to rich men. 4. All the horses that are in the king's fields are swift. 5. These stones are very large and hard. 6. He takes the dead man's spear and fights against the large army. 7. This new house has many doors. 8. My ways are not your

ways. 9. Whosoever chooses me, him I also (**ēac**) choose. 10. Every man has many friends that are not wise.

1. **Hālig**, *holy*, contains, of course, the same root. “I find,” says Carlyle, “that you could not get any better definition of what ‘holy’ really is than ‘healthy—completely healthy.’”

2. This word has been much discussed. The older etymologists explained it as meaning *worth stealing*. A more improbable conjecture is that it means *worth a stall* or *place*. It is used of ships in the *Anglo-Saxon Chronicle*. As applied to men, Skeat thinks it meant *good* or *worthy at stealing*; but the etymology is still unsettled.



CHAPTER XV.

NUMERALS.

88. Numerals are either (*a*) Cardinal, expressing pure number, *one, two, three*; or (*b*) Ordinal, expressing rank or succession, *first, second, third*.

(*a*) Cardinals.

89. The Cardinals fall into the three following syntactic groups:

GROUP I.

1. **ān**
2. **twēgen** [twain]
3. **ðrīe**

These numerals are inflected adjectives. **Ān**, *one, an, a*, being a long stemmed monosyllable, is declined like **gōd** (§ 80). The weak form, **āna**, means *alone*.

Twēgen and **ðrīe**, which have no singular, are thus declined:

	Masc.	Fem.	Neut.	Masc.	Fem.	Neut.
Plur. N.A.	twēgen	twā	twā (tū)	ðrīe	ðrēo	ðrēo
G.	twēgra	twēgra	twēgra	ðrēora	ðrēora	ðrēora
D.	twæm	twæm	twæm	ðrīm	ðrīm	ðrīm
	(twām)	(twām)	(twām)			

90.

GROUP II.

4. fēower
5. fīf
6. siex
7. seofon
8. eahta
9. nigon
10. tīen
11. ęndlefan
12. twelf
13. ðrēotīene
14. fēowertīene
15. fīftīene
16. siextīene
17. seofontīene
18. eahtatīene
19. nigontīene

These words are used chiefly as uninflected adjectives: **on gewitscipe ðrēora oþþe fēower bisceopa**, *on testimony of three or four bishops*; **on siex dagum**, *in six days*; **ān nādre ðe hæfde nigon hēafdu**, *a serpent which had nine heads*; **æðeling eahtatīene wintra**, *a prince of eighteen winters*.

91.

GROUP III.

20. twēntig
21. ān ęnd twēntig
30. ðrītig
40. fēowertig
50. fīftig
60. siextig
70. hundseofontig
80. hundeahtatig
90. hundnigontig
100. hund

200. twā hund
1000. ðūsēnd
2000. twā ðūsēnd

All these numbers are employed as neuter singular nouns, and are followed by the genitive plural: **Næfde hē þēah mā ðonne twēntig hrȳðera, and twēntig scēapa, and twēntig swȳna**, *He did not have, however, more than twenty (of) cattle, and twenty (of) sheep, and twenty (of) swine*; **Hīe hæfdon hundeahtatig scipa**, *They had eighty ships*; **twā hund mīla brād**, *two hundred miles broad*; **ðær wæron seofon hund gūðfanena genumen**, *there were seven hundred standards captured*; **ān ðūsēnd mōnna**, *a thousand men*; **Hannibales folces wæs twā ðūsēnd ofslagen**, *Of Hannibal's men there were two thousand slain*; **Hīe ācuron endlefan ðūsēnd mōnna**, *They chose eleven thousand men*.

NOTE 1.—Group III is rarely inflected. Almost the only inflectional endings that are added are (1) **-es**, a genitive singular termination for the numerals in **-tig**, and (2) **-e**, a dative singular for **hund**. (1) The first is confined to adjectives expressing extent of space or time, as, **eald**, *old*; **brād**, *broad*; **hēah**, *high*; and **lōng**, *long*: **ðæt is ðrītiges mīla lōng**, *that is thirty miles long*; **Hē wæs ðrītiges gēara eald**, *He was thirty years old*. (2) The second is employed after **mid**: **mid twām hunde scipa**, *with two hundred ships*; **mid ðrīm hunde mōnna**, *with three hundred men*; **Ðær wearð ... Regulus gefangen mid V hunde mōnna**, *There was Regulus captured with five hundred men*.

The statement made in nearly all the grammars that **hund** occurs as a nominative and accusative plural is without foundation.

NOTE 2.—Many numerals, otherwise indeclinable, are used in the genitive plural with the indefinite pronoun **sum**, which then means *one of* a certain number. In this peculiar construction, the numeral always precedes **sum**: **fēowera sum**, *one of four* (= *with three others*); **Hē sǣde þæt hē syxa sum ofslōge syxtig**, *He said that he, with five others, slew sixty (whales)*; **Hē wæs fēowertigra sum**, *He was one of forty*.

NOTE 3.—These are the most common constructions with the Cardinals. The forms in **-tig** have only recently been investigated. A study of Wūlfing's citations shows that Alfred occasionally uses the forms in **-tig** (1) as adjectives with plural inflections: **mid XXXgum cyningum**, *with thirty kings*; and (2) as nouns with plural inflections: **æfter siextigum daga**, *after sixty days*. But both constructions are rare.

(b) Ordinals.

92. The Ordinals, except the first two, are formed from the Cardinals. They are:

1. forma, āresta, fyrsta
2. oðer, æfterra
3. ðridda
4. fēorða
5. fifta
6. siexta
7. seoforða
8. eahtoða
9. nigoða
10. tēoða
11. endlefta
12. twelfta
13. ðrēotēoða
14. fēowertēoða
15. fiftēoða
etc.
20. twēntigoða
21. ān qnd twēntigoða
30. ðrītigoða
etc.

NOTE.—There are no Ordinals corresponding to **hund** and **ðūsend**.

With the exception of **oðer** (§ 77), all the Ordinals are declined as Weak Adjectives; the article, however, as in Mn.E., is frequently omitted: **Brūtus wæs sē forma consul**, *Brutus was the first consul*; **Hēr endað sēo āreste bōc, qnd onginneð sēo oðer**, *Here the first book ends, and the second begins*; **ðy fiftan dæge**, *on the fifth day*; **on ðæm tēoðan gēare hiera gewinnes**, *in the tenth year of their strife*; **Hēo wæs twelfte**, *She was twelfth*; **Sē wæs fēorða frōm Augusto**, *He was fourth from Augustus*.



CHAPTER XVI.

ADVERBS, PREPOSITIONS, AND CONJUNCTIONS.

Adverbs.

93. (1) Adverbs are formed by adding **-e** or **-lice** to the corresponding adjectives: **sōð**, *true*; **sōðe** or **sōðlice**, *truly*; **earmlīc**, *wretched*; **earmlīce**, *wretchedly*; **wīd**, *wide*; **wīde**, *widely*; **micel**, *great*; **micle** (**micele**), *greatly, much*.

(2) The terminations **-e** and **-lice** are replaced in some adverbs by **-(l)unga** or **-(l)inga**: **eallunga**, *entirely*; **fāringa**, *suddenly*; **grundlunga**, *from the ground, completely*.

NOTE 1.—In Mn.E. *headlong*, *darkling*, and *groveling*, originally adverbs, we have survivals of these endings.

(3) The genitive case is frequently used adverbially: **sūðewearðes**, *southwards*; **ealles**, *altogether, entirely*; **dæg**, *by day*; **nihtes**, *by night*; **ðæs**, *from that time, afterwards*. Cf. **hys** (= **his**) **weges** in **Ðonne rīdeð ælc hys weg**, *Then rides each his way*.

NOTE 2.—The adverbial genitive is abundantly preserved in Mn.E. *Always*, *crossways*, *sideways*, *needs* (= *necessarily*), *sometimes*, etc., are not plurals, but old genitive singulars. The same construction is seen in *of course*, *of a truth*, *of an evening*, *of old*, *of late*, and similar phrases.

(4) Dative and instrumental plurals may be used as adverbs: **hwīlum**, *at times, sometimes* [whilom]; **stundum** (**stund** = *period*), *from time to time*; **miclum**, *greatly*. Especially common is the suffix **-mælum** (**mæ** = *time, measure* [meal]), preserved adverbially in Mn.E. *piecemeal*: **dropmælum**, *drop by drop*; **styccemælum** (**stycce** = *piece*), *piecemeal, here and there*.

(5) The suffix **-an** usually denotes motion from:

hēr , <i>here</i> .	hider , <i>hither</i> .	heonan , <i>hence</i> .
ðær , <i>there</i> .	ðider , <i>thither</i> .	ðonan , <i>thence</i> .
hwær , <i>where?</i>	hwider , <i>whither?</i>	hwonan , <i>whence?</i>
		norðan , <i>from the north</i> .
		ēastan , <i>from the east</i> .
		hindan , <i>from behind</i> .
		feorran , <i>from far</i> .
		ūtan , <i>from without</i> .

(6) The adverb **rihte** (**riht** = *right, straight*) denotes *motion toward* in **norðrihte**, *northward, due north*; **ēastrihte**, *due east*; **sūðrihte**, *due south*; **westrihte**, *due west*.

Prepositions.

94. The nominative is the only case in O.E. that is never governed by a preposition. Of the other cases, the dative and accusative occur most frequently with prepositions.

(1) The prepositions that are most frequently found with the dative are:

æfter, *after*.

æt, *at*.

be (bī), *by, near, about*.

betwēonan (betuh), *between*.

būtan (būton), *except*.

for, *for*.

frōm (fram), *from, by*.

mid, *with*.

of, *of, from*.

tō, *to*.

tōforan, *before*.

tōweard, *toward*.

(2) The following prepositions require the accusative:

geond, *throughout* [be-yond].

ofer, *over, upon*.

oð, *until, up to*.

ðurh, *through*.

ymbe, *about, around* [um-while, ember-days].

(3) The preposition **on** (rarely **in**), meaning *into*, is usually followed by the accusative; but meaning *in, on, or during*, it takes the dative or instrumental. The preposition **wið**, meaning *toward*, may be followed by the genitive, dative, or accusative; but meaning *against*, and implying *motion* or *hostility*, the accusative is more common.

(4) The following phrases are used prepositionally with the dative:

be norðan, *north of*.

be ēastan, *east of*.

be sūðan, *south of*.

be westan, *west of*.

tō ēacan, *in addition to*.

on emnlange (efn-lang = evenly long), *along*.

tō emnes, *along*.

(5) Prepositions regularly precede the noun or pronoun that they introduce; but by their adverbial nature they are sometimes drawn in front of the verb: **And him wæs mycel męnegu tō gegaderod**, *And there was gathered unto him a great multitude*. In relative clauses introduced by **ðe**, the preceding position is very common: **sēo scīr ... ðe hē on būde**, *the district, ... which he dwelt in (= which he in-habited)*; **Hē wæs swyðe spēdig man on ðām āhtum ðe hiera spēda on bēoð**, *He was a very rich man in those possessions which their riches consist in*; **nȳhst ðām tūne ðe sē dēada man on līð**, *nearest the town that the dead man lies in*.

Conjunctions.

95. (1) The most frequently occurring conjunctions are:

ac, *but*.
 ær, *before, ere*.
 būtan (būton), *except that, unless*.
 ēac, *also [eke]*.
 for ðām,
 for ðām ðe,
 for ðon,
 for ðon ðe,
 for ðȳ, *therefore*.
 gif, *if*.
 hwæðer, *whether*.
 ʀnd (and), *and*.
 oððe, *or*.
 ðæt, *that, so that*.
 ðēah, *though, however*.

} *because*.

(2) The correlative conjunctions are:

ægðer ge ge,	both and.
ægðer oððer	} either or.
oððe oððe	
nē nē,	neither nor.
sam sam,	whether or.
swā swā	{ the the. as as.
ðā ðā	
ðonne ðonne	} when then.



CHAPTER XVII.

COMPARISON OF ADJECTIVES AND ADVERBS.

Adjectives.

96. (1) Adjectives are regularly compared by adding **-ra** for the comparative, and **-ost** (rarely **-est**) for the superlative:

<i>Positive.</i>	<i>Comparative.</i>	<i>Superlative.</i>
earm , <i>poor</i>	earmra	earmost
rīce , <i>rich</i>	rīcra	rīcost
smæl , <i>narrow</i>	smælra	smalost
brād , <i>broad</i>	brādra (brædra)	brādost
swift , <i>swift</i>	swiftra	swiftost

(2) Forms with **i**-umlaut usually have superlative in **-est**:

<i>Positive.</i>	<i>Comparative.</i>	<i>Superlative.</i>
eald , <i>old</i>	ieldra	ieldest
lōng , <i>long</i>	lēngra	lēngest
strōng , <i>strong</i>	strengra	strengest
geong , <i>young</i>	giengra	giengest
hēah , <i>high</i>	hīerra	hīehst

(3) The following adjectives are compared irregularly:

<i>Positive.</i>	<i>Comparative.</i>	<i>Superlative.</i>
gōd , <i>good</i>	bētra	bētst
lȳtel , <i>little, small</i>	læssa	læst
micel , <i>great, much</i>	māra	mæst
yfel , <i>bad</i>	wiersa	wierst

(4) The positive is sometimes supplied by an adverb:

<i>Positive.</i>	<i>Comparative.</i>	<i>Superlative.</i>
feor , <i>far</i>	fierra	fierrest
nēah , <i>near</i>	nēarra	nīehst
ǣr , <i>before</i>	ǣrra , <i>former</i>	ǣrest , <i>first</i>

(5) The comparatives all follow the Weak Declension. The superlatives, when preceded by the definite article, are weak; but when used predicatively they are frequently strong: **sē lāesta dæl**, *the least part*; **Donne cymeð sē man sē ðæt swiftoste hors hafað tō ðæm ærestan dæle and tō ðæm mæstan**, *Then comes the man that has the swiftest horse to the first part and to the largest*. But, **ðæt bȳne land is ēasteweard brādost** (not **brādoste**), *the cultivated land is broadest eastward*; and (hit) **bið ealra wyrta mæst**, *and it is largest of all herbs*; **Ac hyra (= hiera) ār is mæst on ðæm gafole ðe ðā Finnas him gylðað**, *But their income is greatest in the tribute that the Fins pay them*.

(6) The comparative is usually followed by **ðonne** and the nominative case: **Sē hwæl bið micle lāessa ðonne oðre hwalas**, *That whale is much smaller than other whales*; **Ðā wunda ðæs mōdes bēoð dīgelran ðonne ðā wunda ðæs lichaman**. *The wounds of the mind are more secret than the wounds of the body*.

But when **ðonne** is omitted, the comparative is followed by the dative: **Ūre Ālīesend, ðe māra is ƿnd mærra eallum gesceaftum**, *Our Redeemer, who is greater and more glorious than all created things*; **nē ongeat hē nō hiene selfne beþran oðrum gōdum mōnnum**, *nor did he consider himself better than other good men*.

Adverbs.

97. (1) Adverbs are regularly compared by adding **-or** for the comparative and **-ost** (rarely **-est**) for the superlative:

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
georne , willingly	geornor	geornost
swīðe , very, severely	swīðor , more	swīðost , most, chiefly
æ̅r , before	æ̅ror , formerly	æ̅rest , first
norð , northwards	norðor	norðmest ¹

(2) The comparatives of a few adverbs may be found by dropping **-ra** of the corresponding adjective form:

Positive.	Comparative.	Superlative.
lōnge , long	lēng	lēngest

micle, much mā
wel, well bæt

māest
bætst

Expressions of Time.

98. (1) Duration of time and extent of space are usually expressed by the accusative case: **Ealle ðā hwīle ðe ðæt līc bið inne**, *All the time that the body is within*; **twēgen dagas**, *for two days*; **ealne weg**, *all the way, always*.

(2) Time when is more often expressed by the instrumental case when no preposition is used: **ðy ilcan dæge**, *the same day*; **ælc gēare**, *each year*; **ðy gēare**, *that year*; **ælc dæge**, *each day*.

(3) Time or space within which is expressed by **on** and the dative: **on sumera**, *in summer*; **on wintra**, *in winter*; **on fīf dagum**, *in five days*; **on fīf mīlum**, *in five miles*; **on ðissum gēare**, *in this year*; **on ðām tīman**, *in those times*. Sometimes by the genitive without a preceding preposition: **ðæs gēares**, *in that year*.

99.

VOCABULARY.

ðæt gefylce [folc], *troop, division*.

ðæt lōnd (land), *land*.

sēo mīl, *mile*.

ōðer ... oðer, *the one ... the other; the former ... the latter*.

sē sige, *victory*.

sige² habban, *to win (the) victory*.

sprecan, *to speak*.

ðæt swīn (swyn), *swine, hog*.

wēste, *waste*.

100.

EXERCISES.

I. 1. Hē hæfð ðrēo swīðe swift hors. 2. Ic hæbbe nigontiene scēap qnd mā ðonne twēntig swīna. 3. Sēo gōde cwēn cīest twā hund mōnna. 4. Uton feohtan wið ðā Dene mid ðrīm hunde scipa. 5. Qnd hīe wāron on twām gefylcum: on oðrum wæs³ Bāchsecg qnd Halfdene ðā hāðnan cyningas, qnd on oðrum wāron ðā eorlas. 6. Ðū spricst sōðlice. 7. Ðonne rīt ælc mōn

his weges. 8. Æfter mōnigum dagum, hæfde Ælfred cyning ⁴ sige. 9. Dis lōnd is wēste styccemǣlum. 10. Ðēs feld is fiftiges mīla brād. 11. Ælfred cyning hæfde mōnige frīend, for ðāem ðe hē wæs ægðer ge wīs ge gōd. 12. Ðā hwalas, ðe ðū ymbe spricst, sind micle læssan oðrum hwalum. 13. Hēo is ieldre ðonne hiere swuster, ac mīn brōðor is ieldra ðonne hēo. 14. Wē cumað tō ðāem tūne ælce gēare. 15. Ðā men ðe ðā swiftostan hors hæfdon wāron mid ðāem Denum fēower dagas.

II. 1. Our army (**werod**) was in two divisions: one was large, the other was small. 2. The richest men in the kingdom have more (**mā**) than thirty ships. 3. He was much wiser than his brother. 4. He fights against the Northumbrians with two ships. 5. After three years King Alfred gained the victory. 6. Whosoever chooses these gifts, chooses well. 7. This man's son is both wiser and better than his father. 8. When the king rides, then ride his thanes also. 9. The richest men are not always (**ā**) the wisest men.

1. This is really a double superlative, **m** being itself an old superlative suffix. Cf. Latin *opti-m-us*. In Mn.E. *northmost* and *hindmost*, *-m-est* has been confused with *-most*, with which etymologically it has nothing to do.

2. **Sige** usually, but not invariably, precedes **habban**.

3. See p. 100, [note on gefeaht](#).

4. The proper noun comes first in appositive expressions: **Ælfred cyning**, **Sidroc eorl**, **Hēahmund bisceop**.



CHAPTER XVIII.

STRONG VERBS: CLASS I. (See § 17.)

Syntax of Moods.

101. Of the three hundred simple verbs belonging to the O.E. Strong Conjugation, it is estimated ¹ that seventy-eight have preserved their strong inflections in Mn.E., that eighty-eight have become weak, and that the remaining one hundred and thirty-four have entirely disappeared, their places being taken in most cases by verbs of Latin origin introduced through the Norman-French.

NOTE.—Only the simple or primitive verbs, not the compound forms, are here taken into consideration. The proportionate loss, therefore, is really much greater. O.E. abounded in formative prefixes. “Thus from the Anglo-Saxon **flōwan**, *to flow*, ten new compounds were formed by the addition of various prefixes, of which ten, only one, **oferflōwan**, *to overflow*, survives with us. In a similar manner, from the verb **sittan**, *to sit*, thirteen new verbs were formed, of which not a single one is to be found to-day.” Lounsbury, *ib.* Part I, p. 107.

102. Class I: The “Drive” Conjugation.

Vowel Succession: **ī, ā, i, i.**

INFINITIVE.	PRETERIT SING.	PRETERIT PLUR.	PAST PART.
Drīf-an	drāf	drif-on	gedrif-en , <i>to drive</i> .
Indicative.		Subjunctive.	
PRESENT.		PRESENT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic drīf-e	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } drīf-e
2.	ðū drīf-st (drīf-est)	2.	ðū } drīf-e
3.	hē drīf-ð (drīf-eð)	3.	hē } drīf-e
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } (drīf-að)	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } drīf-en
2.	gē } (drīf-að)	2.	gē } drīf-en
3.	hīe } (drīf-að)	3.	hīe } drīf-en
PRETERIT.		PRETERIT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic drāf	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } drif-e
2.	ðū drif-e	2.	ðū } drif-e
3.	hē drāf	3.	hē } drif-e
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } drif-on	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } drif-en
2.	gē } drif-on	2.	gē } drif-en
3.	hīe } drif-on	3.	hīe } drif-en
Imperative.	Infinitive.	Present Participle.	
<i>Sing.</i> 2.	drīf	drīf-an	drīf-ende
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	drīf-an	Past Participle.	
2.	drīf-að		
	Gerund.		
	tō drīf-anne (-enne)	gedrif-en	

Tense Formation of Strong Verbs.

103. (1) It will be seen from the conjugation of **drīfan** that the *present stem* in all strong verbs is used throughout the present indicative, the present subjunctive, the imperative, the infinitive, the gerund, and the present participle. More than half of the endings, therefore, of the Strong Conjugation are added directly to the present stem.

(2) That the *preterit singular stem* is used in only two forms of the verb, the 1st and 3d persons singular of the preterit indicative: **Ic drāf, hē drāf.**

(3) That the *preterit plural stem* is used in the preterit plural indicative, in the second person of the preterit singular indicative, and in the singular and plural of the preterit subjunctive.

(4) That the *stem of the past participle* (**gedrif-**) is used for no other form.

Syntax of the Verb.

104. The Indicative Mood ² represents the predicate *as a reality*. It is used both in independent and in dependent clauses, its function in O.E. corresponding with its function in Mn.E.

105. The Subjunctive Mood represents the predicate *as an idea*. ³ It is of far more frequent occurrence in O.E. than in Mn.E.

1. When used in independent clauses it denotes desire, command, or entreaty, and usually precedes its subject: **Sīe ðīn nama gehālgod,** *Hallowed be Thy name; Ne swerigen gē,* *Do not swear.*

2. In dependent clauses it denotes uncertainty, possibility, or mere futurity. ⁴
(a) Concessive clauses (introduced by **ðēah,** *though*) and (b) temporal clauses (introduced by **āer, āer ðāem ðe,** *before*) are rarely found with any other mood than the subjunctive. The subjunctive is also regularly used in Alfredian prose (c) after verbs of saying, even when no suggestion of doubt or discredit attaches to the narration. ⁵ “Whether the statement refer to a fact or not, whether the subject-matter be vouched for by the reporter, as regards its objective reality and truth, the subjunctive does not tell. It simply

represents a statement as reported” ⁶: **ðēah man āsette twēgen fāetels full ealað oððe wāteres**, *though one set two vessels full of ale or water*; **ær ðāem ðe hit eall forhergod wāre**, *before it was all ravaged*; **Hē sāde ðæt Norðmanna land wāre swyðe lang and swyðe smæl**, *He said that the Norwegians’ land was very long and very narrow*.

106. The Imperative is the mood of command or intercession: **Iōhannes, cum tō mē**, *John, come to me*; **And forgyf ūs ūre gyltas**, *And forgive us our trespasses*; **Ne drīf ūs fram ðē**, *Do not drive us from thee*.

107. (1) The Infinitive and Participles are used chiefly in verb-phrases (§§ **138-141**); but apart from this function, the Infinitive, being a neuter noun, may serve as the subject or direct object of a verb. **Hātan** (*to command, bid*), **lātan** (*to let, permit*), and **onginnan** (*to begin*) are regularly followed by the Infinitive: **Hine rīdan lyste**, *To ride pleased him*; **Hēt ðā bāre settan**, *He bade set down the bier*; ⁷ **Lātað ðā lýtlingas tō mē cuman**, *Let the little ones come to me*; **ðā ongann hē spreca**, *then began he to speak*.

(2) The Participles may be used independently in the dative absolute construction (an imitation of the Latin ablative absolute), usually for the expression of time: ⁸ **Him ðā gýt sprecendum**, *While he was yet speaking*; **gefylledum dagum**, *the days having been fulfilled*.

108. The Gerund, or Gerundial Infinitive, is used:

(1) To express purpose: **Ūt ēode sē sāwere his sād tō sāwenne**, *Out went the sower his seed to sow*.

(2) To expand or determine the meaning of a noun or adjective: **Sýmōn, ic hābbe ðē tō secgenne sum ðing**, *Simon, I have something to say to thee*; **Hit is scōndlic ymb swelc tō spreca**, *It is shameful to speak about such things*.

(3) After **bēon** (*wesan*) to denote duty or necessity: **Hwæt is nū mā ymbe ðis tō spreca**, *What more is there now to say about this?* **ðonne is tō geðencenne hwaet Crīst self cwæð**, *then it behooves to bethink what Christ himself said*.

NOTE.—The Gerund is simply the dative case of the Infinitive after **tō**. It began very early to supplant the simple Infinitive; hence the use of *to* with the Infinitive in Mn.E. As late as the Elizabethan age the Gerund sometimes replaced the Infinitive even after the auxiliary verbs:

“Some pagan shore,
Where these two Christian armies *might combine*
The blood of malice in a vein of league,
And not *to spend* it so unneighbourly.”

—*King John*, V, ii, 39.

NOTE.—The Gerund is simply the *When to* lost the meaning of purpose and came to be considered as a merely formal prefix, *for* was used to supplement the purpose element: *What went ye out for to see?* ⁹

1. Lounsbury, *English Language*, Part II, § 241.
2. Usage sanctions *mood*, but the better spelling would be *mode*. It is from the Lat. *modus*, whereas *mood* (= *temper*) is O.E. *mōd*.
3. Gildersleeve's *Latin Grammar*, § 255.
4. Thus when Alfred writes that an event took place *before* the founding of Rome, he uses the subjunctive: **ǣr ðǣm ðe Rōmeburh getimbrod wære** = *before Rome were founded*; but, **ǣfter ðǣm ðe Rōmeburh getimbrod wæs** = *after Rome was founded*.
5. “By the time of Ælfric, however, the levelling influence of the indicative [after verbs of saying] has made considerable progress.”—Gorrell, *Indirect Discourse in Anglo-Saxon* (Dissertation, 1895), p. 101.
6. Hotz, *On the Use of the Subjunctive Mood in Anglo-Saxon* (Zürich, 1882).
7. Not, *He commanded the bier to be set down*. The Mn.E. passive in such sentences is a loss both in force and directness.
8. Callaway, *The Absolute Participle in Anglo-Saxon* (Dissertation, 1889), p. 19.
9. This is not the place to discuss the Gerund in Mn.E., the so-called “infinitive in *-ing*.” The whole subject has been befogged

for the lack of an accepted nomenclature, one that shall do violence neither to grammar nor to history.



CHAPTER XIX.

STRONG VERBS: CLASSES II AND III.

109. Class II: The “Choose” Conjugation.

Vowel Succession: ēo, ēa, u, o.

INFINITIVE. ¹ PRET. SING. PRET. PLUR. ² PAST PART. ²
 cēos-an, cēas, cur-on gecor-en, to choose.

Indicative.

PRESENT.

Sing. 1. Ic cēos-e
 2. ðū cīest (cēos-est)
 3. hē cīest (cēos-eð)

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } cēos-að
 3. hīe }

PRETERIT.

Sing. 1. Ic cēas
 2. ðū cur-e
 3. hē cēas

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } cur-on
 3. hīe }

Subjunctive.

PRESENT.

Sing. 1. Ic
 2. ðū } cēos-e
 3. hē }

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } cēos-en
 3. hīe }

PRETERIT.

Sing. 1. Ic
 2. ðū } cur-e
 3. hē }

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } cur-en
 3. hīe }

Imperative.

Sing. 2. cēos
Plur. 1. cēos-an
 2. cēos-að

Infinitive.

cēos-an

Gerund.

tō cēos-anne (-enne)

Present Participle.

cēos-ende

Past Participle.

gecor-en

110. Class III: The “Bind” Conjugation.

Vowel Succession: $\left. \begin{matrix} i \\ e \end{matrix} \right\}, a, u, \left. \begin{matrix} u \\ o \end{matrix} \right\}.$

The present stem ends in **m, n, l, r**, or **h**, + one or more consonants:

m:	belimp-an,	$\left\{ \begin{matrix} \text{belomp} \\ \text{belamp} \end{matrix} \right\}$	, belump-on, belump-en,	<i>to belong.</i>
n:	bind-an,	$\left\{ \begin{matrix} \text{bōnd} \\ \text{band} \end{matrix} \right\}$	, bund-on, gebund-en,	<i>to bind.</i>
l:	help-an,	healp,	hulp-on, geholp-en,	<i>to help.</i>
r:	weorð-an,	wearð,	wurd-on, geword-en,	<i>to become.</i>
h:	gefeoht-an,	gefeagt,	gefuht-on, gefoht-en,	<i>to fight.</i>

NOTE 1.—If the present stem ends in a nasal (**m, n**) + a consonant, the past participle retains the **u** of the pret. plur.; but if the present stem ends in a liquid (**l, r**) or **h**, + a consonant, the past participle has **o** instead of **u**.

NOTE 2.—Why do we not find ***halp**, ***warð**, and ***faht** in the pret. sing.? Because **a** before **l, r**, or **h**, + a consonant, underwent “breaking” to **ea**. Breaking also changes every **e** followed by **r** or **h**, + a consonant, to **eo**: **weorðan** (< ***werðan**), **feohtan** (< ***fehtan**).

111.

Indicative.		Subjunctive.	
PRESENT.		PRESENT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic bind-e	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } bind-e
2.	ðū bintst (bind-est)	2.	ðū }
3.	hē bint (bind-eð)	3.	hē }
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } bind-að	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } bind-en
2.	gē }	2.	gē }
3.	hīe }	3.	hīe }
PRETERIT.		PRETERIT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic bōnd	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } bund-e
2.	ðū bund-e	2.	ðū }
3.	hē bōnd	3.	hē }
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } bund-on	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } bund-en
2.	gē }	2.	gē }
3.	hīe }	3.	hīe }
Imperative.		Infinitive.	Present Participle.
<i>Sing.</i> 2.	bind	bind-an	bind-ende
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	bind-an		
2.	bind-að	Gerund.	Past Participle.
		tō bind-anne (-enne)	gebund-en

112.

VOCABULARY.

ðæt gefeoht, *fight, battle*.
sēo geræcednes, *narration* [ræccan].
ðæt gesceap, *creation* [scieppan].
sēo hērgung (§ 39, (3)), *harrying, plundering* [hērgian].
sē medu (medo) (§ 51), *mead*.
sēo meolc, *milk*.
sē middangeard, *world* [middle-yard].
sē munuc, *monk* [monachus].
sēo mȳre, *mare* [mearh].
hē sǣde, *he said*.
hīe sǣdon, *they said*.
sēo spēd, *riches* [speed].
spēdig, *rich, prosperous* [speedy].
sēo tīd, *time* [tide].
unspēdig, *poor*.
sē westanwind, *west-wind*.
ðæt wīn, *wine*.

ārīsan,	ārās,	ārison,	ārisen,	<i>to arise.</i>
bīdan,	bād,	bidon,	gebiden,	<i>to remain, expect</i> (with gen.)
drēogan, ³	drēag,	drugon,	gedrogen,	<i>to endure, suffer.</i>
drincan,	drȳnc,	druncon,	gedruncen,	<i>to drink.</i>
findan,	fȳnd,	fundon,	gefunden,	<i>to find.</i>
geswīcan	geswāc,	geswicon,	geswicen,	<i>to cease, cease from</i> (with gen.)
iernan (yrnan),	ȳrn,	urnon,	geurnen,	<i>to run.</i>
onginnan,	ongȳnn,	ongunnon,	ongunnen,	<i>to begin.</i>
rīdan,	rād,	ridon,	geriden,	<i>to ride.</i>
singan,	sȳng,	sungon,	gesungen,	<i>to sing.</i>
wrītan,	wrāt,	writon,	gewriten,	<i>to write.</i>

I. 1. Æfter ðissum wordum, sē munuc wrāt ealle ðā gerecednesse on ānre bēc. 2. Ðā eorlas ridon ūp ær ðām ðe ðā Dene ðæs gefeohtes gewicen. 3. Cædmon song ærest be middangeardes gesceape. 4. Sē cyning ond ðā rīcostan men drincað mȳran meolc, ond ðā unspēdigan drincað medu. 5. Qnd hē ārās ond sē wind geswāc. 6. Hīe sǣdon ðæt hīe ðær westwindes biden. 7. Hwæt is nū mā ymbe ðās ðing tō sprecanne? 8. Ðā secgas ongunnon geswīcan ðære hergunga. 9. Ðā bēag ðæt lond ðær ēastryhte, oððe sēo sǣ in on ðæt lond. 10. Ðās lond belimpað tō, ðām Englum. 11. Ðēah ðā Dene ealne dæg gefuhten, gīet hæfde Ælfred cyning sige. 12. Qnd ðæs (afterwards) ymbe ānne mōnað gefeaht Ælfred cyning wið ealne ðone here æt Wiltūne.

II. 1. The most prosperous men drank mare's milk and wine, but the poor men drank mead. 2. I suffered many things before you began to help me (dat.). 3. About two days afterwards (**Ðæs ymbe twēgen dagas**), the plundering ceased. 4. The king said that he fought against all the army (**here**). 5. Although the Danes remained one month (**§ 98, (1)**), they did not begin to fight. 6. These gifts belonged to my brother. 7. The earls were glad because their lord was (indicative) with them. 8. What did you find? 9. Then wrote he about (**be**) the wise man's deeds. 10. What more is there to endure?

1. A few verbs of Class II have **ū** instead of **ēo** in the infinitive:

brūcan, brēac, brucon, gebrocen, to enjoy
[brook].

būgan, bēag, bugon, gebogen, to bend, bow.

2. By a law known as Grammatical Change, final **ð**, **s**, and **h** of strong verbs generally become **d**, **r**, and **g**, respectively, in the preterit plural and past participle.

3. Cf. the Scotch "to dree one's weird" = *to endure one's fate*.



CHAPTER XX.

STRONG VERBS: CLASSES IV, V, VI, AND VII.

CONTRACT VERBS.

[The student can now complete the conjugation for himself (§ 103). Only the principal parts will be given.]

114. Class IV: The “Bear” Conjugation.

Vowel Succession: **e, æ, ā, o.**

The present stem ends in **l, r, or m**, no consonant following:

l: **hel-an, hæl, hæl-on, gehol-en, to conceal.**

r: **ber-an, bær, bær-on, gebor-en, to bear.**

The two following verbs are slightly irregular:

m: { **nim-an, nōm (nam), nōm-on (nām-on), genum-en, to take.**
cum-an, c(w)ōm, c(w)ōm-on, gecum-en, to come.

115. Class V: The “Give” Conjugation.

Succession of Vowels: **e (ie), æ, ā, e.**

The present stem ends in a single consonant, never a liquid or nasal:

met-an, mæt, mæton, gemet-en, to measure, mete.

gief-an, geaf, gēaf-on, gegief-en, to give.

NOTE 1.—The palatal consonants, **g, c, and sc**, convert a following **e** into **ie**, **æ** into **ea**, and **ā** into **ēa**. Hence **giefan** (< ***gefan**), **geaf** (< ***gæf**), **gēafon** (< ***gæfon**), **gegiefen** (< ***gegefen**). This change is known as Palatalization. See § 8.

NOTE 2.—The infinitives of the following important verbs are only apparently exceptional:

biddan, bæd, bæd-on, gebed-en, to ask for [bid].

licgan, læg, læg-on, geleg-en, to lie, extend.

sittan, sæt, sæt-on, geset-en, to sit.

The original **e** reappears in the participial stems. It was changed to **i** in the present stems on account of a former **-jan** in the infinitive (**bid-jan**, etc.). See § 61. To the same cause is due the doubling of consonants in the infinitive. All simple consonants in O.E., with the exception of **r**, were doubled after a short vowel, when an original **j** followed.

Class VI: The “Shake” Conjugation.

116.

Succession of Vowels: **a, ō, ō, a.**

scac-an, scōc, scōc-on, gescac-en, to shake.
far-an, fōr, fōr-on, gefar-en, to go [fare].

117.

Class VII: The “Fall” Conjugation.

Vowel Succession: $\begin{matrix} \bar{a} \\ \bar{æ} \end{matrix} \left. \vphantom{\begin{matrix} \bar{a} \\ \bar{æ} \end{matrix}} \right\}, \bar{e}, \bar{e}, \begin{matrix} \bar{a} \\ \bar{æ} \end{matrix} \left. \vphantom{\begin{matrix} \bar{a} \\ \bar{æ} \end{matrix}} \right\}; \text{ or } \begin{matrix} ea \\ \bar{e}a \\ \bar{o} \end{matrix} \left. \vphantom{\begin{matrix} ea \\ \bar{e}a \\ \bar{o} \end{matrix}} \right\}, \bar{e}o, \bar{e}o, \begin{matrix} ea \\ \bar{e}a \\ \bar{o} \end{matrix} \left. \vphantom{\begin{matrix} ea \\ \bar{e}a \\ \bar{o} \end{matrix}} \right\}.$

- (1) **hāt-an, hēt, hēt-on, gehāt-en, $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{to call, name,} \\ \text{command.} \end{array} \right.$**
læt-an, lēt, lēt-on, gelæt-en, to let.
 (2) **feall-an, fēoll, fēoll-on, gefeall-en, to fall.**
heald-an, hēold, hēold-on, geheald-en, to hold.
hēaw-an, hēow, hēow-on, gehēaw-en, to hew.
grōw-an, grēow, grēow-on, gegrōw-en, to grow.

NOTE 1.—This class consists of the Reduplicating Verbs; that is, those verbs that originally formed their preterits not by internal vowel change (ablaut), but by prefixing to the present stem the initial consonant + **e** (cf. Gk. λέ-λοιπα and Lat. *dě-di*). Contraction then took place between the syllabic prefix and the root, the fusion resulting in **ē** or **ēo**: ***he-hat > heht > hēt**.

NOTE 2.—A peculiar interest attaches to **hātan**: the forms **hätte** and **hätton** are the sole remains in O.E. of the original Germanic passive. They are used both as presents and as preterits: **hätte** = *I am* or *was called, he is* or *was called*. No other verb in O.E. could have a passive sense without calling in the aid of the verb *to be* (§ 141).

Contract Verbs.

118. The few Contract Verbs found in O.E. do not constitute a new class; they fall under Classes I, II, V, VI, and VII, already treated. The present stem ended originally in **h**. This was lost before **-an** of the infinitive, contraction and compensatory lengthening being the result. The following are the most important of these verbs:

Classes.

- I. **ðēon** (< *ðīhan), **ðāh, ðig-on, $\left\{ \begin{array}{l} \text{geðig-en} \\ \text{geðung-en} \end{array} \right\}, \text{to thrive.}$**
 II. **tēon** (< *tēohan), **tēah, tug-on, getog-en, to draw, go [tug].**
 V. **sēon** (< *sehwan), **seah, sāw-on, gesew-en, to see.**
 VI. **slēan** (< *slahan), **slōh, slōg-on, geslæg-en, to slay.**
 VII. **fōn** (< *fōhan), **fēng, fēng-on, gefōng-en, to seize [fang].**

119. The Present Indicative of these verbs runs as follows (see rules of i-umlaut, § 58):

Sing. 1.	Ic ðēo	tēo	sēo	slēa	fō
2.	ðū ðīhst	tīehst	siehst	sliehst	fēhst
3.	hē ðīhð	tīehð	siehð	sliehð	fēhð
Plur. 1.	wē	ðēoð	tēoð	sēoð	slēað
2.	gē				
3.	hīe				

The other tenses and moods are regularly formed from the given stems.

120. VOCABULARY.

sēo æht, *property, possession* [āgan].

aweg, *away* [on weg].

sēo fierd, *English army* [faran].

sē here, *Danish army* [hęrgian].

on gehwæðre hōnd, *on both sides*.

sige niman (= **sige habban**), *to win (the) victory*.

sēo spræc, *speech, language*.

tō rīce fōn, *to come to the throne*.¹

ðæt wæl [Val-halla] } *slaughter, carnage*.
sē wælsliht,

sē weall, *wall, rampart*.

ðæt wildor, *wild beast, reindeer*.

sē wīngeard, *vineyard*.

ābrecan,² **ābræc**, **ābræcon**, **ābrocen**, *to break down*.

cweðan, **cwæð**, **cwædon**, **gecweden**, *to say* [quoth].

gesēon, **geseah**, **gesāwon**, **gesewen**, *to see*.

grōwan, **grēow**, **grēowon**, **gegrōwen**, *to grow*.

ofslēan, **ofslōh**, **ofslōgon**, **ofslægen**, *to slay*.

sprecan, **spræc**, **spræcon**, **gesprecen**, *to speak*.

stelan, **stæl**, **stælon**, **gestolen**, *to steal*.

stōndan, **stōd**, **stōdon**, **gestōnden**, *to stand*.

weaxan, **wēox**, **wēoxon**, **geweaxen**, *to grow, increase* [wax].

I. 1. Æfter ðæm sōðlice (indeed) ealle mæn spræcon āne (one) spræce. 2. Qnd hē cwæð: “Ðis is ān folc, qnd ealle hīe sprecað āne spræce.” 3. On sumum stōwum wīngeardas grōwað. 4. Hē hēt ðā nædran ofslēan. 5. Ðā Eṅle ābræcon ðone lōngan weall, qnd sige nōmon. 6. Qnd ðæt sǣd grēow qnd wēox. 7. Ic ne geseah ðone mōn sē ðe ðæs cnapan adesan stæl. 8. Hē wæs swyðe spēdig man on ðæm æhtum ðe hiera spēda on ³ bēoð, ðæt is, on wiltrum. 9. Qnd ðær wearð (was) micel wælsliht on gehwæðre hōnd. 10. Qnd æfter ðissum gefeohte cōm Ælfred cyning mid his fierde, qnd gefeaht wið ealne ðone hēre, qnd sige nōm. 11. Ðēos burg hātte ⁴ Æscesdūn (Ashdown). 12. Ðære cwēne līc lǣg on ðæm hūse. 13. Qnd sē dæl ðe ðær aweg cōm wæs swyðe lýtēl. 14. Qnd ðæs ðrēotīene dagas Æðered tō rīce fēng.

II. 1. The men stood in the ships and fought against the Danes. 2. Before the thanes came, the king rode away. 3. They said (**sǣdon**) that all the men spoke one language. 4. They bore the queen’s body to Wilton. 5. Alfred gave many gifts to his army (dat. without **tō**) before he went away. 6. These men are called earls. 7. God sees all things. 8. The boy held the reindeer with (**mid**) his hands. 9. About six months afterwards, Alfred gained the victory, and came to the throne. 10. He said that there was very great slaughter on both sides.

1. Literally, *to take to (the) kingdom*. Cf. “Have you anything to take to?” (*Two Gentlemen of Verona*, IV, 1, 42).

2. **Brecan** belongs properly in Class V, but it has been drawn into Class IV possibly through the influence of the **r** in the root.

3. See § 94, (5).

4. See § 117, Note 2.



CHAPTER XXI.

WEAK VERBS (§ 18).

122. The verbs belonging to the Weak Conjugation are generally of more recent origin than the strong verbs, being frequently formed from the roots of strong verbs. The Weak Conjugation was the growing conjugation in O.E. as it is in Mn.E. We instinctively put our newly coined or borrowed words into this conjugation (*telegraphed, boycotted*); and children, by the analogy of weak verbs, say *runned* for *ran*, *seed* for *saw*, *teared* for *tore*, *drawed* for *drew*, and *growed* for *grew*. So, for example, when Latin *dictāre* and *breviāre* came into O.E., they came as weak verbs, **dihtian** and **brēfian**.

The Three Classes of Weak Verbs.

123. There is no difficulty in telling, from the infinitive alone, to which of the three classes a weak verb belongs. Class III has been so invaded by Class II that but three important verbs remain to it: **habban**, *to have*; **libban**, *to live*; and **sēcgan**, *to say*. Distinction is to be made, therefore, only between Classes II and I. Class II contains the verbs with infinitive in **-ian** not preceded by **r**. Class I contains the remaining weak verbs; that is, those with infinitive in **-r-ian** and those with infinitive in **-an** (not **-ian**).

Class I.

124. The preterit singular and past participle of Class I end in **-ede** and **-ed**, or **-de** and **-ed** respectively.

NOTE.—The infinitives of this class ended originally in **-jan** (= **-ian**). This accounts for the prevalence of **i**-umlaut in these verbs, and also for the large number of short-voweled stems ending in a double consonant (§ 115, Note 2). The weak verb is frequently the causative of the corresponding strong verb. In such cases, the root of the weak verb corresponds in form to the preterit singular of the strong verb: Mn.E. *drench* (= *to make drink*), *lay* (= *to make lie*), *rear* (= *to make rise*), and *set* (= *to make sit*), are the umlauted forms of **drȳnc** (preterit singular of **drincan**), **læg** (preterit singular of **licgan**), **rās** (preterit singular of **rīsan**), and **sæt** (preterit singular of **sittan**).

Preterit and Past Participle in *-ede* and *-ed*.

125. Verbs with infinitive in **-an** preceded by **ri-** or the double consonants **mm**, **nn**, **ss**, **bb**, **cg** (= **gg**), add **-ede** for the preterit, and **-ed** for the past participle, the double consonant being always made single:

ri:	nēri-an,	nēr-ede,	genēr-ed,	<i>to save.</i>
mm:	frēm-an,	frēm-ede,	gefrem-ed,	<i>to perform</i> [frame].
nn:	ðenn-an,	ðen-ede,	geðen-ed,	<i>to extend.</i>
ss:	cnyss-an,	cnys-ede,	gecnys-ed,	<i>to beat.</i>
bb:	swēbb-an,	swēf-ede,	geswēf-ed,	<i>to put to sleep.</i>
cg:	wēc-an,	wēg-ede,	gewēg-ed,	<i>to agitate.</i>

NOTE.—**Lēc-an**, *to lay*, is the only one of these verbs that syncopates the **e**: **lēcgan**, **lēgde** (**lēde**), **gelēgd** (**gelēd**), instead of **lēgede**, **gelēged**.

Preterit and Past Participle in *-de* and *-ed*.

126. All the other verbs belonging to Class I. add **-de** for the preterit and **-ed** for the past participle. This division includes, therefore, all stems long by nature (§ 10, (3), (a)):

dæl-an,	dæl-de,	gedæl-ed,	<i>to deal out, divide</i> [dæl].
dēm-an,	dēm-de,	gedēm-ed,	<i>to judge</i> [dōm].
grēt-an,	grēt-te,	gegrēt-ed,	<i>to greet.</i>
hīer-an,	hīer-de,	gehīer-ed,	<i>to hear.</i>
læd-an,	læd-de,	gelæd-ed,	<i>to lead.</i>

NOTE 1.—A preceding voiceless consonant (§ 9, Note) changes **-de** into **-te**: ***grēt-de** > **grēt-te**; ***mēt-de** > **mēt-te**; ***īec-de** > **īec-te**. Syncope and contraction are also frequent in the participles: **gegrēt-ed** > ***gegrēt-d** > **gegrēt(t)**; **gelæd-ed** > **gelæd(d)**.

NOTE 2.—**Būan**, *to dwell, cultivate*, has an admixture of strong forms in the past participle: **būan**, **būde**, **gebūd** (**bȳn**, **gebūn**). The present participle survives in Mn.E. *husband* = *house-dweller*.

127. It includes, also, all stems long by position (§ 10, (3), (b)) except those in **mm**, **nn**, **ss**, **bb**, and **cg** (§ 125):

sēnd-an,	sēnd-e,	gesēnd-ed,	<i>to send.</i>
sēt-an,	sēt-te,	gesēt-ed,	<i>to set</i> [sittan].
sigl-an,	sigl-de,	gesigl-ed,	<i>to sail.</i>
spēnd-an,	spēnd-e,	gespēnd-ed,	<i>to spend.</i>
trēdd-an,	trēd-de,	getrēd-ed,	<i>to tread.</i>

NOTE.—The participles frequently undergo syncope and contraction: **gesęnded** > **gesęnd**; **gesęted** > **gesęt(t)**; **gespęded** > **gespęnd**; **getręded** > **getręd(d)**.

Irregular Verbs of Class I.

128. There are about twenty verbs belonging to Class I that are irregular in having no umlaut in the preterit and past participle. The preterit ends in **-de**, the past participle in **-d**; but, through the influence of a preceding voiceless consonant (§ 9, Note), **-ed** is generally unvoiced to **-te**, and **-d** to **-t**. The most important of these verbs are as follows:

bring-an,	brōh-te,	gebrōh-t,	<i>to bring.</i>
byc-gan,	boh-te,	geboh-t,	<i>to buy.</i>
sēc-an,	sōh-te,	gesōh-t,	<i>to seek.</i>
sęll-an,	seal-de,	geseal-d,	<i>to give, sell [hand-sel].</i>
tāc-an,	tāh-te,	getāh-t,	<i>to teach.</i>
tęll-an,	teal-de,	geteal-d,	<i>to count [tell].</i>
đęnc-an,	đōh-te,	geđōh-t,	<i>to think.</i>
đync-an,	đūh-te,	geđūh-t,	<i>to seem [methinks].</i>
wyrc-an,	worh-te,	geworh-t,	<i>to work.</i>

NOTE.—Such of these verbs as have stems in **c** or **g** are frequently written with an inserted **e**: **bycgean**, **sēccean**, **tāccean**, etc. This **e** indicates that **c** and **g** have palatal value; that is, are to be followed with a vanishing **y**-sound. In such cases, O.E. **c** usually passes into Mn.E. **ch**: **tāc(e)an** > *to teach*; **rāc(e)an** > *to reach*; **strecc(e)an** > *to stretch*. **Sēc(e)an** gives *beseech* as well as *seek*. See § 8.

Conjugation of Class I.

129. Paradigms of **nęrian**, *to save*; **fręmman**, *to perform*; **dāelan**, *to divide*:

Indicative.

PRESENT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic nęrie	fręmme	dāele
2.	đū nęrest	fręmest	dāelst
3.	hē nęređ	fręmeđ	dāelđ
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	nęriađ	fręmmađ
2.	gē		
3.	hīe		
			dāelađ

PRETERIT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic nęrede	fręmede	dāelde
2.	đū nęredest	fręmedest	dāeldest

3. hē nērede frēmede dāelde

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } nēredon frēmedon dāeldon
 3. hīe }

Subjunctive.

PRESENT.

Sing. 1. Ic }
 2. ðū } nērie frēmme dāle
 3. hē }

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } nērien frēmnen dālen
 3. hīe }

PRETERIT.

Sing. 1. Ic }
 2. ðū } nērede frēmede dāelde
 3. hē }

Plur. 1. wē }
 2. gē } nēreden frēmeden dāelden
 3. hīe }

Imperative.

Sing. 2. nēre frēme dāel
 Plur. 1. nērian frēmman dāelan
 2. nēriað frēmmað dālað

Infinitive.

nērian frēmman dāelan

Gerund.

tō nērianne (-enne) tō frēmmanne (-enne) tō dāelanne (-enne)

Present Participle.

nēriende frēmmente dāelende

Past Participle.

genēred gefrēmed gedāled

NOTE.—The endings of the preterit present no difficulties; in the 2d and 3d singular present, however, the student will observe (a) that double consonants in the stem are made single: **frēmest, frēmeð** (not ***freēmest, *freēmmeð**); **ðenest, ðeneð**; **sėtest (sėtst), sėteð (sėtt)**; **fylst, fylð**, from **fyllan, to fill**; (b) that syncope is the rule in stems long by nature: **dālst** (< **dālest**), **dālð** (< **dāleð**); **dēmst** (< **dēmest**), **dēmð** (< **dēmeð**); **hīerst** (< **hīerest**), **hīerð** (< **hīereð**). Double consonants are also made single in the imperative 2d singular and in the past participle. Stems long by nature take no final **-e** in the imperative: **dāel, hīer, dēm**.

Class II.

130. The infinitive of verbs belonging to this class ends in **-ian** (not **-r-ian**), the preterit singular in **-ode**, the past participle in **-od**. The preterit plural usually has **-edon**, however, instead of **-odon**:

eard-ian,	eard-ode,	geear-d-od,	<i>to dwell</i> [eorðe].
luf-ian,	luf-ode,	geluf-od,	<i>to love</i> [lufu].
rīcs-ian,	rīcs-ode,	gerīcs-od,	<i>to rule</i> [rīce].
sealf-ian,	sealf-ode,	gessealf-od,	<i>to anoint</i> [salve].
segl-ian,	segl-ode,	gesegl-od,	<i>to sail</i> [segel].

NOTE.—These verbs have no trace of original umlaut, since their **-ian** was once **-ōjan**. Hence, the vowel of the stem was shielded from the influence of the **j** (= **i**) by the interposition of **ō**.

Conjugation of Class II.

131. Paradigm of **lufian**, *to love*:

Indicative.		Subjunctive.	
PRESENT.		PRESENT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic lufie	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } lufie
2.	ðū lufast	2.	ðū }
3.	hē lufað	3.	hē }
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } lufiað	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } lufien
2.	gē }	2.	gē }
3.	hīe }	3.	hīe }
PRETERIT.		PRETERIT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic lufode	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic } lufode
2.	ðū lufodest	2.	ðū }
3.	hē lufode	3.	hē }
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } lufedon (-odon)	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē } lufeden (-oden)
2.	gē }	2.	gē }
3.	hīe }	3.	hīe }
Imperative.	Infinitive.	Present Participle.	
<i>Sing.</i> 2.	lufa	lufiende	
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	lufian		
2.	lufiað	Gerund.	Past Participle.
		tō lufianne (-enne)	gelufod

NOTE 1.—The **-ie** (**-ien**) occurring in the present must be pronounced as a dissyllable. The **y**-sound thus interposed between the **i** and **e** is frequently indicated by the letter **g**: **lufie**, or **lufige**; **lufien**, or **lufigen**. So also for **ia**: **lufiað**, or **lufigað**; **lufian**, or **lufig(e)an**.

NOTE 2.—In the preterit singular, **-ade**, **-ude**, and **-ede** are not infrequent for **-ode**.

Class III.

132. The few verbs belonging here show a blending of Classes I and II. Like certain verbs of Class I (§ 128), the preterit and past participle are formed by adding **-de** and **-d**; like Class II, the 2d and 3d present indicative singular end in **-ast** and **-að**, the imperative 2d singular in **-a**:

habb-an,	hæf-de,	gehæf-d,	<i>to have.</i>
libb-an,	lif-de,	gelif-d,	<i>to live.</i>
sęcg-an,	sæd-e (sæg-de),	gesæd (gesæg-d),	<i>to say.</i>

Conjugation of Class III.

133. Paradigms of **habban**, *to have*; **libban**, *to live*; **sęcgan**, *to say*.

Indicative.

PRESENT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic hæbbe	libbe	sęcge
2.	ðū hæfst (hafast)	lifast	sægst (sagast)
3.	hē hæfð (hafað)	lifað	sægð (sagað)
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} habbað	libbað
2.	gē		
3.	hīe		
			sęcgað

PRETERIT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic hæfde	lifde	sæde
2.	ðū hæfdest	lifdest	sædest
3.	hē hæfde	lifde	sæde
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} hæfdon	lifdon
2.	gē		
3.	hīe		
			sædon

Subjunctive.

PRESENT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic	} hæbbe	libbe	sęcge
2.	ðū			
3.	hē			
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} hæbben	libben	sęcgen
2.	gē			
3.	hīe			

PRETERIT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic	}	hæfde	lifde	sæde
2.	ðū				
3.	hē				

<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	}	hæfden	lifden	sæden
2.	gē				
3.	hīe				

Imperative.

<i>Sing.</i> 2.	hafa	lifa	saga
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	habban	libban	sęcgan
2.	habbað	libbað	sęcgað

Infinitive.

habban	libban	sęcgan
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Gerund.

tō habbanne (-enne)	tō libbanne (-enne)	tō sęcganne (-enne)
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Present Participle.

hæbbende	libbende	sęcgende
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Past Participle.

gehæfd	gelifd	gesæd
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CHAPTER XXII.

REMAINING VERBS; VERB-PHRASES WITH **habban**, **bēon**, AND **weorðan**.

Anomalous Verbs. (See § 19.)

134. These are:

bēon (<i>wesan</i>),	wæs ,	wæron ,	—,	<i>to be.</i>
willan ,	wolde ,	woldon ,	—,	<i>to will, intend.</i>
dōn ,	dyde ,	dydon ,	gedōn ,	<i>to do, cause.</i>
gān ,	ēode ,	ēodon ,	gegān ,	<i>to go.</i>

NOTE.—In the original Indo-Germanic language, the first person of the present indicative singular ended in (1) **ō** or (2) **mi**. Cf. Gk. λύ-ω, εἰ-μί, Lat. *am-ō*, *su-m*. The Strong and Weak Conjugations of O.E. are survivals of the **ō**-class. The four Anomalous Verbs mentioned above are the sole remains in O.E. of the **mi**-class. Note the surviving **m** in **eom** *I am*, and

dōm *I do* (Northumbrian form). These **mi**-verbs are sometimes called non-Thematic to distinguish them from the Thematic or **ō**-verbs.

Conjugation of Anomalous Verbs.

135. Only the present indicative and subjunctive are at all irregular:

Indicative.

PRESENT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic eom (bēom)	wille	dō	gā
2.	ðū eart (bist)	wilt	dēst	gæst
3.	hē is (bið)	wille	dēð	gæð
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} sind(on)	willað	dōð
2.	gē			
3.	hīe			

Subjunctive.

PRESENT.

<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic	} sīe	wille	dō	gā
2.	ðū				
3.	hē				
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	} sīen	willen	dōn	gān
2.	gē				
3.	hīe				

NOTE.—The preterit subjunctive of **bēon** is formed, of course, not from **wæs**, but from **wæron**. See § 103, (3).

Preterit-Present Verbs. (See § 19.)

136. These verbs are called Preterit-Present because the present tense (indicative and subjunctive) of each of them is, in form, a strong preterit, the old present having been displaced by the new. They all have weak preterits. Most of the Mn.E. Auxiliary Verbs belong to this class.

witan,	{ wiste, wisse,	wiston,	gewiten,	<i>to know</i> [to wit, wot].
āgan,	āhte,	āhton,	āgen (adj.),	<i>to possess</i> [owe].
cunnan,	cūðe,	cūðon,	{ gecunnen, cūð (adj.),	<i>to know, can</i> [uncouth, cunning].
durran,	dorste,	dorston,	—	<i>to dare.</i>
sculan,	sceolde,	sceoldon,	—	<i>shall.</i>

magan,	{	meahte,	meahton,	}	—	to be able, may.
mōtan,		mihhte,	mihhton,		—	may, must.
		mōste,	mōston,			

NOTE.—The change in meaning from preterit to present, with retention of the preterit form, is not uncommon in other languages. Several examples are found in Latin and Greek (cf. *nōvi* and *οἶδα*, *I know*). Mn.E. has gone further still: **āhte** and **mōste**, which had already suffered the loss of their old preterits (**āh**, **mōt**), have been forced back again into the present (*ought*, *must*). Having exhausted, therefore, the only means of preterit formation known to Germanic, the strong and the weak, it is not likely that either *ought* or *must* will ever develop distinct preterit forms.

Conjugation of Preterit-Present Verbs.

137. The irregularities occur in the present indicative and subjunctive:

Indicative.

PRESENT.

Sing. 1.	Ic wāt	āh	cƿn (can)	dear	sceal	mæg	mōt
2.	ðū wāst	āhst	cƿnst (canst)	dearst	scealt	meaht	mōst
3.	hē wāt	āh	cƿn (can)	dear	sceal	mæg	mōt
Plur. 1.	wē	} witon	āgon	cunnon	durren	sculon	magon
2.	gē						
3.	hīe						

Subjunctive.

PRESENT.

Sing. 1.	Ic	} wite	āge	cunne	durre	scule (scyle)	mæge	mōte
2.	ðū							
3.	hē							
Plur. 1.	wē	} witen	āgen	cunnen	durren	sculen (scylen)	mægen	mōten
2.	gē							
3.	hīe							

NOTE 1.—**Willan** and **sculan** do not often connote simple futurity in Early West Saxon, yet they were fast drifting that way. The Mn.E. use of *shall* only with the 1st person and *will* only with the 2d and 3d, to express simple futurity, was wholly unknown even in Shakespeare's day. The elaborate distinctions drawn between these words by modern grammarians are not only cumbersome and foreign to the genius of English, but equally lacking in psychological basis.

NOTE 2.—**Sculan** originally implied the idea of (1) *duty*, or *compulsion* (= *ought to*, or *must*), and this conception lurks with more or less prominence in almost every function of **sculan** in O.E.: **Dryhten bebēad Moyse hū hē sceolde beran ðā earce**, *The Lord instructed Moses how he ought to bear the ark*; **Ælc mann sceal be his andgietes mæðe ... sprecan ðæt he spricð**, and **dōn ðæt ðæt hē dēð**, *Every man must, according to the measure of his*

intelligence, speak what he speaks, and do what he does. Its next most frequent use is to express (2) *custom*, the transition from the obligatory to the customary being an easy one: **Sē byrdesta sceall gyldan fiftýne mearðes fell**, *The man of highest rank pays fifteen marten skins.*

NOTE 3.—**Willan** expressed originally (1) *pure volition*, and this is its most frequent use in O.E. It may occur without the infinitive: **Nylle ic ðæs synfullan dēað, ac ic wille ðæt hē gecyrre and lybbe**, *I do not desire the sinner's death, but I desire that he return and live.* The wish being father to the intention, **willan** soon came to express (2) *purpose*: **Hē sǣde ðæt hē at sumum cirre wolde fandian hū longe ðæt land norðryhte lǣge**, *He said that he intended, at some time, to investigate how far that land extended northward.*

Verb-Phrases with *habban*, *bēon* (*wesan*), and *weorðan*.

Verb-Phrases in the Active Voice.

138. The present and preterit of **habban**, combined with a past participle, are used in O.E., as in Mn.E., to form the present perfect and past perfect tenses:

PRESENT PERFECT.		PAST PERFECT.	
<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic hæbbe gedrifen	<i>Sing.</i> 1.	Ic hæfde gedrifen
2.	ðū hæfst gedrifen	2.	ðū hæfdest gedrifen
3.	hē hæfð gedrifen	3.	hē hæfde gedrifen
<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē	<i>Plur.</i> 1.	wē
2.	gē	2.	gē
3.	hīe	3.	hīe
	} habbað gedrifen		} hæfdon gedrifen

The past participle is not usually inflected to agree with the direct object: **Norðymbre ƿnd Ēastęngle hæfdon Ælfrede cýninge āðas geseald** (not **gesealde**, § 82), *The Northumbrians and East Anglians had given king Alfred oaths*; **ƿnd hæfdon micne dǣl ðāra horsa freten** (not **fretenne**), *and (they) had devoured a large part of the horses.*

NOTE.—Many sentences might be quoted in which the participle does agree with the direct object, but there seems to be no clear line of demarcation between them and the sentences just cited. Originally, the participle expressed a *resultant state*, and belonged in sense more to the object than to **habban**; but in Early West Saxon **habban** had already, in the majority of cases, become a pure auxiliary when used with the past participle. This is conclusively proved by the use of **habban** with intransitive verbs. In such a clause, therefore, as **oð ðæt hīe hine ofslægenne hæfdon**, there is no occasion to translate *until they had him slain* (= *resultant state*); the agreement here is more probably due to the proximity of **ofslægenne** to **hine**. So also **ac hī hæfdon þā hiera stemn gesętenne**, *but they had already served out (sat out) their military term.*

139. If the verb is intransitive, and denotes a change of condition, a departure or arrival, **bēon (wesan)** usually replaces **habban**. The past participle, in such cases, partakes of the nature of an adjective, and generally agrees with the subject: **Mīne welan þe ic iō hæfde syndon ealle gewitene qnd gedrorene**, *My possessions which I once had are all departed and fallen away*; **wæron þā men uppe on londe of āgāne**, *the men had gone up ashore*; **qnd þā oþre wæron hungre ācwole**, *and the others had perished of hunger*; **qnd ēac sē micla here wæs þā þær tō cumen**, *and also the large army had then arrived there*.

140. A progressive present and preterit (not always, however, with distinctively progressive meanings) are formed by combining a present participle with the present and preterit of **bēon (wesan)**. The participle remains uninflected: **qnd hīe alle on ðone cyning wærun feohtende**, *and they all were fighting against the king*; **Symle hē bið lōciende, nē slæpð hē nāfre**, *He is always looking, nor does He ever sleep*.

NOTE.—In most sentences of this sort, the subject is masculine (singular or plural); hence no inference can be made as to agreement, since **-e** is the participial ending for both numbers of the nominative masculine (§ 82). By analogy, therefore, the other genders usually conform in inflection to the masculine: **wæron þā ealle þā dēoflu clypigende ānre stefne**, *then were all the devils crying with one voice*.

Verb-Phrases in the Passive Voice.

141. Passive constructions are formed by combining **bēon (wesan)** or **weorðan** with a past participle. The participle agrees regularly with the subject: **hīe wæron benumene ægðer ge þæs cēapes ge þæs cornes**, *they were deprived both of the cattle and the corn*; **hī bēoð āblende mid ðām þīostrum heora scylda**, *they are blinded with the darkness of their sins*; **and sē wælhreowa Domiciānus on ðām ylcan gēare wearð acweald**, *and the murderous Domitian was killed in the same year*; **qnd Æpelwulf aldormon wearð ofslægen**, *and Æthelwulf, alderman, was slain*.

NOTE 1.—To express agency, Mn.E. employs *by*, rarely *of*; M.E. *of*, rarely *by*; O.E. **frōm (fram)**, rarely **of**: **Sē ðe Godes bebodu ne gecnāwð, ne bið hē oncnāwen frōm Gode**, *He who does not recognise God's commands, will not be recognized by God*; **Betwux þām wearð ofslagen Ēadwine ... fram Brytta cyninge**, *Meanwhile, Edwin was slain by the king of the Britons*.

NOTE 2.—O.E. had no progressive forms for the passive, and could not, therefore, distinguish between *He is being wounded* and *He is wounded*. It was not until more than a hundred years after Shakespeare's death that *being* assumed this function. **Weorðan**, which originally denoted *a passage from one state to another*, was ultimately driven out by **bēon** (**wesan**), and survives now only in *Woe worth* (= *be to*).

142.

VOCABULARY.

ðā Beormas, *Permians*.

ðā Dēniscan, *the Danish (men), Danes*.

ðā Finnas, *Fins*.

ðæt gewald, *control* [**wealdan**].

sēo sǣ, *sea*.

sēo scīr, *shire, district*.

sēo wælstōw, *battle-field*.

āgan wælstōwe gewald, *to maintain possession of the battle-field*.

sē wealdend, *ruler, wielder*.

geflīeman, **geflīemde**, **geflīemed**, *to put to flight*.

gestaðelian, **gestaðelode**, **gestaðelod**, *to establish, restore*.

gewissian, **gewissode**, **gewissod**, *to guide, direct*.

wīcian, **wīcode**, **gewīcod**, *to dwell* [**wīc** = village].

143.

EXERCISES.

1. 1. Qnd ðær wæs micel wæl geslāgen on gehwæpre hƿnd, qnd Æpelwulf ealdormƿn wearƿ ofslāgen; qnd þā Dēniscan āhton wælstōwe gewald.
2. Qnd þæs ymb ānne mōnaþ gefeaht Ælfred cyning wiþ ealne þone hƿre ond hine geflīemde.
3. Hē sǣde þēah þæt þæt land sīe swīþe lang norþ þƿnan.
4. Þā Beormas hæfdon swīþe wel gebūd (§ 126, Note 2) hiera land.
5. Ohthere sǣde þæt sēo scīr hǣtte (§ 117, Note 2) Hālgoland, þe hē on (§ 94, (5)) būde.
6. Þā Finnas wīcedon be þære sǣ.
7. Dryhten, ælmihtiga (§ 78, Note) God, Wyrhta and Wealdend ealra gesceafta, ic bidde ðē for ðīnre miclan mildheortnesse ðæt ðū mē gewissie tō ðīnum willan; and gestaðela mīn mōd tō ðīnum willan and tō mīnre sǣwle ðearfe.
8. Þā sceolde hē ðær bīdan ryhtnorþanwindes, for ðām þæt land bēag þær sūðryhte, oþþe sēo sǣ in on ðæt land, hē nysse hwæðer.
9. For ðȳ, mē ðyncð bƿtre, gif ēow

swā ǫyncð, ðæt wē ēac ðās bēc on ðæt geðēode wēnden ðe wē ealle
gecnāwan mægen.

II. 1. When the king heard that, he went (= then went he) westward with his
army to Ashdown. 2. Lovest thou me more than these? 3. The men said that
the shire which they lived in was called Halgoland. 4. All things were made
(**wyrca**n) by God. 5. They were fighting for two days with (= against) the
Danes. 6. King Alfred fought with the Danes, and gained the victory; but
the Danes retained possession of the battle-field. 7. These men dwelt in
England before they came hither. 8. I have not seen the book of (**ymbe**)
which you speak (**spreca**n).

PART III.



SELECTIONS FOR READING.



PROSE.

INTRODUCTORY.

I. The Anglo-Saxon Chronicle.

THIS famous work, a series of progressive annals by unknown hands, embraces a period extending from Cæsar's invasion of England to 1154. It is not known when or where these annals began to be recorded in English.

"The annals from the year 866—that of Ethelred's ascent of the throne—to the year 887 seem to be the work of one mind. Not a single year is passed over, and to several is granted considerable space, especially to the years 871, 878, and 885. The whole has gained a certain roundness and fulness, because the events—nearly all of them episodes in the ever-recurring conflict with the Danes—are taken in their connection, and the thread dropped in one year is resumed in the next. Not only is the style in itself concise; it has a sort of nervous severity and pithy rigor. The construction is often antiquated, and suggests at times the freedom of poetry; though this purely historical prose is far removed from poetry in profusion of language." (Ten Brink, *Early Eng. Lit.*, I.)

II. The Translations of Alfred.

Alfred's reign (871-901) may be divided into four periods. The *first*, the period of Danish invasion, extends from 871 to 881; the *second*, the period of comparative quiet, from 881 to 893; the *third*, the period of renewed strife (beginning with the incursions of Hasting), from 893 to 897; the *fourth*, the period of peace, from 897 to 901. His literary work probably falls in the second period.*

The works translated by Alfred from Latin into the vernacular were (1) *Consolation of Philosophy* (*De Consolatione Philosophiae*) by Boëthius (475-525), (2) *Compendious History of the World* (*Historiarum Libri VII*) by Orosius (c. 418), (3) *Ecclesiastical History of the English* (*Historia Ecclesiastica Gentis Anglorum*) by Bede (672-735), and (4) *Pastoral Care* (*De Cura Pastoralis*) by Pope Gregory the Great (540-604).

The chronological sequence of these works is wholly unknown. That given is supported by Turner, Arend, Morley, Grein, and Pauli. Wülker argues for an exact reversal of this order. According to Ten Brink, the order was more probably (1) *Orosius*, (2) *Bede*, (3) *Boëthius*, and (4) *Pastoral Care*. The most recent contribution to the subject is from Wülffing, who contends for (1) *Bede*, (2) *Orosius*, (3) *Pastoral Care*, and (4) *Boëthius*.

* There is something inexpressibly touching in this clause from the great king's pen: gif wē ðā stilnesse habbað. He is speaking of how much he hopes to do, by his translations, for the enlightenment of his people.

I. THE BATTLE OF ASHDOWN.

[From the *Chronicle*, Parker MS. The event and date are significant. The Danes had for the first time invaded Wessex. Alfred's older brother, Ethelred, was king; but to Alfred belongs the glory of the victory at Ashdown (Berkshire). Asser (*Life of Alfred*) tells us that for a long time Ethelred remained praying in his tent, while Alfred and his followers went forth "like a wild boar against the hounds."]

1 871. Hēr cuōm ¹ sē hēre tō Rēadingum on Westseaxe,
2 qnd þæs ymb iii niht ridon ii eorlas ūp. Ða gemētte hīe

1 Æþelwulf aldorman ² on Englafelda, qnd him þær wiþ gefeaht,
2 qnd sige nam. Þæs ymb iiii niht Æþered cyning
3 qnd Ælfred his brōþur ³ þær micle fierd tō Rēadingum
4 gelæddon, qnd wiþ þone hēre gefuhton; qnd þær wæs
5 micel wæl geslægen on gehwæpre hōnd, qnd Æþelwulf
6 aldormōn wearþ ofslægen; qnd þa Dēniscan āhton wælstōwe
7 gewald.

8 Qnd þæs ymb iiii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning qnd
9 Ælfred his brōþur wiþ alne ⁴ þone hēre on Æscesdūne.
10 Qnd hīe wārun ⁵ on twām gefylcum: on oþrum wæs
11 Bāchsecg qnd Halfdene þā hāþnan cyningas, qnd on
12 oþrum wāron þā eorlas. Qnd þā gefeaht sē cyning
13 Æþered wiþ þāra cyninga getuman, qnd þær wearþ sē
14 cyning Bāgsecg ofslægen; qnd Ælfred his brōþur wiþ
15 þāra eorla getuman, qnd þær wearþ Sidroc eorl ofslægen
16 sē alda, ⁶ qnd Sidroc eorl sē gioncga, ⁷ qnd Ōsbearn eorl,
17 qnd Fræna eorl, qnd Hareld eorl; qnd þā hērgas ⁸ bēgen
18 gefliemde, qnd fela þūsenda ofslægenra, qnd onfeohende
19 wāron oþ niht.

20 Qnd þæs ymb xiiii niht gefeaht Æþered cyning qnd
21 Ælfred his brōður wiþ þone hēre æt Basengum, qnd þær
22 þa Dēniscan sige nāmon.

23 Qnd þæs ymb ii mōnaþ gefeaht Æþered cyning qnd
24 Ælfred his brōþur wiþ þone hēre æt Mēretūne, qnd hīe
25 wārun on tuām ⁹ gefylcium, qnd hīe bütū gefliemdon, qnd
26 lōnge on dæg sige āhton; qnd þær wearþ micel wælsliht
27 on gehwæpere hōnd; qnd þā Dēniscan āhton wælstōwe
1 gewald; qnd þær wearþ Hēahmund bisceop ofslægen,
2 qnd fela gōdra mōnna. Qnd æfter þissum gefeohte cuōm ¹
3 micel sumorlida.

4 Qnd þæs ofer Ēastron gefōr Æþered cyning; qnd hē
 5 rīcsode v gēar; qnd his līc līþ æt Wīnburnan.
 6 Þā fēng Ælfred Æþelwulfing his brōþur tō Wesseaxna
 7 rīce. Qnd þæs ymb ānne mōnaþ gefeaht Ælfred cyning
 8 wiþ alne ⁴ þone hēre lýtla werede ¹⁰ æt Wiltūne, qnd hine
 9 lōnge on dæg gefliemde, qnd þā Dēniscan āhton wælstōwe
 10 gewald.
 11 Qnd þæs gēares wurden viiii folcgefeht gefohten wiþ
 12 þone hēre on þȳ cynerīce be sūþan Tēmese, būtan þām þe
 13 him Ælfred þæs cyninges brōþur qnd ānlīpig aldormōn ² qnd
 14 cyninges þegnas oft rāde onridon þe mōn nā ne rīmde;
 15 qnd þæs gēares wærun ⁵ ofslægene viiii eorlas qnd ān cyning.
 16 Qnd þȳ gēare nāmon Westseaxe friþ wiþ þone hēre.

100.8. gefeaht. Notice that the singular is used. This is the more common construction in O.E. when a compound subject, composed of singular members, follows its predicate. Cf. *For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory*. See also p. 107, note on **wæs**.

100.18. qnd fela þūsenda ofslægenra, and there were many thousands of slain (§ 91).

101.12. būtan þām þe, etc., besides which, Alfred ... made raids against them (**him**), which were not counted. See § 70, Note.

CONSULT GLOSSARY AND PARADIGMS UNDER FORMS GIVEN BELOW.

No note is made of such variants as **y** (ȳ) or **i** (ī) for **ie** (īe); occurrences, also, of **and** for **qnd**, **land** for **lōnd**, are found on almost every page of Early West Saxon. Such words should be sought for under the more common forms, **qnd**, **lōnd**.

¹ = cwōm.

² = ealdormōn.

³ = brōþor.

- 4 = ealne.
5 = wæron.
6 = ealda.
7 = geonga.
8 = heƿas.
9 = twæm.
10 = werode.

II. A PRAYER OF KING ALFRED.

[With this characteristic prayer, Alfred concludes his translation of Boëthius's *Consolation of Philosophy*. Unfortunately, the only extant MS. (Bodleian 180) is Late West Saxon. I follow, therefore, Prof. A. S. Cook's normalization on an Early West Saxon basis. See Cook's *First Book in Old English*, p. 163.]

1 Dryhten, ælmihtiga God, Wyrhta and Wealdend ealra
2 gesceafta, ic bidde ðē for ðīnre miclan mildheortnesse,
3 and for ðære hālgan rōde tēcne, and for Sanctæ Marian
4 mægðhāde, and for Sancti Michaeles gehīersumnesse, and
5 for ealra ðīnra hālgena lufan and hīera earnungum, ðæt
6 ðū mē gewissie bēð ðonne ic āworhte tō ðē; and gewissa
7 mē tō ðīnum willan, and tō mīnre sāwle ðearfe, bēð ðonne
8 ic self cunne; and gestaðela mīn mōd tō ðīnum willan and
9 tō mīnre sāwle ðearfe; and gestranga mē wið ðæs dēofles
10 costnungum; and āfierr fram mē ðā fūlan gālnesse and
11 ælce unrihtwīsnesse; and gescield mē wið mīnum wiðerwinnum,
12 gesewenlīcum and ungesewenlīcum; and tēc mē
13 ðīnne willan tō wyrceanne; ðæt ic mæge ðē inweardlice
14 lufian tōforan eallum ðīngum, mid clānum geðance and
15 mid clānum līchaman. For ðon ðe ðū eart mīn Scieppend,
16 and mīn Alīesend, mīn Fultum, mīn Frōfor, mīn Trēownes,
17 and mīn Tōhopa. Sīe ðē lof and wuldor nū and
18 ā ā ā, tō worulde būtan æghwīlcum ende. Amen.

102.3-4. **Marian ... Michaelles**. O.E. is inconsistent in the treatment of foreign names. They are sometimes naturalized, and sometimes retain in part their original inflections. **Marian**, an original accusative, is here used as a genitive; while **Michaelles** has the O.E. genitive ending.

102.17. **Sīe ðē lof**. See § 105, 1.

III. THE VOYAGES OF OHTHERE AND WULFSTAN.

[Lauderdale and Cottonian MSS. These voyages are an original insertion by Alfred into his translation of Orosius's *Compendious History of the World*.

"They consist," says Ten Brink, "of a complete description of all the countries in which the Teutonic tongue prevailed at Alfred's time, and a full narrative of the travels of two voyagers, which the king wrote down from their own lips. One of these, a Norwegian named Ohthere, had quite circumnavigated the coast of Scandinavia in his travels, and had even penetrated to the White Sea; the other, named Wulfstan, had sailed from Schleswig to Frische Haff. The geographical and ethnographical details of both accounts are exceedingly interesting, and their style is attractive, clear, and concrete."

Ohthere made two voyages. Sailing first northward along the western coast of Norway, he rounded the North Cape, passed into the White Sea, and entered the Dwina River (**ān micel ēa**). On his second voyage he sailed southward along the western coast of Norway, entered the Skager Rack (**wīdsæ**), passed through the Cattegat, and anchored at the Danish port of Haddeby (**æt Hæþum**), modern Schleswig.

Wulfstan sailed only in the Baltic Sea. His voyage of seven days from Schleswig brought him to Drausen (**Trūsō**) on the shore of the Drausensea.]

Ohthere's First Voyage.

1 Ōthere sǣde his hlāforde, Ælfrede cyninge, þæt hē
2 ealra Norðmōnna norþmest būde. Hē cwæð þæt hē būde
3 on þāem lande norþweardum wip þā Westsæ. Hē sǣde
4 þēah þæt þæt land sīe swīpe lang norþ þonan; ac hit is

5 eal wēste, būton on fēawum stōwum styccemælum wīciað
6 Finnas, on huntoðe on wintra, qnd on sumera on fiscapē
7 be þære sǣ. Hē sǣde þæt hē æt sumum cirre wolde
8 fandian hū lōnge þæt land norþryhte lǣge, oþþe hwæðer
9 ænig mōn be norðan þæm wēstenne būde. Ðā fōr hē
10 norþryhte be þæm lande: lēt him ealne weg þæt wēste
11 land on ðæt stēorbord, qnd þā wīdsǣ on ðæt bæcbord þrīe
12 dagas. Ðā wæs hē swā feor norþ swā þā hwælhuntan
13 firrest farap. Ðā fōr hē þā gīet norþryhte swā feor swā
14 hē meahte on þæm oþrum þrīm dagum gesiglan. Ðā bēag
15 þæt land þær ēastryhte, oþþe sēo sǣ in on ðæt lōnd, hē
16 nysse hwæðer, būton hē wisse ðæt hē ðær bād westanwindes
17 qnd hwōn norþan, qnd siglde ðā ēast be lande
18 swā swā hē meahte on fēower dagum gesiglan. Ðā
19 sceolde hē ðær bīdan ryhtnorþanwindes, for ðæm þæt
20 land bēag þær sūþryhte, oþþe sēo sǣ in on ðæt land, hē
21 nysse hwæþer. Ðā siglde hē þōnan sūðryhte be lande
1 swā swā hē mehte ¹ on fīf dagum gesiglan. Ðā læg þær
2 ān micel ēa ūp in on þæt land. Ðā cirdon hīe ūp in on
3 ðā ēa, for þæm hīe ne dorston forþ bī þære ēa siglan for
4 unfriþe; for þæm ðæt land wæs eall gebūn on oþre healfe
5 þære ēas. Ne mētte hē ær nān gebūn land, siþþan hē
6 frōm his āgnum hām fōr; ac him wæs ealne weg wēste
7 land on þæt stēorbord, būtan fiscerum qnd fugelerum ōnd
8 huntum, qnd þæt wæron eall Finnas; qnd him wæs ā
9 wīdsǣ on ðæt bæcbord. Ðā Beormas hæfdon swīþe wel
10 gebūd hira land: ac hīe ne dorston þær on cuman. Ac
11 þāra Terfinna land wæs eal wēste, būton ðær huntan
12 gewīcodon, oþþe fisceras, oþþe fugeleras.

13 Fela spella him sǣdon þā Beormas ægþer ge of hiera
14 āgnum lande ge of þæm landum þe ymb hīe ūtan wæron;
15 ac hē nyste hwæt þæs sōþes wæs, for þæm hē hit self ne

16 geseah. Ðā Finnas, him þūhte, ʒnd þā Beormas spræcon
17 nēah ān ɡeþēode. Swīpost hē fōr ðider, tō ēacan þæs
18 landes scēawunge, for þām horshwælum, for ðām hīe
19 habbað swīþe æþele bān on hiora ² tōþum—þā tēð hīe brōhton
20 sume þām cyninge—ʒnd hiora hȳd bið swīðe ɡōd tō
21 sciprāpum. Sē hwæl bið micle læssa þonne oðre hwalas:
22 ne bið hē lengra ðonne syfan ³ ʒlna lang; ac on his āɡnum
23 lande is sē bētsta hwælhuntað: þā bēoð eahta and fēowertiges
24 ʒlna lange, and þā mæstan fiftiges ʒlna lange;
25 þāra hē sāde þæt hē syxa sum ofslōge syxtig on twām
26 dagum.

1 Hē wæs swȳðe spēdig man on þām æhtum þe heora ²
2 spēda on bēoð, þæt is, on wil drum. Hē hæfde þā ɡȳt, ðā
3 hē þone cyningc ⁵ sōhte, tamra dēora unbebohtra syx hund.
4 Ðā dēor hī hātað ‘hrānas’; þāra wæron syx stælrānas;
5 ðā bēoð swȳðe dȳre mid Finnum, for ðām hȳ fōð þā
6 wildan hrānas mid. Hē wæs mid þām fyrstum mannum
7 on þām lande: næfde hē þēah mā ðonne twēntig hrȳðera,
8 and twēntig scēapa, and twēntig swȳna; and þæt lȳtle
9 þæt hē ʒrede, hē ʒrede mid horsan. ⁴ Ac hyra ār is mæst
10 on þām gafole þe ðā Finnas him ɡylðað. Þæt gafol bið
11 on dēora fellum, and on fugela feðerum, and hwales bāne,
12 and on þām sciprāpum þe bēoð of hwæles hȳde ɡeworht
13 and of sēoles. Æghwilc ɡylt be hys ɡebyrdum. Sē byrdesta
14 sceall ɡyldan fiftȳne mearðes fell, and fīf hrānes,
15 and ān beren fel, and tȳn ambra feðra, and berenne kyrtel
16 oððe yterenne, and twēgen sciprāpas; æɡþer sȳ syxtig
17 ʒlna lang, oþer sȳ of hwæles hȳde ɡeworht, oþer of sīoles. ⁶

18 Hē sāde ðæt Norðmanna land wære swȳþe lang and
19 swȳðe smæl. Eal þæt his man āðer oððe ʒttan oððe ʒrian
20 mæg, þæt līð wið ðā sē; and þæt is þēah on sumum

21 stōwum swyðe clūdig; and licgað wilde mōras wið ēastan
22 and wið ūpp on emnlange þāem bȳnum lande. On þāem
23 mōrum eardiað Finnas. And þæt bȳne land is ēasteward
24 brādost, and symle swā norðor swā smælre. Ēastewerð ⁷
25 hit mæg bīon ⁸ syxtig mīla brād, oþpe hwēne brædre;
26 and middeward þrītig oððe brædre; and norðeward hē
27 cwæð, þær hit smalost wære, þæt hit mihte bēon þrēora
28 mīla brād tō þāem mōre; and sē mōr syðþan, ⁹ on sumum
1 stōwum, swā brād swā man mæg on twām wucum oferfēran;
2 and on sumum stōwum swā brād swā man mæg
3 on syx dagum oferfēran.

4 Ðonne is tōemnes þāem lande sūðewardum, on oðre
5 healfe þæs mōres, Swēoland, oþ þæt land norðeward;
6 and tōemnes þāem lande norðewardum, Cwēna land. Þā
7 Cwēnas hergiað hwīlum on ðā Norðmen ofer ðone mōr,
8 hwīlum þā Norðmen on hȳ. And þær sint swīðe micle
9 mēras fersce geond þā mōras; and berað þā Cwēnas hyra
10 scypu ofer land on ðā mēras, and þanon hergiað on ðā
11 Norðmen; hȳ habbað swyðe lȳtle scypa and swyðe
12 leohte.

104.6. frōm his āgnum hām. An adverbial dative singular without an inflectional ending is found with **hām, dæg, morgen,** and **æfen**.

104.8. ʒnd þæt wāron. See § 40, Note 3.

104.15. hwæt þæs sōpes wæs. Sweet errs in explaining **sōpes** as attracted into the genitive by **þæs**. It is not a predicate adjective, but a partitive genitive after **hwæt**.

104.25. syxa sum. See § 91, Note 2.

105.2. on bēoð. See § 94, (5).

105.19. **Eal þæt his man.** Pronominal genitives are not always possessive in O.E.; **his** is here the partitive genitive of **hit**, the succeeding relative pronoun being omitted: *All that (portion) of it that may, either-of-the-two, either be grazed or plowed*, etc. (§ 70, Note).

106.11-12. **scypa ... leohte.** These words exhibit inflections more frequent in Late than in Early West Saxon. The normal forms would be **scypu**, **leoht**; but in Late West Saxon the **-u** of short-stemmed neuters is generally replaced by **-a**; and the nominative accusative plural neuter of adjectives takes, by analogy, the masculine endings; **hwate**, **gōde**, **hālge**, instead of **hwatu**, **gōd**, **hālg**.

1 = meahte, mihte.

2 = hiera.

3 = seofon.

4 = horsum.

5 = cyning.

6 = sēoles.

7 = -weard.

8 = bēon.

9 = siððan.

Ohthere's Second Voyage.

13 Ōhthere sǣde þæt sīo 1 scīr hātte Hālgoland, þe hē on
14 būde. Hē cwæð þæt nān man ne būde be norðan him.
15 Þonne is ān port on sūðewardum þāem lande, þone man
16 hǣt Sciringeshēal. Þyder hē cwæð þæt man ne mihte
17 geseglian on ānum mōnðe, gyf man on niht wīcode, and
18 ælce dæge hæfde ambyrne wind; and ealle ðā hwīle hē
19 sceal seglian be lande. And on þæt stēorbord him bið

20 ærest Īraland, and þonne ðā īgland þe synd betux Īralande
 21 and þissum lande. Þonne is þis land, oð hē cymð
 22 tō Sciringeshēale, and ealne weg on þæt bæcbord Norðweg.
 1 Wið sūðan þone Sciringeshēal fylð swyðe mycel
 2 sǣ ūp in on ðæt land; sēo is brādre þonne ænig man ofer
 3 sēon mæge. And is Gotland on oðre healfe ongēan, and
 4 siððan Sillende. Sēo sǣ līð mænig ² hund mīla ūp in on
 5 þæt land.
 6 And of Sciringeshēale hē cwæð ðæt hē seglode on fif
 7 dagan ³ tō þāem porte þe mōn hǣt æt Hǣþum; sē stent
 8 betuh Winedum, and Seaxum, and Angle, and hȳrð in
 9 on Dene. Ðā hē þiderweard seglode fram Sciringeshēale,
 10 þā wæs him on þæt bæcbord Denamearc and on
 11 þæt stēorbord wīdsǣ þrȳ dagas; and þā, twēgen dagas ær
 12 hē tō Hǣþum cōme, him wæs on þæt stēorbord Gotland,
 13 and Sillende, and īglanda fela. On þāem landum eardodon
 14 Engle, ær hī hider on land cōman. ⁴ And hym wæs
 15 ðā twēgen dagas on ðæt bæcbord þā īgland þe in on
 16 Dēnemeorce hȳrað.

107.7. æt Hǣþum. “This pleonastic use of *æt* with names of places occurs elsewhere in the older writings, as in the Chronicle (552), ‘in þære stōwe þe is genemned æt Searobyrg,’ where the *æt* has been erased by some later hand, showing that the idiom had become obsolete. Cp. the German ‘Gasthaus zur Krone,’ Stamboul = *es tǣn pólin*.” (Sweet.) See, also, *Atterbury*, § 28, Note 3.

107.14-15. wæs ... þā īgland. The singular predicate is due again to inversion (p. 100, note on **gefeah**). The construction is comparatively rare in O.E., but frequent in Shakespeare and in the popular speech of to-day. Cf.

There is, Here is, There has been, etc., with a (single) plural subject following.

1 = sēo.

2 = mōnig.

3 = dagum.

4 = cōmen.

Wulfstan's Voyage.

17 Wulfstān sǣde þæt hē gefōre of Hǣðum, þæt hē wære
18 on Trūsō on syfan dagum and nihtum, þæt þæt scip wæs
19 ealne weg yrnende under segle. Weonoðland him wæs
1 on stēorbord, and on bæcbord him wæs Langaland, and
2 Lǣland, and Falster, and Scōnēg; and þās land eall
3 hýrað tō Dēnemearcan. And þonne Burgenda land wæs
4 ūs on bæcbord, and þā habbað him sylfe ¹ cyning. Þonne
5 æfter Burgenda lande wæron ūs þās land, þā synd hātene
6 ærest Blēcinga-ēg, and Mēore, and Ēowland, and Gotland
7 on bæcbord; and þās land hýrað tō Swēom. And Weonodland
8 wæs ūs ealne weg on stēorbord oð Wīslēmūðan.
9 Sēo Wīslē is swýðe mycel ēa, and hīo ² tōlīð Wītland and
10 Weonodland; and þæt Wītland belimpeð tō Estum; and
11 sēo Wīslē līð ūt of Weonodlande, and līð in Estmēre;
12 and sē Estmēre is hūru fīftēne ³ mīla brād. Þonne cymeð
13 Ilfing ēastan in Estmēre of ðām mēre, ðe Trūsō standeð
14 in stæðe; and cumað ūt samod in Estmēre, Ilfing ēastan
15 of Estlande, and Wīslē sūðan of Winodlande. And
16 þonne benimð Wīslē Ilfing hire naman, and ligeð of þām
17 mēre west and norð on sǣ; for ðý hit man hǣt
18 Wīslēmūða.
19 Þæt Estland is swýðe mycel, and þær bið swýðe manig

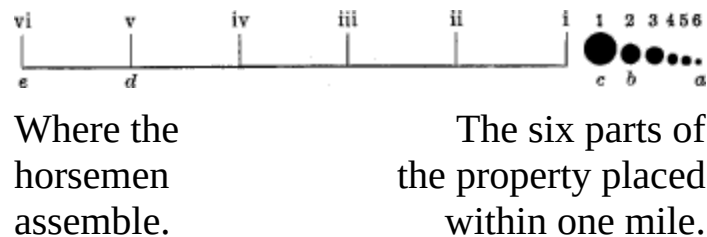
20 burh, and on ælcere byrig bið cyning. And þær bið
21 swýðe mycel hunig, and fiscnað; and sē cyning and þā
22 rīcostan men drincað mýran meolc, and þā unspēdigan
23 and þā þēowan drincað medo. ⁴ Þær bið swýðe mycel
24 gewinn betwēonan him. And ne bið ðær nænig ealo ⁵
25 gebrowen mid Estum, ac þær bið medo genōh. And þær
26 is mid Estum ðēaw, þonne þær bið man dēad, þæt hē lið
27 inne unforbærned mid his māgum and frēondum mōnað,
28 ge hwīlum twēgen; and þā cyningas, and þā oðre hēahðungene
29 men, swā micle lencg ⁶ swā hī māran spēda
30 habbað, hwīlum healf gēar þæt hī bēoð unforbærned, and
1 licgað bufan eorðan on hyra hūsum. And ealle þā hwīle
2 þe þæt līc bið inne, þær sceal bēon gedrync and plega,
3 oð ðone dæg þe hī hine forbærnað. Þonne þȳ ylcan dæge
4 þe hī hine tō þām āde beran wyllað, þonne tōdælað hī
5 his feoh, þæt þær tō lāfe bið æfter þām gedrynce and þām
6 plegan, on fīf oððe syx, hwȳlum on mā, swā swā þæs fēos
7 andēfn bið. Alēcgað hit ðonne forhwæga on ānre mīle
8 þone mæstan dæl fram þām tūne, þonne oðerne, ðonne
9 þone þridan, oþ þe hyt eall ālēd bið on þære ānre mīle;
10 and sceall bēon sē læsta dæl nȳhst þām tūne ðe sē dēada
11 man on lið. Þonne sceolon ⁷ bēon gesamnode ealle ðā
12 menn ðe swyftoste hors habbað on þām lande, forhwæga
13 on fīf mīlum oððe on syx mīlum fram þām fēo. Þonne
14 ærnað hȳ ealle tōweard þām fēo: ðonne cymeð sē man
15 sē þæt swiftoste hors hafað tō þām ærestan dæle and tō
16 þām mæstan, and swā ælc æfter oðrum, oþ hit bið eall
17 genumen; and sē nimð þone læstan dæl sē nȳhst þām
18 tūne þæt feoh gærneð. And þonne rīdeð ælc hys weges
19 mid ðām fēo, and hyt mōtan ⁸ habban eall; and for ðȳ
20 þær bēoð þā swiftan hors ungefōge dȳre. And þonne his
21 gestreōn bēoð þus eall āspēnded, þonne byrð man hine ūt,

22 and forbærneð mid his wāpnum and hrægle; and swīðost
 1 ealle hys spēda hȳ forspendað mid þāem langan legere
 2 þæs dēadan mannes inne, and þæs þe hȳ be þāem wegum
 3 ālēcgað, þe ðā frēmdan tō ærnað, and nimað. And þæt
 4 is mid Estum þēaw þæt þær sceal ælces geðēodes man
 5 bēon forbærned; and gyf þār ⁹ man ān bān findeð unforbærned,
 6 hī hit sceolan ⁷ miclum gebētan. And þær is mid
 7 Estum ān mægð þæt hī magon cyle gewyrca; and þȳ
 8 þær licgað þā dēadan men swā lange, and ne fūliað, þæt
 9 hȳ wyrcað þone cyle him on. And þēah man āsette
 10 twēgen fāetels full ealað oððe wāteres, hȳ gedōð þæt
 11 æghper bið oferfrozen, sam hit sȳ sumor sam winter.

108.1-4. **him ... ūs.** Note the characteristic change of person, the transition from *indirect* to *direct discourse*.

109.2. **sceal.** See § 137, Note 2 (2).

109.7. **Ālēcgað hit.** Bosworth illustrates thus:



“The horsemen assemble five or six miles from the property, at *d* or *e*, and run towards *c*; the man who has the swiftest horse, coming first to 1 or *c*, takes the first and largest part. The man who has the horse coming second takes part 2 or *b*, and so, in succession, till the least part, 6 or *a*, is taken.”

Text version of illustration

110.5-6. **man ... hī**. Here the plural **hī** refers to the singular **man**. Cf. p. 109, ll. 18-19, **ǣlc ... mōtan**. In *Exodus* xxxii, 24, we find “Whosoever hath any gold, let *them* break it off”; and Addison writes, “I do not mean that I think *anyone* to blame for taking due care of *their* health.” The construction, though outlawed now, has been common in all periods of our language. Paul remarks (*Prinzipien der Sprachgeschichte*, 3d ed., § 186) that “When a word is used as an indefinite [one, man, somebody, etc.] it is, strictly speaking, incapable of any distinction of number. Since, however, in respect of the external form, a particular number has to be chosen, it is a matter of indifference which this is.... Hence a change of numbers is common in the different languages.” Paul fails to observe that the change is always from singular to plural, not from plural to singular. See *Note on the Concord of Collectives and Indefinites* (Anglia XI, 1901). See p. 119, note on ll. 19-21.

1 = selfe.

2 = hēo.

3 = fiftīene.

4 = medu.

5 = ealu.

6 = lęng.

7 = sculon.

8 = mōton.

9 = ðǣr.

IV. THE STORY OF CÆDMON.

[From the so-called Alfredian version of Bede's *Ecclesiastical History*. The text generally followed is that of MS. Bodley, Tanner 10. Miller (*Early English Text Society*, No. 95, *Introd.*) argues, chiefly from the use of the prepositions, that the original O.E. MS. was Mercian, composed possibly in Lichfield (Staffordshire). At any rate, O.E. idiom is frequently sacrificed to the Latin original.

“Cædmon, as he is called, is the first Englishman whose name we know who wrote poetry in our island of England; and the first to embody in verse the new passions and ideas which Christianity had brought into England.... Undisturbed by any previous making of lighter poetry, he came fresh to the work of Christianising English song. It was a great step to make. He built the chariot in which all the new religious emotions of England could now drive along.” (Brooke, *The History of Early English Literature*, cap. XV.) There is no reason to doubt the historical existence of Cædmon; for Bede, who relates the story, lived near Whitby, and was seven years old when Cædmon died (A.D. 680)].

- 1 In ðysse abbudissan mynstre wæs sum brōðor syndriglīce
- 2 mid godcundre gife gemæred qnd geweorðad, for þon
- 3 he gewunade gerisenlīce lēoð wyrcan, þā ðe tō æfēstnisse ¹
- 4 qnd tō ārfæstnisse belumpon; swā ðætte swā hwæt swā
- 5 hē of godcundum stafum þurh bōceras geleornode, þæt hē
- 6 æfter medmiclum fæce in scopgereorde mid þā mæstan
- 7 swētnisse qnd inbryrdnisse geglengde, qnd in Eṅgliscgereorde
- 8 wel geworht forþ brōhte. Qnd for his lēoþsṅgum
- 1 mōnigra mōnna mōd oft to worulde forhogdnisse qnd tō
- 2 geþēodnisse þæs heofonlīcan līfes onbærnde wæron. Qnd
- 3 ēac swelce ² mōnige oðre æfter him in Qngelþēode ongunnon
- 4 æfēste lēoð wyrcan, ac nænig hwæðre him þæt gelīce
- 5 dōn ne meahte; for þon hē nālæs frōm mōnnum nē ðurh
- 6 mōn gelæred wæs þæt hē ðone lēoðcræft leornade, ac hē
- 7 wæs godcundlīce gefultumod, qnd þurh Godes gife þone
- 8 sṅgcræft onfēng; qnd hē for ðon næfre nōht lēasunge,
- 9 nē īdles lēoþes wyrcan ne meahte, ac efne þā ān ðā ðe tō
- 10 æfēstnisse ¹ belumpon qnd his þā æfēstan tungan gedafenode
- 11 singan.
- 12 Wæs hē, sē mōn, in weoruldhāde ³ gesēted oð þā tīde þe
- 13 hē wæs gelyfdre ylde, qnd næfre nænig lēoð geleornade.

14 Qnd hē for þon oft in gebēorscipe, þonne þær wæs blisse
15 intinga gedēmed, þæt hēo ⁴ ealle sceolden þurh endebyrdnesse
16 be hearpan singan, þonne hē geseah þā hearpan him
17 nēalēcan, þonne ārās hē for scome frōm þām symble,
18 qnd hām ēode tō his hūse. Þā hē þæt þā sumre tīde
19 dyde, þæt hē forlēt þæt hūs þæs gebēorscipes, qnd ūt wæs
1 gongende tō nēata scipene, þāra heord him wæs þære
2 nihte beboden; þā hē ðā þær on gelimplīcre tīde his
3 leomu ⁵ on reſte geſette qnd onslēpte, þa stōd him sum
4 mōn æt þurh swefn, qnd hine hālette qnd grētte, qnd hine
5 be his nōman nemnde: “Cædmōn, sing mē hwæthwugu.”
6 Þā qndswarede hē, qnd cwæð: “Ne cōn ic nōht singan;
7 qnd ic for þon of þyssum gebēorscipe ūt ēode qnd hider
8 gewāt, for þon ic nāht singan ne cūðe.” Eft hē cwæð sē ðe
9 wið hine sprecende wæs: “Hwæðre þū meaht mē singan.”
10 Þā cwæð hē: “Hwæt sceal ic singan?” Cwæð hē: “Sing
11 mē frumsceaft.” Þā hē ðā þās andsware onfēng, þā
12 ongōn hē sōna singan, in herenesse Godes Scyppendes,
13 þā fers qnd þā word þe hē nāfre ne gehȳrde, þāra endebyrdnes
14 þis is:

15 Nū sculon herigea ⁶ heofonrīces Weard,
16 Metodes meahte qnd his mōdgeþanc,
17 weorc Wuldorfæder, swā hē wundra gehwæs,
18 ēce Drihten ōr onstealde.

1 Hē ærest scēop eorðan bearnum
2 heofon tō hrōfe, hālig Scyppend;
3 þā middangeard mōnncynnes Weard,
4 ēce Drihten, æfter tēode
5 fīrum foldan, Frēa ælmihtig.

6 Þā ārās hē frōm þām slæpe, qnd eal þā þe hē slæpende
7 sōng fæste in gemynde hæfde; qnd þām wordum sōna
8 mōnig word in þæt ilce gemet Gode wyrðes sōnges

9 tōgeþēodde. Ðā cōm hē on morgenne tō þāem tūngerēfan,
10 sē þe his ealdormōn wæs: sægde him hwylce gife hē
11 onfēng; qnd hē hine sōna tō þære abbudissan gelædde,
12 qnd hire þæt cȳðde qnd sægde. Ðā heht hēo gesōmnian
13 ealle þā gelæredestan mēn qnd þā leorneras, qnd him
14 qndweardum hēt sēcgan þæt swefn, qnd þæt lēoð singan,
15 þæt ealra heora ⁷ dōme gecoren wære, hwæt oððe hwōnan
16 þæt cumen wære. Ðā wæs him eallum gesewen, swā swā
17 hit wæs, þæt him wære frōm Drihtne sylfum heofonlīc
1 gifu forgifen. Ðā rehton heo ⁴ him qnd sægdon sum hālig
2 spell qnd godcundre lāre word: bebudon him þā, gif hē
3 meahte, þæt hē in swīnsunge lēopsonges þæt gehwyrfde.
4 Ðā hē ðā hæfde þā wīsan onfōngne, þā ēode hē hām tō
5 his hūse, qnd cwōm eft on morgenne, qnd þȳ bētan
6 lēoðe geglēnged him āsong qnd āgeaf þæt him beboden
7 wæs.

8 Ðā ongan sēo abbudisse clyppan qnd lufigean ⁸ þā Godes
9 gife in þāem mēn, qnd hēo hine þā mōnade qnd lārde
10 þæt hē woruldhād forlēte qnd munuchād onfēnge: qnd
11 hē þæt wel þafode. Qnd hēo hine in þæt mynster onfēng
12 mid his gōdum, qnd hine geþēodde tō gesōmnunge þāra
13 Godes þēowa, qnd heht hine lāran þæt getæl þæs hālgan
14 stāres qnd spelles. Qnd hē eal þā hē in gehȳrnesse
15 geleornian meahte, mid hine gemyndgade, qnd swā swā
16 clāne nēten ⁹ eodorcende in þæt swēteste lēoð gehwyrfde.
17 Qnd his song qnd his lēoð wæron swā wynsumu tō gehȳranne,
18 þætte þā seolfan ¹⁰ his lārēowas æt his mūðe writon
19 qnd leornodon. Song hē ārest be middangeardes gesceape,
20 qnd bī fruman mōncynnes, qnd eal þæt stār Genesis (þæt
21 is sēo āreste Moyses bōc); qnd eft bī ūtgōnge Israhēla
22 folces of Ægypta lōnde, qnd bī ingōnge þæs gehātlandes;
23 qnd bī oðrum mōnegum spellum þæs hālgan gewrites

1 canōnes bōca; qnd bī Crīstes mēnniscnesse, qnd bī his
2 prōwunge, qnd bī his ūpāstīgnesse in heofonas; qnd bī
3 þæs Hālgan Gāstes cyme, qnd þāra apostola lāre; qnd eft
4 bī þām dæge þæs tōweardan dōmes, qnd bī fyrhtu þæs
5 tintreglīcan wītes, qnd bī swētnesse þæs heofonlīcan rīces,
6 hē monig lēoð geworhte; qnd swelce ² ēac oðer mōnig be
7 þām godcundan fręsumnessum qnd dōmum hē geworhte.
8 In eallum þām hē geornlīce gēmd ¹¹ þæt hē mēn ātuge
9 frōm synna lufan qnd māndāda, qnd tō lufan qnd tō
10 geornfulnesse āwēhte gōdra dāda, for þon hē wæs, sē
11 mōn, swīpe æfēst qnd regollīcum þēodscipum ēaðmōdlīce
12 underþēoded; qnd wið þām þā ðe in oðre wīsan dōn woldon,
13 hē wæs mid welme ¹² micelre ellenwōdnisse onbærned.
14 Qnd hē for ðon fægre ende his līf betynde qnd geendade.

111.1. ðysse abbudissan. The abbess referred to is the famous Hild, or Hilda, then living in the monastery at Streones-halh, which, according to Bede, means “Bay of the Beacon.” The Danes afterward gave it the name Whitby, or “White Town.” The surroundings were eminently fitted to nurture England’s first poet. “The natural scenery which surrounded him, the valley of the Esk, on whose sides he probably lived, the great cliffs, the billowy sea, the vast sky seen from the heights over the ocean, played incessantly upon him.” (Brooke.)

Note, also, in this connection, the numerous Latin words that the introduction of Christianity (A.D. 597) brought into the vocabulary of O.E.: **abbudisse, mynster, bisceop, Lāden, prēost, æstel, mancus.**

112.4-5. The more usual order of words would be **ac nāenig, hwæðre, ne meahte ðæt dōn gelīce him.**

112.10-11. **ƿnd his ... singan**, and which it became his (the) pious tongue to sing.

112.14-15. **blisse intinga**, for the sake of joy; but the translator has confused *laetitia* *causā* (ablative) and *laetitia* *causa* (nominative). The proper form would be **for blisse** with omission of **intingan**, just as *for my sake* is usually **for mē**; *for his (or their) sake*, **for him**. Cf. Mark vi, 26: “Yet *for his oath’s sake, and for their sakes which sat with him*, he would not reject her,” **for ðāem āðe, ƿnd for ðāem þe him mid sǣton**. *For his sake* is frequently **for his ðingon (ðingum)**, rarely **for his intingan**. **Þingon** is regularly used when the preceding genitive is a noun denoting a person: *for my wife’s sake*, **for mīnes wīfes ðingon** (*Genesis* xx, 11), etc.

112.18-19. **þæt ... þæt hē forlēt**. The substantival clause introduced by the second **þæt** amplifies by apposition the first **þæt**: *When he then, at a certain time (instrumental case, § 98, (2)), did that, namely, when he left the house*. The better Mn.E. would be *this ... that*: “Added yet *this* above all, *that* he shut up John in prison” (*Luke* iv, 20).

113.1-2. **þāra ... beboden**. This does not mean that Cædmon was a herdsman, but that he served in turn as did the other secular attendants at the monastery.

113.13-14. **þāra ƿndebyrdnes þis is**. Bede writes *Hic est sensus, non autem ordo ipse verborum*, and gives in Latin prose a translation of the hymn from the Northumbrian dialect, in which Cædmon wrote. The O.E. version given above is, of course, not the Northumbrian original (which, however, with some variations is preserved in several of the Latin MSS. of

Bede's *History*), but a West Saxon version made also from the Northumbrian, not from the Latin.

113.15. **Nū sculon herigean**, *Now ought we to praise*.

The subject **wē** is omitted in the best MSS. Note the characteristic use of synonyms, or epithets, in this bit of O.E. poetry. Observe that it is not the *thought* that is repeated, but rather the *idea*, the *concept*, God. See p. 124.

113.17. **wundra gehwæs**. See p. 140, note on **cēnra gehwylcum**.

114.7-9. **ꝥnd þāem wordum ... tōgeþēodde**, *and to those words he soon joined, in the same meter, many (other) words of song worthy of God*. But the translator has not only blundered over Bede's Latin (*eis mox plura in eundem modum verba Deo digna carminis adjunxit*), but sacrificed still more the idiom of O.E. The predicate should not come at the end; **in** should be followed by the dative; and for **Gode wyrðes sɔnges** the better O.E. would be **sɔnges Godes wyrðes**. When used with the dative **wyrð** (**weorð**) usually means *dear* (= *of worth*) *to*.

114.16. **þā ... gesewen**. We should expect **frɔm him eallum**; but the translator has again closely followed the Latin (*visumque est omnibus*), as later (in the *Conversion of Edwin*) he renders *Talis mihi videtur* by **þyslīc mē is gesewen**. *Talis* (**þyslīc**) agreeing with a following *vita* (**līf**). Ælfric, however, with no Latin before him, writes that John **wearð ðā him [= frɔm Drihtene] inweardlīce gelufod**. It would seem that in proportion as a past participle has the force of an adjective, the *to* relation may supplant the *by* relation; just as we say *unknown to* instead of *unknown by*,

unknown being more adjectival than participial.

Gesewen, therefore, may here be translated *visible*, *evident*, *patent* (= **gesynelīc**, **sweotol**); and **gelufod**, *dear* (= **weorð**, **lēof**).

A survival of adjectival **gesewen** is found in Wycliffe's *New Testament* (1 Cor. xv, 5-8): "He was *seyn to* Cephas, and aftir these thingis *to* enleuene; aftirward he was *seyn to* mo than fyue hundrid britheren togidere ... aftirward he was *seyn to* James, and aftirward *to* alle the apostlis. And last of alle he was *seyn to* me, as *to* a deed borun child." The construction is frequent in Chaucer.

115.9-10. ƿnd hēo hine ƿā mōnade ... munuchād onfēnge. Hild's advice has in it the suggestion of a personal experience, for she herself had lived half of her life (thirty-three years) "before," says Bede, "she dedicated the remaining half to our Lord in a monastic life."

116.6. hē mōnig lēoð geworhte. The opinion is now gaining ground that of these "many poems" only the short hymn, already given, has come down to us. Of other poems claimed for Cædmon, the strongest arguments are advanced in favor of a part of the fragmentary poetical paraphrase of *Genesis*.

1 = æfæstnesse.

2 = swilce.

3 = woruldhāde.

4 = hīe.

5 = limu.

6 = heƿian.

7 = hiera.

8 = lufian.

9 = nīeten.

10 = selfan.

11 = gīemde.

12 = wielme.

V. ALFRED'S PREFACE TO THE PASTORAL CARE.

[Based on the Hatton MS. Of the year 597, the *Chronicle* says: "In this year, Gregory the Pope sent into Britain Augustine with very many monks, who gospelled [preached] God's word to the English folk." Gregory I, surnamed "The Great," has ever since been considered the apostle of English Christianity, and his *Pastoral Care*, which contains instruction in conduct and doctrine for all bishops, was a work that Alfred could not afford to leave untranslated. For this translation Alfred wrote a *Preface*, the historical value of which it would be hard to overrate. In it he describes vividly the intellectual ruin that the Danes had wrought, and develops at the same time his plan for repairing that ruin.

This *Preface* and the *Battle of Ashdown* (p. 99) show the great king in his twofold character of warrior and statesman, and justify the inscription on the base of the statue erected to him in 1877, at Wantage (Berkshire), his birth-place: "Ælfred found Learning dead, and he restored it; Education neglected, and he revived it; the laws powerless, and he gave them force; the Church debased, and he raised it; the Land ravaged by a fearful Enemy, from which he delivered it. Ælfred's name will live as long as mankind shall respect the Past."]

1 Ælfred kyning hāteð grētan Wærferð biscep ¹ his wordum
2 luflīce qnd frēondlīce; qnd ðē cȳðan hāte ðæt mē cōm
3 swīðe oft on gemynd, hwelce ² witan iū ³ wæron giond ⁴
4 Angelcynn, ægðer ge godcundra hāda ge woruldcundra;
5 qnd hū gesæliglīca tīda ðā wæron giond Angelcynn; qnd
6 hū ðā kyningas ðe ðone onwald hæfdon ðæs folces on
7 ðām dagum Gode qnd his ærendwrecum hērsumedon ⁵;
8 qnd hū hīe ægðer ge hiora sibbe ge hiora siodo ⁶ ge hiora
9 onweald innanbordes gehīoldon, ⁴ qnd ēac ūt hiora ēðel
10 gerȳmdon; qnd hū him ðā spēow ægðer ge mid wīge ge
11 mid wīsdōme; qnd ēac ða godcundan hādas hū giorne
12 hīe wæron ægðer ge ymb lāre ge ymb liornunga, ge ymb
13 ealle ðā ðīowotdōmas ðe hīe Gode dōn scoldon; qnd hū

14 man ūtanbordes wīsdōm qnd lāre hieder on lōnd sōhte,
15 qnd hū wē hīe nū sceoldon ūte begietan, gif wē hīe habban
16 sceoldon. Swā ⁷ clāne hīo wæs oðfeallenu on Angelcynne
17 ðæt swīðe fēawa wæron behionan Humbre ðe hiora ðēninga
18 cūðen understōndan on Ēnglisc oððe furðum ān āerendgewrit
19 of Lādene on Ēnglisc āreccan; qnd ic wēne ðætte
20 nōht mōnige begiōndan Humbre nāren. Swā ⁷ fēawa
21 hiora wæron ðæt ic furðum āne ānlēpne ⁸ ne mæg geðencean
1 be sūðan Tēmese, ðā ðā ic tō rīce fēng. Gode ælmihtegum
2 sīe ðqnc ðætte wē nū ænigne onstāl habbað
3 lārēowa. Qnd for ðon ic ðē bebīode ðæt ðū dō swā ⁷ ic
4 gelīefe ðæt ðū wille, ðæt ðū ðē ðissa worulddōinga tō ðām
5 geāmetige, swā ðū oftost mæge, ðæt ðū ðone wīsdōm ðe
6 ðē God sealde ðær ðær ðū hiene befæstan mæge, befæste.
7 Geðenc hwelc ⁹ wītu ūs ðā becōmon for ðisse worulde, ðā
8 ðā wē hit nōhwæðer nē selfe ne lufodon, nē ēac oðrum
9 mōnnum ne lēfdon ¹⁰: ðone naman āne wē lufodon ðætte
10 wē Crīstne wæren, qnd swīðe fēawe ðā ðēawas.

11 Ðā ic ðā ðis eall gemunde, ðā gemunde ic ēac hū ic
12 geseah, ær ðām ðe hit eall forhergod wære qnd forbærned,
13 hū ðā ciricean giond eall Angelcynn stōdon
14 māðma qnd bōca gefylda, qnd ēac micel mēnigeo ¹¹ Godes
15 ðīowa; qnd ðā swīðe lýtle fiorme ðāra bōca wiston, for
16 ðām ðe hīe hiora nānwuht ¹² ongietan ne meahton, for
17 ðām ðe hīe næron on hiora āgen geðīode awritene.
18 Swelce ¹³ hīe cwæden: “Ure ieldran, ðā ðe ðās stōwa ær
19 hīoldon, hīe lufodon wīsdōm, qnd ðurh ðone hīe begēaton
20 welan, qnd ūs lēfdon. Hēr mōn mæg gīet gesīon hiora
21 swæð, ac wē him ne cunnon æfter spyrigeon, ¹⁴ qnd for
22 ðām wē habbað nū ægðer forlāten ge ðone welan ge ðone
23 wīsdōm, for ðām ðe wē noldon tō ðām spore mid ūre
24 mōde onlūtan.”

25 Ðā ic ðā ðis eall gemunde, ðā wundrade ic swīðe swīðe
26 ðāra gōdena wiotona ¹⁵ ðe gīu wæron giond Angelcynn, qnd
27 ðā bēc ealla be fullan geliornod hæfdon, ðæt hīe hiora ðā
1 nænne dæl noldon on hiora āgen geðīode wendan. Ac
2 ic ðā sōna eft mē selfum andwyrde, qnd cwæð: “Hīe ne
3 wēndon þætte æfre mēnn sceolden swæ ⁷ reccelease weorðan,
4 qnd sīo lār swæ oðfeallan; for ðære wilnunga hīe
5 hit forlēton, qnd woldon ðæt hēr ðȳ māra wīsdōm on
6 londe wære ðȳ wē mā geðēoda cūðon.”

7 Ðā gemunde ic hū sīo æ wæs ærest on Ebrēisc geðīode
8 funden, qnd eft, ðā hīe Crēacas geliornodon, ðā wendon
9 hīe hīe on hiora āgen geðīode ealle, qnd ēac ealle oðre
10 bēc. Qnd eft Lædenware swæ same, siððan hīe hīe geliornodon,
11 hīe hīe wendon ealla ðurh wīse wealhstōdas
12 on hiora āgen geðīode. Qnd ēac ealla oðra Crīstena
13 ðīoda sumne dæl hiora on hiora āgen geðīode wendon.
14 For ðȳ mē ðyncð bētre, gif īow swæ ðyncð, ðæt wē ēac
15 suma bēc, ðā ðe nīedbeðearfosta sīen eallum mōnnum
16 tō wiotonne, ¹⁶ ðæt wē ðā on ðæt geðīode wenden ðe wē
17 ealle gecnāwan mægen, qnd gedōn swæ wē swīðe ēaðe
18 magon mid Godes fultume, gif wē ðā stilnesse habbað,
19 ðætte eall sīo gioguð ðe nū is on Angelcynne friora
20 mōnna, ðāra ðe ðā spēda hæbben ðæt hīe ðæm befēolan
21 mægen, sīen tō liornunga oðfæste, ðā hwīle ðe hīe tō
1 nānre oðerre note ne mægen, oð ðone first ðe hīe wel
2 cunnen Ęnglisc gewrit ārædan: lære mōn siððan furður
3 on Lædengeðīode ðā ðe mōn furðor lāran wille, qnd tō
4 hīerran hāde dōn wille. Ðā ic ðā gemunde hū sīo lār
5 Lædengeðīodes ær ðissum āfeallen wæs giond Angelcynn,
6 qnd ðeah mōnige cūðon Ęnglisc gewrit ārædan, ðā
7 ongan ic ongemang oðrum mislīcum qnd manigfealdum
8 bisgum ðisses kynerīces ðā bōc wendan on Ęnglisc ðe is

9 genemned on Læden “Pastoralis,” qnd on Englisc “Hierdebōc,”
 10 hwīlum word be worde, hwīlum andgit of andgiete,
 11 swæ swæ ic hīe geliornode æt Plegmunde mīnum
 12 ærcebiscepe, qnd æt Assere mīnum biscepe, qnd æt Grimbolde
 13 mīnum mæsseprīoste, qnd æt Iōhanne mīnum mæsseprēoste.
 14 Siððan ic hīe ðā geliornod hæfde, swæ swæ
 15 ic hīe forstōd, qnd swæ ic hīe andgitfullīcost āreccēan
 16 meahte, ic hīe on Englisc āwende; qnd tō ælcum biscepstōle
 17 on mīnum rīce wille āne onsendan; qnd on ælcra
 18 bið ān æstel, sē bið on fīftegum mancessa. Qnd ic bebīode
 19 on Godes naman ðæt nān mōn ðone æstel frōm
 20 ðære bēc ne dō, nē ðā bōc frōm ðæm mynstre; uncūð hū
 21 lōnge ðær swæ gelærede biscepas sīen, swæ swæ nū, Gode
 22 ðonc, wel hwær siendon. For ðy ic wolde ðætte hīe ealneg
 1 æt ðære stōwe wāren, būton sē biscep hīe mid him
 2 habban wille, oððe hīo hwær tō lāne sīe, oððe hwā oðre
 3 bī wīte.

117.1-2. Ælfred kyning hāteð ... hāte. Note the change from the formal and official third person (**hāteð**) to the more familiar first person (**hāte**). So Ælfric, in his *Preface to Genesis*, writes **Ælfric munuc grēt Æðelwærd ealdormann ēadmōdlīce. Ðū bāede mē, lēof, þæt ic**, etc.: *Ælfric, monk, greets Æthelweard, alderman, humbly. Thou, beloved, didst bid me that I*, etc.

118.5. Notice that **mæge** (l. 5) and **mæge** (l. 6) are not in the subjunctive because the sense requires it, but because they have been attracted by **gāmetige** and **befæste**. **Sīen** (p. 119, l. 15) and **hæbben** (p. 119, l. 20) illustrate the same construction.

118.9-10. *We liked only the reputation of being Christians, very few (of us) the Christian virtues.*

119.14. Alfred is here addressing the bishops collectively, and hence uses the plural **īow** (= **ēow**), not **þē**.

119.16. **ðæt wē ðā**. These three words are not necessary to the sense. They constitute the figure known as epanalepsis, in which “the same word or phrase is repeated after one or more intervening words.” **þā** is the pronominal substitute for **suma bēc**.

119.17. **Gedōn** is the first person plural subjunctive (from infinitive **gedōn**). It and **wenden** are in the same construction. Two things seem “better” to Alfred: (1) *that we translate*, etc., (2) *that we cause*, etc.

119.19-21. **sīo gioguð ... is ... hīe ... sīen**. Notice how the collective noun, **gioguð**, singular at first both in form and function, gradually loses its oneness before the close of the sentence is reached, and becomes plural. The construction is entirely legitimate in Mn.E. Spanish is the only modern language known to me that condemns such an idiom: “Spanish ideas of congruity do not permit a collective noun, though denoting a plurality, to be accompanied by a plural verb or adjective in the same clause” (Ramsey, *Text-Book of Modern Spanish*, § 1452).

120.2. **lære mōn**. See § 105, 1.

120.11-13. That none of these advisers of the king, except Plegmond, a Mercian, were natives, bears out what Alfred says about the scarcity of learned men in England when he began to reign. Asser, to whose Latin *Life of Alfred*, in spite of its mutilations, we owe almost

all of our knowledge of the king, came from St. David's (in Wales), and was made Bishop of Sherborne.

121.1. Translate **ǣt ðǣre stōwe** by *each in its place*.
The change from plural **hīe** (in **hīe ... wǣren**) to singular **hīe** (in the clauses that follow) will thus be prepared for.

121.2-3. **oððe hwā oððre bī wrīte**, or *unless some one wish to copy a new one (write thereby another)*.

1 = bīsceop.

2 = hwilce.

3 = gīu.

4 = For all words with *io* (*īo*), consult Glossary under *eo* (*ēo*).

5 = hīersumedon.

6 = sidu (*siodu*).

7 = swā.

8 = ānlīpigne.

9 = hwilc.

10 = līefdon.

11 = mēnigu.

12 = nānwiht.

13 = swilce.

14 = spyrian.

15 = wītena.

16 = wītanne.

POETRY.



INTRODUCTORY.



In [Section II., Structure](#), the stress markers ´ and ` are intended to display above the macron – or (rarely) breve ˇ:

– ´ x –

Some computers will instead show them after (to the right of) the macron. “Resolved stress” (two short syllables acting as one long) is shown with a double breve below the syllables:

˘˘
x

If your computer does not have this character, it will probably display a box or question mark between the two syllables.

I. HISTORY.

(a) Old English Poetry as a Whole.

NORTHUMBRIA was the home of Old English poetry. Beginning with Cædmon and his school A.D. 670, Northumbria maintained her poetical supremacy till A.D. 800, seven years before which date the ravages of the Danes had begun. When Alfred ascended the throne of Wessex (871), the Danes had destroyed the seats of learning throughout the whole of Northumbria. As Whitby had been “the cradle of English poetry,”

Winchester (Alfred's capital) became now the cradle of English prose; and the older poems that had survived the fire and sword of the Vikings were translated from the original Northumbrian dialect into the West Saxon dialect. It is, therefore, in the West Saxon dialect that these poems ¹ have come down to us.

Old English poetry contains in all only about thirty thousand lines; but it includes epic, lyric, didactic, elegiac, and allegorical poems, together with war-ballads, paraphrases, riddles, and charms. Of the five elegiac poems (*Wanderer*, *Seafarer*, *Ruin*, *Wife's Complaint*, and *Husband's Message*), the *Wanderer* is the most artistic, and best portrays the gloomy contrast between past happiness and present grief so characteristic of the Old English lyric.

Old English literature has no love poems. The central themes of its poets are battle and bereavement, with a certain grim resignation on the part of the hero to the issues of either. The movement of the thought is usually abrupt, there being a noticeable poverty of transitional particles, or connectives, "which," says Ten Brink, "are the cement of sentence-structure."

(b) Beowulf.

The greatest of all Old English poems is the epic, *Beowulf*. ² It consists of more than three thousand lines, and probably assumed approximately its present form in Northumbria about A.D. 700. It is a crystallization of continental myths; and, though nothing is said of England, the story is an invaluable index to the social, political, and ethical ideals of our Germanic ancestors before and after they settled along the English coast. It is most poetical, and its testimony is historically most valuable, in the character-portraits that it contains. The fatalism that runs through it, instead of making the characters weak and less human, serves at times rather to dignify and elevate them. "Fate," says Beowulf (l. 572), recounting his battle with the sea-monsters, "often saves an undoomed man *if his courage hold out*."

"The ethical essence of this poetry," says Ten Brink, "lies principally in the conception of manly virtue, undismayed courage, the stoical encounter with death, silent submission to fate, in the readiness to help others, in the

clemency and liberality of the prince toward his thanes, and the self-sacrificing loyalty with which they reward him.”

NOTE 1.—Many different interpretations have been put upon the story of *Beowulf* (for argument of story, see texts). Thus Müllenhoff sees in Grendel the giant-god of the storm-tossed equinoctial sea, while Beowulf is the Scandinavian god Freyr, who in the spring drives back the sea and restores the land. Laistner finds the prototype of Grendel in the noxious exhalations that rise from the Frisian coast-marshes during the summer months; Beowulf is the wind-hero, the autumnal storm-god, who dissipates the effluvia.

1. This does not, of course, include the few short poems in the *Chronicle*, or that portion of *Genesis* (*Genesis B*) supposed to have been put directly into West Saxon from an Old Saxon original. There still remain in Northumbrian the version of *Cædmon's Hymn*, fragments of the *Ruthwell Cross*, *Bede's Death-Song*, and the *Leiden Riddle*.

2. The word *bēowulf*, says Grimm, meant originally *bee-wolf*, or *bee-enemy*, one of the names of the woodpecker. Sweet thinks the bear was meant. But the word is almost certainly a compound of *Bēow* (cf. O.E. **bēow** = grain), a Danish demigod, and *wulf* used as a mere suffix.

II. STRUCTURE.

(a) Style.

In the structure of Old English poetry the most characteristic feature is the constant repetition of the idea (sometimes of the thought) with a corresponding variation of phrase, or epithet. When, for example, the Queen passes into the banquet hall in *Beowulf*, she is designated at first by her name, **Wealhþēow**; she is then described in turn as **cwēn Hrōðgāres** (*Hrothgar's queen*), **gold-hroden** (*the gold-adorned*), **frēolīc wīf** (*the noble woman*), **ides Helminga** (*the Helmings' lady*), **bēag-hroden cwēn** (*the*

ring-adorned queen), **mōde geþungen** (*the high-spirited*), and **gold-hroden frēolīcu folc-cwēn** (*the gold-adorned, noble folk-queen*).

And whenever the sea enters largely into the poet's verse, not content with simple (uncompounded) words (such as **sǣ**, **lagu**, **holm**, **strēam**, **mere**, etc.), he will use numerous other equivalents (phrases or compounds), such as **wapema gebind** (*the commingling of waves*), **lagu-flōd** (*the sea-flood*), **lagu-stræt** (*the sea-street*), **swan-rād** (*the swan-road*), etc. These compounds are usually nouns, or adjectives and participles used in a sense more appositive than attributive.

It is evident, therefore, that this abundant use of compounds, or periphrastic synonyms, grows out of the desire to repeat the idea in varying language. It is to be observed, also, that the Old English poets rarely make any studied attempt to balance phrase against phrase or clause against clause. Theirs is a repetition of idea, rather than a parallelism of structure.

NOTE 1.—It is impossible to tell how many of these synonymous expressions had already become stereotyped, and were used, like many of the epithets in the *Iliad* and *Odyssey*, purely as padding. When, for example, the poet tells us that at the most critical moment Beowulf's sword failed him, adding in the same breath, **īren ær-gōd** (*matchless blade*), we conclude that the bard is either nodding or parroting.

(b) Meter.

[Re-read § 10, (3).]

Primary Stress.

Old English poetry is composed of certain rhythmically ordered combinations of accented and unaccented syllables. The accented syllable (the arsis) is usually long, and will be indicated by the macron with the acute accent over it (—́); when short, by the breve with the same accent (˘́). The unaccented syllable or syllables (the thesis) may be long or short, and will be indicated by the oblique cross (×).

Secondary Stress.

A secondary accent, or stress, is usually put upon the second member of compound and derivative nouns, adjectives, and adverbs. This will be indicated by the macron with the grave accent, if the secondary stress falls on a long syllable (—̀); by the breve with the same accent, if the secondary stress falls on a short syllable (—̆). Nouns:

Hrōðgāres (—̀×), **fēondgrāpum** (—̀×), **frēomægum** (—̀×),
Ēast-Dēna (—̆×), **Helminga** (—̀×), **Scyldinga** (—̀×), **ānhaga** (—̆×),
Ecgbēowes (—̀×), **sinc-fato** (—̆×).

Adjectives: ¹

āghwylcne (—̀×), **prīsthȳdig** (—̀×), **gold-hroden** (—̆×),
drēorigne (—̀×), **gylденne** (—̀×), **ōðerne** (—̀×), **gæstlicum** (—̀×),
wynsume (—̆×), **ænigne** (—̀×).

Adverbs: ²

unsōfte (—̀×), **heardlice** (—̀×), **sęmninga** (—̀×).

The Old English poets place also a secondary accent upon the ending of present participles (**-ende**), and upon the penultimate of weak verbs of the second class (§ 130), provided the root-syllable is long. ³ Present participles:

slāependne (—̀×), **wīs-hycgende** (—̀×), **flēotendra** (—̀×),
hrēosende (—̀×).

Weak verbs:

swynsode (—̆×), **pancode** (—̆×), **wānigean** (—̆×), **scēawian** (—̆×),
scēawige (—̆×), **hlīfian** (—̆×).

Resolved Stress.

A short accented syllable followed in the same word by an unaccented syllable (usually short also) is equivalent to one long accented syllable (̆× = —̀). This is known as a resolved stress, and will be indicated thus, ̆×;

hæleða (˘ẋx), **guman** (˘ẋ), **Gode** (˘ẋ), **sęle-ful** (˘ẋx), **ides** (˘ẋ),
fyrena (˘ẋx), **maðelode** (˘ẋ˘x), **hogode** (˘ẋx), **mægen-ellen** (˘ẋ˘x),
hige-þihtigne (˘ẋ˘˘), **Metudes** (˘ẋx), **lagulāde** (˘ẋ˘x),
unlyfigendes (˘˘ẋ˘x), **biforan** (ẋ˘x), **forþolian** (ẋ˘x),
baðian (˘ẋx), **worolde** (˘˘ẋ).

Resolution of stress may also attend secondary stresses:

sinc-fato (˘˘ẋ), **dryht-sęle** (˘˘ẋ), **ferðloca** (˘˘ẋ), **forðwege** (˘˘ẋ).

The Normal Line.

Every normal line of Old English poetry has four primary accents, two in the first half-line and two in the second half-line. These half-lines are separated by the cesura and united by alliteration, the alliterative letter being found in the first stressed syllable of the second half-line. This syllable, therefore, gives the cue to the scansion of the whole line. It is also the only alliterating syllable in the second half-line. The first half-line, however, usually has two alliterating syllables, but frequently only one (the ratio being about three to two in the following selections). When the first half-line contains but one alliterating syllable, that syllable marks the first stress, rarely the second. The following lines are given in the order of their frequency:

- (1) **þær wæs hæleða hléahtor; hlýn swýnsode.**
- (2) **móde gepúngen, médo-ful ætbær.**
- (3) **sóna þæt onfúnde fýrena hýrde.**

Any initial vowel or diphthong may alliterate with any other initial vowel or diphthong; but a consonant requires the same consonant, except **st**, **sp**, and **sc**, each of which alliterates only with itself.

Remembering, now, that either half-line (especially the second) may begin with several unaccented syllables (these syllables being known in types A, D, and E as the *anacrusis*), but that neither half-line can end with more than one unaccented syllable, the student may begin at once to read and properly

accentuate Old English poetry. It will be found that the alliterative principle does not operate mechanically, but that the poet employs it for the purpose of emphasizing the words that are really most important. Sound is made subservient to sense.

When, from the lack of alliteration, the student is in doubt as to what word to stress, let him first get the exact meaning of the line, and then put the emphasis on the word or words that seem to bear the chief burden of the poet's thought.

NOTE 1.—A few lines, rare or abnormal in their alliteration or lack of alliteration, may here be noted. In the texts to be read, there is one line with no alliteration: *Wanderer* 58; three of the type $a \cdots b \mid a \cdots b$: *Beowulf* 654, 830, 2746; one of the type $a \cdots a \mid b \cdots a$: *Beowulf* 2744; one of the type $a \cdots a \mid b \cdots c$: *Beowulf* 2718; and one of the type $a \cdots b \mid c \cdots a$: *Beowulf* 2738.

The Five Types.

By an exhaustive comparative study of the metrical unit in Old English verse, the half-line, Professor Eduard Sievers, ⁴ of the University of Leipzig, has shown that there are only five types, or varieties, employed. These he classifies as follows, the perpendicular line serving to separate the so-called feet, or measures:

1. A $\acute{\times} \mid \acute{\times}$
2. B $\times \acute{\mid} \times \acute{\mid}$
3. C $\times \acute{\mid} \acute{\times}$
4. D { $D^1 \acute{\mid} \acute{\times}$
 $D^2 \acute{\mid} \acute{\times}$
5. E { $E^1 \acute{\times} \mid \acute{\mid}$
 $E^2 \acute{\times} \mid \acute{\mid}$

It will be seen (1) that each half-line contains two, and only two, feet; (2) that each foot contains one, and only one, primary stress; (3) that A is trochaic, B iambic; (4) that C is iambic-trochaic; (5) that D and E consist of the same feet but in inverse order.

The Five Types Illustrated.

[All the illustrations, as hitherto, are taken from the texts to be read. The figures prefixed indicate whether first or second half-line is cited. B = *Beowulf*; W = *Wanderer*.]

1. TYPE A, ' × | ' ×

Two or more unaccented syllables (instead of one) may intervene between the two stresses, but only one may follow the last stress. If the thesis in either foot is the second part of a compound it receives, of course, a secondary stress.

- | | |
|---|---------------------|
| (2) ful gesealde , B. 616, | ' × ' × |
| (1) wīdre gewindan , B. 764, | ' × × ' × |
| (1) ⁵ Gemunde þā sē gōda , B. 759, | × ' × × ' × |
| | × |
| (1) ⁵ swylce hē on ealder-dagum , B. 758, | × × × × ' × ' × |
| | × |
| (1) ȳpde swā þisne eardgeard , W. 85, | ' × × × × ' ' × |
| (1) wīs-fæst wordum , B. 627, | ' ' ' × |
| (1) gryre-lēoð galan , B. 787, | ' × ' ' × |
| (2) somod ætgædre , W. 39, | ' × × ' × |
| (1) duguðe ond geogoðe , B. 622, | ' × × × ' × × |
| (1) fæger fold-bold , B. 774, | ' × ' ' × |
| (1) atelīc egesa , B. 785, | ' × ' ' × × |
| (2) goldwine mīnne , W. 22, | ' ' × ' × |
| (1) egesān þēon [> *þīhan: § 118], B. 2737, | ' × × ' × |

NOTE.—Rare forms of A are ' ' × | ' × (does not occur in texts), ' ' × | ' ' (occurs once, B. 781 (1)), and ' × ' | ' × (once, B. 2743 (1)).

2. TYPE B, × ' | × ' ×

Two, but not more than two, unaccented syllables may intervene between the stresses. The type of B most frequently occurring is × × ' | × ' ×.

- | | |
|--|-----------------|
| (1) ond þā frēolīc wīf , B. 616, | × × ' × ' × |
| (2) hē on lust geþeah , B. 619, | × × ' × ' × |
| (2) þā se æðeling gīong , B. 2716, | × × ' × × ' × |
| (2) seah on ehta geweorc , B. 2718, | × × ' × × ' × |

(1) **ofer flōda genipu**, B. 2809,

× × ′ | × ×
 ×

(1) **forþam mē wītan ne þearf**, B. 2742,

(2) **þaes þe hire se willa gelamp**, B. 627,

× × × ′ | × × ′
 × × × × × | × × ′

(1) **forþon ne mæg weorþan wīs**, W. 64,

(1) **Nāfre ic ānegum [= ān'gum] mēn**, B. 656,

 × × × × ′ | × ′
 × × × ′ | × ′

NOTE.—In the last half-line Sievers substitutes the older form **āngum**, and supposes elision of the **e** in **Nāfre** (= **Nāfr-ic**: ××′ | ×′).

3. TYPE C, × ′ | ′ ×

The conditions of this type are usually satisfied by compound and derivative words, and the second stress (not so strong as the first) is frequently on a short syllable. The two arses rarely alliterate. As in B, two unaccented syllables in the first thesis are more common than one.

(1) **þæt hēo on ānigne**, B. 628,

(1) **þæt ic ānunga**, B. 635,

(2) **ēode gold-hroden**, B. 641,

(1) **gemyne mārðo**, B. 660,

(1) **on þisse meodu-healle**, B. 639,

(2) **æt brimes nosan**, B. 2804,

(2) **æt Wealhþéon [= -þēowan]**, B. 630,

(1) **geond lagulāde**, W. 3,

(1) **Swā cwæð eardstapa**, W. 6,

(2) **ēalā byrnwiga**, W. 94,

(2) **nō þær fela bringeð**, W. 54,

× × × ′ | ′ ×
 × × ′ | ′ ×
 × × ′ | ′ ×
 × ′ × | ′ ×
 × × × ′ × | ′ ×
 × ′ × | ′ ×
 × ′ | ′ ×
 × ′ × | ′ ×
 × × ′ | ′ ×
 × × ′ | ′ ×
 × × ′ × | ′ ×

4. TYPE D, { D¹ ′ | ′ ′ ×
 D² ′ | ′ × ′

Both types of D may take one unaccented syllable between the two primary stresses (′ × | ′ ′ ×, ′ × | ′ × ′). The secondary stress in D¹ falls usually on

the second syllable of a compound or derivative word, and this syllable (as in C) is frequently short.

(a) D¹ — | — ˘ ×

- | | |
|--|-------------------|
| (1) cwēn Hrōðgāres , B. 614, | — — ˘ × |
| (2) dāel æghwylcne , B. 622, | — — ˘ × |
| (1) Bēowulf maðelode , B. 632, | — × ˘ × ˘ × |
| (2) slāt unwearnum , B. 742, | — — ˘ × |
| (1) wrāþra wælsleahta , W. 7, | — × — ˘ × |
| (1) wōd wintercearig [= wint'rcearig], W. 24, | — — ˘ × |
| (1) sōhte seþe drēorig , W. 25, | — × ˘ × ˘ × |
| (1) ne sōhte searo-nīðas , B. 2739, | × — × ˘ × ˘ × |

NOTE.—There is one instance in the texts (B. 613, (1)) of apparent — × × | — ˘ ×: **word wāeron wynsume**. (The triple alliteration has no significance. The sense, besides, precludes our stressing **wāeron**.) The difficulty is avoided by bringing the line under the A type: — × × | — ˘ ×.

(b) D² — | — × ˘

- | | |
|---|-------------|
| (2) Forð nēar ætstōp , B. 746, | — — × ˘ |
| (2) eorl furður stōp , B. 762, | — — × ˘ |
| (2) Deþum eallum wearð , B. 768, | ˘ × — × ˘ |
| (1) grētte Gēata lēod , B. 626, | — × — × ˘ |
| (1) ænig yrfe-weard , B. 2732, | — × — × ˘ |
| (1) hrēosan hrīm and snāw , W. 48, | — × — × ˘ |
| (2) swimmað eft on weg , W. 53, | — × — × ˘ |

Very rarely is the thesis in the second foot expanded.

- | | |
|--|---------------|
| (2) þegn ungemete till , B. 2722, | — — × × × ˘ |
| (1) hrūsan heolster biwrāh , W. 23, | — × — × × ˘ |

5. TYPE E, { E¹ — ˘ ˘ × | —
E² — × ˘ | —

The secondary stress in E¹ falls frequently on a short syllable, as in D¹.

(a) E¹ — ˘ ˘ × | —

(1) wyrmlicum fāh , W. 98,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$
(2) medo-ful ætbær , B. 625,	$\acute{\times} \grave{\times} \mid \acute{-}$
(1) sā-bāt gesæt , B. 634,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$
(1) sige-folca swēg , B. 645,	$\acute{\times} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$
(2) Norð-Denum stōd , B. 784,	$\acute{-} \grave{\times} \mid \acute{-}$
(1) fēond-grāpum fæst , B. 637,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$
(2) wyn eal gedrēas , W. 36,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$
(2) feor oft gemon , W. 90,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \mid \acute{-}$

As in D², the thesis in the first foot is very rarely expanded.

(1) wīn-ærnes geweald , B. 655,	$\acute{-} \grave{-} \times \times \mid \acute{-}$
(1) Hafa nū onð geheald , B. 659,	$\acute{\times} \grave{-} \times \times \mid \acute{-}$
(1) searo-þoncum besmiðod , B. 776,	$\acute{\times} \grave{-} \times \times \mid \acute{\times}$

NOTE.—Our ignorance of Old English sentence-stress makes it impossible for us to draw a hard-and-fast line in all cases between D² and E¹. For example, in these half-lines (already cited),

wyn eal gedrēas
feor oft gemon
Forð nēar ætstōp

if we throw a strong stress on the adverbs that precede their verbs, the type is D². Lessen the stress on the adverbs and increase it on the verbs, and we have E¹. The position of the adverbs furnishes no clue; for the order of words in Old English was governed not only by considerations of relative emphasis, but by syntactic and euphonic considerations as well.

(b) E² $\acute{-} \times \grave{-} \mid \acute{-}$

This is the rarest of all types. It does not occur in the texts, there being but one instance of this type (l. 2437 (2)), and that doubtful, in the whole of *Beowulf*.

Abnormal Lines.

The lines that fall under none of the five types enumerated are comparatively few. They may be divided into two classes, (1) hypermetrical lines, and (2) defective lines.

(1) HYPERMETRICAL LINES.

Each hypermetrical half-line has usually three stresses, thus giving six stresses to the whole line instead of two. These lines occur chiefly in groups, and mark increased range and dignity in the thought. Whether the half-line be first or second, it is usually of the A type without anacrusis. To this type belong the last five lines of the *Wanderer*. Lines 92 and 93 are also unusually long, but not hypermetrical. The first half-line of 65 is hypermetrical, a fusion of A and C, consisting of (´×××´|´×).

(2) DEFECTIVE LINES.

The only defective lines in the texts are B. 748 and 2715 (the second half-line in each). As they stand, these half-lines would have to be scanned thus:

rǣhte ongēan	´ × × ´
bealo-nīð wēoll	´ × ´ ´

Sievers emends as follows:

rǣhte tōgēanes	´ × × ´ × = A
bealo-nīðe wēoll	´ × ´ × ´ = E ¹

These defective half-lines are made up of syntactic combinations found on almost every page of Old English prose. That they occur so rarely in poetry is strong presumptive evidence, if further evidence were needed, in favor of the adequacy of Sievers' five-fold classification.

NOTE.—All the lines that could possibly occasion any difficulty to the student have been purposely cited as illustrations under the different types. If these are mastered, the student will find it an easy matter to scan the lines that remain.

1. It will be seen that the adjectives are chiefly derivatives in **-ig**, **-en**, **-er**, **-līc**, and **-sum**.
2. Most of the adverbs belonging here end in **-līce**, **-unga**, and **-inga**, § 93, (1), (2): such words as **æt-gǣdere**, **on-gēan**, **on-wég**, **tō-gēanes**, **tō-míddes**, etc., are invariably accented as here indicated.
3. It will save the student some trouble to remember that this means long by nature (**līcodon**), or long by position (**swynsode**),

or long by resolution of stress (**maðelode**),—see next paragraph.

4. Sievers' two articles appeared in the *Beiträge zur Geschichte der deutschen Sprache und Literatur*, Vols. X (1885) and XII (1887). A brief summary, with slight modifications, is found in the same author's *Altgermanische Metrik*, pp. 120-144 (1893).

Before attempting to employ Sievers' types, the student would do well to read several pages of Old English poetry, taking care to accentuate according to the principles already laid down. In this way his ear will become accustomed to the rhythm of the line, and he will see more clearly that Sievers' work was one primarily of systematization. Sievers himself says: "I had read Old English poetry for years exactly as I now scan it, and long before I had the slightest idea that what I did instinctively could be formulated into a system of set rules." (*Altgermanische Metrik*, *Vorwort*, p. 10.)

5. The first perpendicular marks the limit of the anacrusis.

SELECTIONS FOR READING.



VI. EXTRACTS FROM BEOWULF.

THE BANQUET IN HEOROT. [Lines 612-662.]

[The Heyne-Socin text has been closely followed. I have attempted no original emendations, but have deviated from the Heyne-Socin edition in a few cases where the Grein-Wülker text seemed to give the better reading.]

The argument preceding the first selection is as follows: Hrothgar, king of the Danes, or Scyldings, elated by prosperity, builds a magnificent hall in which to feast his retainers; but a monster, Grendel by name, issues from his fen-haunts, and night after night carries off thane after thane from the banqueting hall. For twelve years these ravages continue. At last Beowulf, nephew of Hygelac, king of the Geats (a people of South Sweden), sails with fourteen chosen companions to Dane-land, and offers his services to the aged Hrothgar. "Leave me alone in the hall to-night," says Beowulf. Hrothgar accepts Beowulf's proffered aid, and before the dread hour of visitation comes, the time is spent in wassail. The banquet scene follows.]

þær wæs hæleþa hleahtor, hlyn swynsode,
word wæron wynsume. Ēode Wealhþēow forð,
cwēn Hrōðgāres, cynna gemyndig;
grētte gold-hroden guman on healle, [615]
onð þā frēolīc wīf ful gesealde
ārest Ēast-Dēna ēpel-wearde,
bæd hine blīðne æt þære bēor-þege,
lēodum lēofne; hē on lust geþeah
symbol onð sēle-ful, sige-rōf kyning. [620]

Ymb-ēode þā ides Helminga
 duguðe ond geogoðe dæl æghwylcne,
 sinc-fato sealde, oð þæt sæl ālamp
 þæt hīo ¹ Bēowulfe, bēag-hroden cwēn,
 mōde gepungen, medo ²-ful ætbær; [625]
 grētte Gēata lēod, Gode þancode
 wīs-fæst wordum, þæs þe hire se willa gelamp,
 þæt hēo on ænigne eorl gelyfde
 fyrena frōfre. Hē þæt ful geþeah,
 wæl-rēow wiga, æt Wealhþēon, [630]
 ond þā gyddode gūðe gefȳsed;
 Bēowulf maðelode, bearn Ecgþēowes:
 “Ic þæt hogode, þā ic on holm gestāh,
 sǣ-bāt gesæt mid mīnra sēcga gedriht,
 þæt ic ānunga ēowra lēoda [635]
 willan geworhte, oððe on wæl crunge
 fēond-grāpum fæst. Ic gefrēmman sceal
 eorlīc ellen, oððe ende-dæg
 on þisse meodu ²-healle mīnne gebīdan.”
 Þām wīfe þā word wel līcodon, [640]
 gilp-cwide Gēates; ēode gold-hroden
 frēolicu folc-cwēn tō hire frēan sittan.
 Þā wæs eft swā ær inne on healle
 þrȳð-word sprecen, ³ þēod on sǣlum,
 sige-folca swēg, oþ þæt sēmninga [645]
 sunu Healfðenes sēcean wolde
 æfen-ræste; wiste þām āhlācan ⁴
 tō þām hēah-sēle hilde gepinged,
 siððan hīe sunnan lēoht gesēon *ne* meahton
 oððe nīpende niht ofer ealle, [650]
 scadu-helma gesceapu scrīðan cwōman, ⁵
 wan under wolcnum. Werod eall ārās;

grētte þā *giddum* guma oðerne
Hrōðgār Bēowulf, ʒnd him hæl ābēad,
wīn-ærnes gewæld, ʒnd þæt word ācwæð: [655]
“Næfre ic ænegum ⁶ meṇ ær ālyfde,
siððan ic hʒnd ʒnd rʒnd hebban mihte,
ðrȳþ-ærn Deṇa būton þē nū þā.
Hafa nū ʒnd geheald hūsa sēlest,
gemyne mārþo, ⁷ mægen-ellen cȳð, [660]
waca wið wrāðum. Ne bið þē wilna gād,
gif þū þæt ellen-weorc aldre ⁸ gedīgest.”

623. sinc-fato sealde. Banning (*Die epischen Formeln im Beowulf*) shows that the usual translation, *gave costly gifts*, must be given up; or, at least, that the *costly gifts* are nothing more than *beakers of mead*. The expression is an epic formula for *passing the cup*.

638-39. ęnde-ðæg ... mīnne. This unnatural separation of noun and possessive is frequent in O.E. poetry, but almost unknown in prose.

641-42. ēode ... sittan. The poet might have employed **tō sittanne** (§ 108, (1)); but in poetry the infinitive is often used for the gerund. Alfred himself uses the infinitive or the gerund to express purpose after **gān**, **gʒngan**, **cuman**, and **sęndan**.

647-51. wiste ... cwōman. A difficult passage, even with Thorpe's inserted **ne**; but there is no need of putting a period after **geþinged**, or of translating **oððe** by *and*: *He (Hrothgar) knew that battle was in store (geþinged) for the monster in the high hall, after [= as soon as] they could no longer see the sun's light, or [= that is] after night came darkening over all, and*

shadowy figures stalking. The subject of **cwōman** [= **cwōmon**] is **niht** and **gesceapu**.

The student will note that the infinitive (**scriðan**) is here employed as a present participle after a verb of motion (**cwōman**). This construction with **cuman** is frequent in prose and poetry. The infinitive expresses the kind of motion: **ic cōm drīfan** = *I came driving*.

1 = hēo.

2 = medu-.

3 = gesprecen.

4 = āglācan.

5 = cwōmon.

6 = ænigum.

7 = mārþe (acc. sing.).

8 = ealdre (instr. sing.).

THE FIGHT BETWEEN BEOWULF AND GRENDEL. [Lines 740-837.]

[The warriors all retire to rest except Beowulf. Grendel stealthily enters the hall. From his eyes gleams “a luster unlovely, likest to fire.” The combat begins at once.]

Ne þæt se āglāca yldan þōhte, [740]

ac hē gefēng hraðe forman sīðe

slāpendne rinc, slāt unwearnum,

bāt bān-locan, blōd ēdrum dranc,

syn-snāedum swealh; sōna hæfde

unlyfigendes eal gefeormod [745]

fēt ƿnd folma. Forð nēar ætstōp,

nam þā mid handa hige-þihtigne

rinc on ræste; ræhte ongēan

fēond mid folme; hē onfēng hraþe

inwit-þancum ƿnd wið earm gesæt. [750]

Sōna þæt onfunde fyrena hyrde,

þæt hē ne mētte middan-geardes,
 eorðan scēatta, on ęlran męn
 mund-gripe māran; hē on mōde wearð
 forht, on ferhðe; nō þȳ ær fram meahte. [755]
 Hyge wæs him hin-fūs, wolde on heolster flēon,
 sēcan dēofla gedræg; ne wæs his drohtoð þær,
 swylce hē on ealder ¹-dagum ær gemētte.
 Gemunde þā se gōda mæg Higelāces
 æfen-spræce, ūp-lang āstōd [760]
 ƿnd him fæste wiðfēng; fingras burston;
 eoten wæs ūt-weard; eorl furþur stōp.
 Mynte se mæra, hwær hē meahte swā,
 wīdre gewindan ƿnd on weg þanon
 flēon on fęn-hopu; wiste his fingra geweald [765]
 on grames grāpum. Þæt wæs gēocor sīð,
 þæt se hearm-scaþa tō Heorute ² ātēah.
Dryht-sele dynede; Denum eallum wearð
ceaster-būendum, cēnra gehwylcum,
 eorlum ealu-scerwen. Yrre wæron bēgen [770]
 rēpe rēn-weardas. Ręced hlynsode;
 þā wæs wundor micel, þæt se wīn-sele
 wiðhæfde heaþo-dēorum, þæt hē on hrūsan ne fēol,
 fāger fold-bold; ac hē þæs fæste wæs
 innan ƿnd ūtan īren-bendum [775]
 searo-þȳncum besmiðod. Þær fram sylle ābēag
 medu-bęnc mȳnig, mīne gefræge,
 golde geregnad, þær þā graman wunnon;
 þæs ne wēndon ær witan Scyldinga,
 þæt hit ā mid gemete manna ānig, [780]
 betlīc ƿnd bān-fāg, tōbrecaþ meahte,
 listum tōlūcan, nymþe līges fæðm
 swulge on swaþule. Swēg ūp āstāg

nīwe geneahhe; Norð-Denum stōd
atelīc egesa, ānra gehwylcum, [785]
þāra þe of wealle wōp gehȳrdon,
gryre-lēoð galan Godes ȝndsacan,
sige-lēasne sang, sār wānigean
helle hæfton.³ Hēold hine fæste,
sē þe manna wæs mægene strēngest [790]
on þāem dæge þysses līfes.
Nolde eorla hlēo ānige þinga
þone cwealm-cuman cwicne forlætan,
nē his līf-dagas lēoda ānigum
nytte tealde. Þær genehost brægd [795]
eorl Bēowulfes ealde lāfe,
wolde frēa-drihtnes feorh ealgian,
māres þēodnes, ðær hīe meahton swā.
Hīe ðæt ne wiston, þā hīe gewin drugon,
heard-hicgende hilde-męcgas, [800]
ȝnd on healfa gehwone hēawan þōhton,
sāwle sēcan: þone syn-scaðan
ānig ofer eorðan īrenna cyst,
gūþ-billa nān, grētan nolde;
ac hē sige-wāpnum forsworen hæfde, [805]
ęga gehwylcre. Scolde his aldor⁴-gedāl
on ðāem dæge þysses līfes
earmlīc wurðan⁵ ȝnd se ęllor-gāst
on fēonda geweald feor sīðian.
Þā þæt onfunde, sē þe fela āror [810]
mōdes myrðe manna cynne
fyrene gefrēmede (hē wæs fāg wið God),
þæt him se līc-ȝoma læstan nolde,
ac hine se mōdega⁶ mæg Hygelāces
hæfde be ȝonda; wæs gehwæper oðrum [815]

lifigende lāð. Līc-sār gebād
 atol æglæca ⁷; him on eaxle wearð
 syn-dolh sweotol; seonowe onsprungon;
 burston bān-locan. Bēowulfe wearð
 gūð-hrēð gyfeðe. Scolde Grēndel þqnan [820]
 feorh-sēoc flēon under fēn-hleoðu, ⁸
 sēcean wyn-lēas wīc; wiste þē geornor,
 þæt his aldres ⁹ wæs ęnde gegqngen,
 dōgera dæg-rīm. Dęnum eallum wearð
 æfter þām wæl-rāse willa gelumpen. [825]
 Hæfde þā gefælsod, sē þe ær feorran cōm,
 snotor qnd swyð-ferhð, seþe Hrōðgāres,
 genęred wið nīðe. Niht-weorce gefeh,
 ęllen-mærþum; hæfde Ēast-Dęnum
 Gēat-męcga lēod gilp gelæsted; [830]
 swylce oncyððe ealle gebētte,
 inwid-sorge, þe hīe ær drugon
 qnd for þrēa-nyðum þolian scoldon,
 torn unlytel. Þæt wæs tācen sweotol,
 syððan hilde-dēor hqnd ālēgde, [835]
 earm qnd eaxle (þær wæs eal geador
 Gręndles grāpe) under gēapne hrōf.

740. þæt, the direct object of **yldan**, refers to the contest about to ensue. Beowulf, in the preceding lines, was wondering how it would result.

746. ætstōp. The subject of this verb and of **nam** is Grendel; the subject of the three succeeding verbs (**ræhte**, **onfēng**, **gesæt**) is Beowulf.

751-52. The O.E. poets are fond of securing emphasis or of stimulating interest by indirect methods of statement, by suggesting more than they affirm. This

device often appears in their use of negatives (**ne**, l. 13; p. 140, l. 3; **nō**, p. 140, l. 1), and in the unexpected prominence that they give to some minor detail usually suppressed because understood; as where the narrator, wishing to describe the terror produced by Grendel's midnight visits to Heorot, says (ll. 138-139), "Then was it easy to find one who elsewhere, more commodiously, sought rest for himself." It is hard to believe that the poet saw nothing humorous in this point of view.

755. **nō ... meahte**, *none the sooner could he away*. The omission of a verb of motion after the auxiliaries **magan**, **mōtan**, **sculan**, and **willan** is very frequent. Cf. Beowulf's last utterance, p. 147, l. 17.

768. The lines that immediately follow constitute a fine bit of description by indication of effects. The two contestants are withdrawn from our sight; but we hear the sound of the fray crashing through the massive old hall, which trembles as in a blast; we see the terror depicted on the faces of the Danes as they listen to the strange sounds that issue from their former banqueting hall; by these sounds we, too, measure the progress and alternations of the combat. At last we hear only the "terror-lay" of Grendel, "lay of the beaten," and know that Beowulf has made good his promise at the banquet (**gilp gelæsted**).

769. **cēnra gehwylcum**. The indefinite pronouns (§ 77) may be used as adjectives, agreeing in case with their nouns; but they frequently, as here, take a partitive genitive: **ānra gehwylcum**, *to each one* (= *to each of ones*); **ānige** (instrumental) **þinga**, *for any thing* (= *for any of things*); **on healfa gehwone**, *into halves* (= *into each of halves*); **ealra dōgra gehwām**, *every day* (= *on*

each of all days); **ūhtna gehwylce**, every morning (= on each of mornings).

780. Notice that **hit**, the object of **tōbreca**, stands for **wīn-sele**, which is masculine. See p. 39, Note 2.

Manna is genitive after **gemete**, not after **ænig**.

787-89. **gryre-lēoð ... hæfton** [= **hæftan**]. Note that verbs of hearing and seeing, as in Mn.E., may be followed by the infinitive. They heard *God's adversary sing (galan) ... hell's captive bewail (wānigean)*. Had the present participle been used, the effect would have been, as in Mn.E., to emphasize the agent (the subject of the infinitive) rather than the action (the infinitive itself).

795-96. **þær ... lāfe**. Beowulf's followers now seem to have seized their swords and come to his aid, not knowing that Grendel, having forsworn war-weapons himself, is proof against the best of swords. *Then many an earl of Beowulf's (= an earl of B. very often) brandished his sword*. That no definite earl is meant is shown by the succeeding **hīe meahton** instead of **hē meahte**. See p. 110, Note.

799. *They did not know this (ðæt), while they were fighting*; but the first **Hīe** refers to the warriors who proffered help; the second **hīe**, to the combatants, Beowulf and Grendel. In apposition with **ðæt**, stands the whole clause, **þone synscaðan** (object of **grētan**) ... **noelde**. The second, or conjunctive, **ðæt** is here omitted before **þone**. See p. 112, note on ll. 18-19.

837. **grāpe** = genitive singular, feminine, after **eal**.

1 = ealdor-.

2 = Heorote.

- 3 = hæftan.
- 4 = ealdor-.
- 5 = weorðan.
- 6 = mōdiga.
- 7 = āglæca.
- 8 = -hliðu.
- 9 = ealdres.

BEOWULF FATALLY WOUNDED. [Lines 2712-2752.]

[Hrothgar, in his gratitude for the great victory, lavishes gifts upon Beowulf; but Grendel's mother must be reckoned with. Beowulf finds her at the sea-bottom, and after a desperate struggle slays her. Hrothgar again pours treasures into Beowulf's lap. Beowulf, having now accomplished his mission, returns to Sweden. After a reign of fifty years, he goes forth to meet a fire-spewing dragon that is ravaging his kingdom. In the struggle Beowulf is fatally wounded. Wiglaf, a loyal thane, is with him.]

þā sīo ¹ wund ongŋn,
 þe him se eorð-draca ær geworhte,
 swēlan ƿnd swellan. Hē þæt sōna onfand,
 þæt him on brēostum bealo-nīð wēoll [2715]
 āttor on innan. þā se æðeling gīong, ²
 þæt hē bī wealle, wīs-hycgende,
 gesæt on sesse; seah on ęnta geweorc,
 hū þā stān-bogan stapulum fæste
 ēce eorð-ƿced innan healde. [2720]
 Hyne þā mid handa heoro-drēorigne,
 þēoden mārne, þegn ungemete till,
 wine-dryhten his wætere gelafede,
 hilde-sædne, ƿnd his helm onspēon.
 Bīowulf ³ maðelode; hē ofer bēnne spræc, [2725]
 wunde wæl-blēate; wisse hē gearwe,
 þæt hē dæg-hwīla gedrogen hæfde
 eorðan wyne; þā wæs eall sceacen
 dōgor-gerīmes, dēað ungemete nēah:

“Nū ic suna mīnum syllan wolde [2730]
 gūð-gewādu, þær mē gifeðe swā
 ænig yrfe-weard æfter wurde
 līce gelenge. Ic ðās lēode hēold
 fīftig wintra; næs se folc-cyning
 ymbe-sittendra ænig þāra, [2735]
 þe mec gūð-winum grētan dorste,
 egesan ðeon. Ic on earde bād
 mæl-gesceafta, hēold mīn tela,
 nē sōhte searo-nīðas, nē mē swōr fela
 āða on unriht. Ic ðæs ealles mæg, [2740]
 feorh-bennum sēoc, gefēan habban;
 for-þām mē wītan ne ðearf Waldend ⁴ fīra
 morðor-bealo ⁵ māga, þonne mīn sceaceð
 līf of līce. Nū ðū lungre geong ⁶
 hord scēawian under hārne stān, [2745]
 Wīglāf lēofa, nū se wyrm ligeð,
 swefeð sāre wund, since berēafod.
 Bīo ⁷ nū on ofoste, þæt ic ær-welan,
 gold-æht ongite, gearo scēawige
 swegle searo-gimmas, þæt ic ðy sēft mæge [2750]
 æfter mādðum-welan mīn ālāetan
 līf ond lēod-scipe, þone ic lōnge hēold.”

2716. **se æðeling** is Beowulf.

2718. **ęnta geweorc** is a stereotyped phrase for anything that occasions wonder by its size or strangeness.

2720. **healde**. Heyne, following Ettmüller, reads **hēoldon**, thus arbitrarily changing mood, tense, and number of the original. Either mood, indicative or subjunctive, would be legitimate. As to the tense, the

narrator is identifying himself in time with the hero, whose wonder was “how the stone-arches ... *sustain* the ever-during earth-hall”: the construction is a form of *oratio recta*, a sort of *miratio recta*. The singular **healde**, instead of **healden**, has many parallels in the dependent clauses of *Beowulf*, most of these being relative clauses introduced by **þāra þe** (= *of those that* ... + a singular predicate). In the present instance, the predicate has doubtless been influenced by the proximity of **eorð-reċed**, a *quasi*-subject; and we have no more right to alter to **healden** or **hēoldon** than we have to change Shakespeare’s *gives* to *give* in

“Words to the heat of deeds too cold breath *gives*.”

(*Macbeth*, II, I, 61.)

2722. The **þegn ungemete till** is Wiglaf, the bravest of Beowulf’s retainers.

2725. **hē ofer þenne spræc**. The editors and translators of *Beowulf* invariably render **ofer** in this passage by *about*; but Beowulf says not a word about his wound. The context seems to me to show plainly that **ofer** (cf. Latin *supra*) denotes here opposition = *in spite of*. We read in *Genesis*, l. 594, that Eve took the forbidden fruit **ofer Drihtenes word**. Beowulf fears (l. 2331) that he may have ruled unjustly = **ofer ealde riht**; and he goes forth (l. 2409) **ofer willan** to confront the dragon.

2731-33. **þær mē ... gelenge**, *if so be that* (**þær ... swā**) *any heir had afterwards been given me* (**mē gifeðe ... æfter wurde**) *belonging to my body*.

2744-45. **geong** [= **gong**] ... **scēawian**. See note on **ēode ... sittan**, p. 137, ll. 19-20. In Mn.E. *Go see, Go fetch*, etc., is the second verb imperative (coördinate

with the first), or subjunctive (*that you may see*), or infinitive without *to*?

2751-52. **mīn ... līf**. See note on **ende-dæg ... mīnne**, p. 137, ll. 16-17.

1 = sēo.

2 = gēong.

3 = Bēowulf.

4 = Wealdend.

5 = morðor-bealu.

6 = gong (gang).

7 = Bēo.

BEOWULF'S LAST WORDS. [Lines 2793-2821.]

[Wiglaf brings the jewels, the tokens of Beowulf's triumph. Beowulf, rejoicing to see them, reviews his career, and gives advice and final directions to Wiglaf.]

*Bīowulf*¹ *maðelode*,
gomel on gīohðe (gold scēawode):
“Ic þāra frætwa Frēan ealles ðanc, [2795]
Wuldur-cyninge, wordum sēcge
ecum Dryhtne, þe ic hēr on starie,
þæs þe ic mōste mīnum lēodum
ær swylt-dæge swylc gestrȳnan.
Nū ic on māðma hord mīne bebohte [2800]
frōde feorh-lege, frēmmað gē nū
lēoda þearfe; ne mæg ic hēr leng wesan.
Hātað heaðo-mære hlāw gewyrcean,
beorhtne æfter bāle æt brimes nosan;
sē scel² tō gemyndum mīnum lēodum [2805]
hēah hlīfian on Hrōnes næsse,
þæt hit sē-līðend syððan hātan³
Bīowulfes¹ biorh¹ þā þe brentingas

ofer flōda genipu feorran drīfað.”
 Dyde him of healse hring gyldenne [2810]
 þīoden ¹ þrīst-hȳdig; þegne gesealde,
 geongum gār-wigan, gold-fāhne helm,
 bēah qnd byrnan, hēt hyne brūcan well.
 “Þū eart ęnde-lāf ūsses cynnes,
 Wægmunðinga; ealle wyrd forswēop [2815]
 mīne māgas tō metod-sceafte,
 eorlas on ęlne; ic him æfter sceal.”
 Þæt wæs þām gōmelan gingeste word
 brēost-gehygdum, ær hē bæl cure,
 hāte heaðo-wylmas; him of hreðre gewāt [2820]
 sāwol sēcean sōð-fæstra dōm.

2795-99. The expression **sęcgan þanc** takes the same construction as **þancian**; i.e., the dative of the person (**Frēan**) and the genitive (a genitive of cause) of the thing (**þāra frætwa**). Cf. note on **biddan**, p. 45. The antecedent of **þe** is **frætwa**. For the position of **on**, see § 94, (5). The clause introduced by **þæs þe** (*because*) is parallel in construction with **frætwa**, both being causal modifiers of **sęcge þanc**. The Christian coloring in these lines betrays the influence of priestly transcribers.

2800. *Now that I, in exchange for (on) a hoard of treasures, have bartered (bebohte) the laying down (-lēge > licgan) of my old life.* The ethical codes of the early Germanic races make frequent mention of blood-payments, or life-barters. There seems to be here a suggestion of the “*wergild*.”

2801. **fręmmað gē**. The plural imperative (as also in **Hātað**) shows that Beowulf is here speaking not so much to Wiglaf in particular as, through Wiglaf, to his retainers in general,—to his *comitatus*.

2806. The desire for conspicuous burial places finds frequent expression in early literatures. The tomb of Achilles was situated “high on a jutting headland over wide Hellespont that it might be seen from off the sea.” Elpenor asks Ulysses to bury him in the same way. Æneas places the ashes of Misenus beneath a high mound on a headland of the sea.

2807. **hit** = **hlǣw**, which is masculine. See p. 39, Note 2.

2810-11. **him ... þīoden**. The reference in both cases is to Beowulf, who is disarming himself (**do-of** > *doff*) for the last time; **þegne** = *to Wiglaf*.

Note, where the personal element is strong, the use of the dative instead of the more colorless possessive; **him of healse**, not **of his healse**.

2817. **ic ... sceal**. See note on **nō ... meahte**, p. 140, l. 1.

2820. **him of hreðre**. Cf. note on **him ... þīoden**, p. 147, ll. 10-11.

2820-21. For construction of **gewāt ... sēcean**, see note on **ēode ... sittan**, p. 137, ll. 19-20.

1 = īo, io = ēo, eo.

2 = sceal.

3 = hāten.

VII. THE WANDERER.

[Exeter MS. “The epic character of the ancient lyric appears especially in this: that the song is less the utterance of a momentary feeling than the portrayal of a lasting state, perhaps the reflection of an entire life, generally that of one isolated, or bereft by death or exile of protectors and friends.” (Ten Brink, *Early Eng. Lit.*, I.) I adopt Brooke’s threefold division (*Early Eng. Lit.*, p. 356): “It opens with a Christian prologue, and closes with a Christian

epilogue, but the whole body of the poem was written, it seems to me, by a person who thought more of the goddess Wyrð than of God, whose life and way of thinking were uninfluenced by any distinctive Christian doctrine.”

The author is unknown.]

PROLOGUE.

Oft him ānhaga āre gebīdeð,
Metudes ¹ miltse, þēah þe hē mōdcearig
geond lagulāde lōnge sceolde
hrēran mid hōndum hrīmcealde sǣ,
wadan wræclǣstas: wyrð bið ful ārǣd! [5]
Swā cwæð eardstapa earfeþa ² gemyndig,
wrāþra wælsleahta, winemæga hryres:

PLAINT OF THE WANDERER.

“Oft ic sceolde āna ūhtna gehwylce
mīne ceare cwīþan; nis nū cwicra nān,
þe ic him mōdsefan mīnne durre [10]
sweotule ³ āsēcgan. Ic tō sōþe wāt
þæt biþ in eorle indryhten þēaw,
þæt hē his ferðlocan fæste binde,
healde his hordcofan, hycge swā hē wille;
ne mæg wērig mōd wyrde wiðstōndan [15]
nē sē hrēo hyge helpe gefrēmman:
for ðon dōmgeorne drēorigne oft
in hyra brēostcofan bindað fæste.
Swā ic mōdsefan mīnne sceolde
oft earmcearig ēðle bidæled, [20]
frēomægum feor feterum sǣlan,
siþþan gēara iū goldwine mīnne
hrūsan heolster biwrāh, and ic hēan þōnan
wōð wintercearig ofer waþema gebind,

sōhte seȝle drēorig sinces bryttan, [25]
 hwær ic feor oþþe nēah findan meahte
 þone þe in meoduhealle ⁴ miltse wisse
 oþþe mec frēondlēasne frēfran wolde,
 wēnian mid wynnum. Wāt sē þe cunnað
 hū slīpen bið sorg tō gefēran [30]
 þām þe him lýt hafað lēofra geholena:
 warað hine wræclāst, nāles wunden gold,
 ferðloca frēorig, nālæs foldan blæd;
 gemon hē seȝlesęcgas and sincþeȝe,
 hū hine on geoguðe his goldwine [35]
 wēnede tō wiste: wyn eal gedrēas!
 For þon wāt sē þe sceal his winedryhtnes
 lēofes lārcwidum lōnge forþolian,
 ðonne sorg and slāp sōmod ætgædre
 earmne ānhagan oft gebindað: [40]
 þinceð him on mōde þæt hē his mōndryhten
 clyppe and cysse, and on cnēo lęcge
 hōnda and hēafod, swā hē hwīlum ær
 in gēardagum giefstōles brēac;
 ðonne onwæcneð eft winelēas guma, [45]
 gesihð him biforan fealwe wægās,
 baþian brimfuglas, brædan feþra,
 hrēosan hrīm and snāw hagle gemęnged.
 Þonne bēoð þȳ hefigran heortan þenne,
 sāre æfter swæsne; sorg bið genīwad; [50]
 þonne māga gemynd mōd geondhweorfeð,
 grēteð glīwstafum, georne geondscēawað.
 Sęcga geseldan swimmað eft on weg;
 flēotendra ferð ⁵ nō þær fela bringeð
 cūðra cwidegiedda; cearo ⁶ bið genīwad [55]
 þām þe sęndan sceal swīþe geneahhe

ofer waþema gebind wērigne sefan.
 For þon ic geþencan ne mæg geond þās woruld
 for hwan mōdsefa mīn ne gesweorce,
 þonne ic eorla līf eal geondþence, [60]
 hū hī færlīce flēt ofgēafon,
 mōdge maguþegnas. Swā þēs middangeard
 ealra dōgra gehwām drēoseð and fealleþ;
 for þon ne mæg weorþan wīs wer, ær hē āge
 wintra dæl in woruldrīce. Wita sceal geþyldig, [65]
 ne sceal nō tō hātheort nē tō hrædwyrde,
 nē tō wāc wiga nē tō wanhȳdig,
 nē tō forht nē tō fægen nē tō feohgīfre,
 nē næfre gielpes tō georn, ær hē geare cunne.
 Beorn sceal gebīdan, þonne hē bēot spriceð, [70]
 oþ þæt collenferð cunne gearwe
 hwider hreþra gehygd hweorfan wille.
 Ongietan sceal glēaw hæle hū gæstlīc bið,
 þonne eall þisse worulde wela wēste stōndeð,
 swā nū missenlīce geond þisne middangeard [75]
 winde biwāune ⁷ weallas stōndaþ,
 hrīme bihrorene, ⁸ hryðge þā ederas.
 Wōriað þā wīnsalo, ⁹ waldend licgað
 drēame bidrorene ¹⁰; duguð eal gecrōng
 wlōnc bī wealle: sume wīg fornōm, [80]
 fērede in forðwege; sumne fugel ¹¹ oþbær
 ofer hēanne holm; sumne sē hāra wulf
 dēaðe gedælde; sumne drēorighlēor
 in eorðscræfe eorl gehȳdde:
 ȳþde swā þisne eardgeard ælda Scyppend, [85]
 oþ þæt burgwara breahtra lēase
 eald ęnta geweorc īdlu stōdon.
 Sē þonne þisne wealsteal wīse geþōhte,

7. The MS. reading is **hryre** (nominative), which is meaningless.

8. For **ūhtna gehwylce**, see note on **cēnra gehwylcum**, p. 140.

10. **þe ... him**. See § 75 (4). Cf. *Merchant of Venice*, II, v, 50-51.

27. For **mine** (MS. **in**), which does not satisfy metrical requirements, I adopt Kluge's plausible substitution of **miltse**; **miltse witan** = *to show (know, feel), pity*. The **myne wisse** of *Beowulf* (l. 169) is metrically admissible.

37. The object of **wāt** is **þinceð him on mōde**; but the construction is unusual, inasmuch as both **þæt's** (**þæt** pronominal before **wāt** and **þæt** conjunctive before **þinceð**) are omitted. See p. 112, ll. 18-19.

41. **þinceð him on mōde** (see note on **him ... þioden**, p. 147). "No more sympathetic picture has been drawn by an Anglo-Saxon poet than where the wanderer in exile falls asleep at his oar and dreams again of his dead lord and the old hall and revelry and joy and gifts,—then wakes to look once more upon the waste of ocean, snow and hail falling all around him, and sea-birds dipping in the spray." (Gummere, *Germanic Origins*, p. 221.)

53-55. **Sęcga ... cwidegiedda** = *But these comrades of warriors [= those seen in vision] again swim away [= fade away]; the ghost of these fleeting ones brings not there many familiar words; i.e. he sees in dream and vision the old familiar faces, but no voice is heard: they bring neither greetings to him nor tidings of themselves.*

65. **Wita sceal gepyldig.** Either **bēon** (**wesan**) is here to be understood after **sceal**, or **sceal** alone means *ought to be*. Neither construction is to be found in Alfredian prose, though the omission of a verb of motion after **sculan** is common in all periods of Old English. See note on **nō ... meahte**, p. 140.

75. **swā nū.** “The Old English lyrical feeling,” says Ten Brink, citing the lines that immediately follow **swā nū**, “is fond of the image of physical destruction”; but I do not think these lines have a merely figurative import. The reference is to a period of real devastation, antedating the Danish incursions. “We might fairly find such a time in that parenthesis of bad government and of national tumult which filled the years between the death of Aldfrith in 705 and the renewed peace of Northumbria under Ceolwulf in the years that followed 729.” (Brooke, *Early Eng. Lit.*, p. 355.)

93. **cwōm ... gesetu.** Ettmüller reads **cwōmon**; but see p. 107, note on **wæs ... þā īgland**. The occurrence of **hwær cwōm** three times in the preceding line tends also to hold **cwōm** in the singular when its plural subject follows. Note the influence of a somewhat similar structural parallelism in *seas hides* of these lines (*Winter’s Tale*, IV, IV, 500-502):

“Not for ... all the *sun sees* or
The close *earth wombs* or the profound *seas*
hides
In unknown fathoms, will I break my oath.”

111. **gesæt ... rūne**, *sat apart to himself in silent meditation*.

114. **eorl ... gefrēmmān.** Supply **sceal** after **eorl**.

- 1 = Metodes.
- 2 = earfoþa.
- 3 = sweotole.
- 4 = medu-.
- 5 = ferhð.
- 6 = cearu.
- 7 = See bewāwan.
- 8 = See behrēosan.
- 9 = wīnsalu.
- 10 = See bedrēosan.
- 11 = fugol.
- 12 = ferhðe.
- 13 = magu.
- 14 = -hliðu.

I. GLOSSARY.



OLD ENGLISH—MODERN ENGLISH.

[The order of words is strictly alphabetical, except that **ð** follows **t**. The combination **æ** follows **ad**.

Gender is indicated by the abbreviations, m. (= masculine), f. (= feminine), n. (= neuter). The usual abbreviations are employed for the cases, nom., gen., dat., acc., and instr. Other abbreviations are sing. (= singular), pl. (= plural), ind. (= indicative mood), sub. (= subjunctive mood), pres. (= present tense), pret. (= preterit tense), prep. (= preposition), adj. (= adjective), adv. (= adverb), part. (= participle), conj. (= conjunction), pron. (= pronoun), intrans. (= intransitive), trans. (= transitive).

Figures not preceded by § refer to page and line of the texts.

A B C D E F G H I K L
M N O P R S T ð U W Y

A.

ā, *ever, always, aye*.

abbudisse, f., *abbess* [Lat. *abbatissa*].

ābēodan (§ 109), *bid, offer*;

him hæl ābēad 138, 9 = *bade him hail, wished him health*.

ābrecan (§ 120, Note 2), *break down, destroy*.

ābūgan (§ 109, Note 1), *give way, start* [bow away].

ac, conj., *but*.

ācweðan (§ 115), *say, speak*.

ācȳðan (§ 126), *reveal, proclaim* [cūð].

ād, m., *funeral pile*.

adesa, m., *adze, hatchet*.

ǣ (ǣw), f., *law*.

ǣdre (ēdre), f., *stream, canal, vein*;

blōd ēdrum dranc 139, 4 = *drank blood in streams* (instr.).

ǣfæstnis, f., *piety*.

ǣfen-ræst, f., *evening rest*.

ǣfen-sprǣc, f., *evening speech*.

ǣfēst (ǣwfēst), *law-abiding, pious*.

ǣfēstnis, see **ǣfæstnis**.

ǣfre, *ever, always*.

ǣfter, prep. (§ 94, (1)), *after*;

ǣfter ðǣm, *after that, thereafter*;

ǣfter ðǣm ðe, conj., *after*.

æfter, adv., *after, afterwards*.

ǣghwā (§ 77, Note), *each, every*.

ǣghwīlc (§ 77, Note), *each, any*.

ǣglǣca, see **āglǣca**.

ǣgðer (ǣghwæðer, āðer) (§ 77, Note), *each, either*;

ǣgðer ... oðer ... oðer, *either ... or ... or*;

ǣgðer ge ... ge (§ 95, (2)), *both ... and*;
ǣgðer ge ... ge ... ge, *both ... and ... and*.

ǣht, f., *property, possession* [ǣgan].

ǣlc (§ 77), *each*.

ǣlde (ielde) (§ 47), m. pl., *men*; gen. pl., **ǣlda**.

ǣlmihtig, *almighty*.

ǣmetta, m., *leisure* [empti-ness].

ǣnig (§ 77), *any*;

ǣnige ðinga 141, 22 = *for anything*.

(See 140, 15, Note.)

ǣr, adv., *before, formerly, sooner*;

nō þȳ ǣr 140, 1 = *none the sooner*;

ǣror, comparative, *before, formerly*;

ǣrest, superlative, *first*.

ǣr, conj. (§ 105, 2), *ere, before* = **ǣr ðǣm ðe**.

ǣr, prep, with dat., *before (time)*;

ǣr ðǣm ðe, conj. (§ 105, 2), *before*.

ærcebisceop, m., *archbishop* [Lat. archiepiscopus].

ǣrendgewrit, n., *message, letter*.

ǣrendwreca (-raca), m., *messenger*.

ǣrest, adj. (§ 96, (4)), *first*.

ærnan (§ 127), *ride, gallop* [iernan].

ǣrra, adj. (§ 96, (4)), *former*.

ǣrwela, m., *ancient wealth*.

æsc, m., *ash, spear*; gen. pl., **asca**.

Æscesdūn, f., *Ashdown* (in Berkshire).

æstel, m., *book-mark* [Lat. hastula].

æt (§ 94, (1)), *at, in*;

with **leornian**, *to learn*, **geðicgan**, *to receive*, and other verbs of similar import,

æt = *from*: 115, 18; 137, 8, etc.

ætberan (§ 114), *bear to, hand*.

ætɡæd(e)re, adv., *together*.

ætsteppan (§ 116), *step up, advance*; pret. sing., **ætstōp**.

æðele, *noble, excellent*.

æðeling, m., *a noble, prince*.

Æðelwulfing, m., *son of Ethelwulf*.

Æðered, m., *Ethelred*.

āfeallan (§ 117), *fall*.

āfierran (§ 127), *remove* [**feor**].

āgan (§ 136), *to own, possess*.

āgen, adj.-part., *own*; dat. sing., **āgnum** [**āgan**].

āgiefan (§ 115), *give back*.

āglæca (**āglæca**), m., *monster, champion*.

āhton, see **āgan**.

ālātan (§ 117), *let go, leave*.

aldor, see **ealdor**.

ālęcgan (§ 125, Note), *lay down* [**licgan**]; past part., **ālēd**.

Āliesend, m., *Redeemer* [**ālīesan** = *release, ransom*].

ālimpan (§ 110), *befall, occur*.

ālȳfan (§ 126), *entrust, permit*.

ambor, m., *measure*; gen. pl., **ambra** (§ 27, (4)).

ambyre, *favorable*.

ān (§ 89), *one*;

āna, *alone, only*;

ānra gehwylcum 141, 15 = *to each one*.

 (See 140, 15, Note.)

anda, m., *zeal, injury, indignation*;

hæleðum on andan 153, 6 = *harmful to men*.

andēfn, f., *proportion, amount*.

andgiet (-git), n., *sense, meaning*.

andgitfullīce, *intelligibly*;

-gitfullīcost, *superlative*.

andswaru, f., *answer*.

andwyrðan (§ 127), *to answer*; pret., **andwyrde**.

Angel, n., *Anglen* (in Denmark); dat. sing., **Angle** (§ 27 (4)).

Angelcynn, n., *English kin, English people, England*.

ānhaga (-hoga), m., *a solitary, wanderer* [ān + **hogian**, *to meditate*].

ānlīpig, *single, individual*.

ānunga (§ 93, (2)), *once for all* [ān].

apostol, m., *apostle* [Gr. ἀπόστολος].

ār, f., *honor, property, favor*;

āre gebīdeð 148, 3 = *waits for divine favor* (gen.).

āræd, adj., *inexorable*.

ārædan (§ 126), *read*.

ārecc(e)an (§ 128), *translate, expound*.

ārfæstnis, f., *virtue*.

ārīsan (§ 102), *arise*.

asca, see **aesc**.

āsecgan (§ 132), *say, relate*.

āsettan (§ 127), *set, place*.

āsingan (§ 110), *sing*.

āspendan (§ 127), *spend, expend*.

āstīgan (§ 102), *ascend, arise*.

āstōndan (§ 116), *stand up*.

ātēah, see **ātēon**.

atelīc, *horrible, dire*.

ātēon (§ 118), *draw, draw away, take* (as a journey).

atol, *horrible, dire*.

āttor, n., *poison*.

ātuge, see **ātēon**.

āð, m., *oath*.

āðer, see **ægðer**.

āweccan (§ 128), *awake, arouse*; pret. sing., **āweahte**, **āwehte**.

aweg, *away*.

āwendan (§ 127), *turn, translate*.

āwrītan (§ 102), *write, compose*.

āwyrčan (§ 128), *work, do, perform*.

B.

Bāchseċg, m., *Bagsac*.

bæcbord, n., *larboard, left side of a ship*.

bāel, n., *funeral fire, funeral pile*.

bān, n., *bone*.

bān-fāg, *adorned with bones or antlers*.

bān-locā, m., *flesh* [bone-locker].

Basengas, m. pl., *Basing* (in Hantshire).

be (**bī**) (§ 94, (1)), *by, about, concerning, near, along, according to*;

be norðan þāem wēstenne (§ 94, (4)), *north of the waste (desert)*;

be fullan, *fully, perfectly*.

bēag, see **būgan**.

bēag-hroden, *ring-adorned*.

bēah (**bēag**), m., *ring, bracelet, collar* [**būgan**].

bealo-nīð, m., *dire hatred, poison, venom*.

bearn, n., *child, son* [bairn].

bebēodan (§ 109), *command, bid, entrust* (with dat.).

bebīo-, see **bebēo-**.

bebohte, see **bebycgan**.

bebycgan (§ 128), *sell*.

bēc, see **bōc**.

becuman (§ 114), *come, arrive, befall*.

bedāelan (§ 126), *separate, deprive*.

bedrēosan (§ 109), *deprive*; past part. pl., **bedrorene** (**bidrorene**) [dross, dreary].

befāestan (§ 127), *fasten, implant*.

befēolan (§ 110), *apply one's self*;

ðāra ðe ðā spēða hæbben ðæt hīe ðæm befēolan mægen 119, 20 = *of those who have the means by which they may apply themselves to it.*

beforan, prep. with dat., *before*.

bēgen (declined like **twēgen**, § 89), *both*.

begeondan (**begiondan**), prep. with dat., *beyond*.

begietan (§ 115), *get, obtain, find*.

beginnan (§ 110), *begin*.

beheonan (**behionan**), prep. with dat., *on this side of*.

behreōsan (§ 109), *fall upon, cover*; past part. pl., **behrorene** (**bihrorene**).

belimpan (§ 110), *pertain, belong*.

beniman (§ 114), *take, derive*.

benn, f., *wound* [**bana** = *murderer*].

bēon (**bīon**) (§ 134), *be, consist*.

beorh (**beorg**, **biorh**), m., *mound* [barrow].

beorht, *bright, glorious*.

Beormas, m. pl., *Permians*.

beorn, m., *man, hero, chief*.

bēor-þegu, f., *beer-drinking* [**þicgan** = *receive*].

bēot, n., *boast*.

beran (§ 114), *bear*.

berēafian (§ 130), *bereave*;

since **berēafod 145, 22** = *bereft of treasure*.

beren, adj., *of a bear, bear*.

berstan (§ 110), *burst, crack*.

besmiðian (§ 130), *make hard* (as at the forge of a smith).

bet, see **wel** (§ 97, (2)).

bētan (§ 126), *make good, requite*; past part. pl., **gebētte**.

bętera (**bętra**), see **gōd** (§ 96, (3)).

betlīc, *excellent*.

bętsta, see **gōd** (§ 96, (3)).

betuh (**betux**) (§ 94, (1)), *between*.

betwēonan (§ 94, (1)), *between*.

betȳnan (§ 126), *close, end* [**tūn** = *enclosure*].

bewāwan (§ 117), *blow upon*; past part. pl., **bewāune** (**biwāune**, **bewāwene**).

bewrēon (§ 118, 1), *enwrap*; pret. 3d sing., **bewrāh** (**biwrāh**).

bī, see **be**.

bi-, see **be-**.

bīdan (§ 102), *bide, await, expect, endure* (with gen.).

biddan (§ 115, Note 2), *bid, pray, request* (§ 65, Note 3);

bæd hine blīðne 136, 7 = *bade him be blithe*.

bindan (§ 110), *bind*.

bīo, see **bēo** (imperative sing.).

bisceop (**biscep**), m., *bishop* [Lat. *episcopus*].

bisceop-stōl, m., *episcopal seat, bishopric*.

bisigu, f., *business, occupation*; dat. pl., **bisgum**.

bītan (§ 102), *bite, cut*.

biwrāh, see **bewrēon**.

blæd, m., *glory, prosperity* [**blāwan** = *blow, inflate*].

Blēcinga-ēg, f., *Blekingen*.

bliss, f., *bliss* [**blīðe**].

blīðe, *blithe, happy*.

blōd, n., *blood*.

bōc (§ 68, (1), Note 1), f., *book*.

bōcere, m., *scribe* [**bōc**].

bōna (**bana**), m., *murderer* [**bane**].

bōt, f., *boot, remedy, help, compensation*.

brād (§ 96, (1)), *broad*.

brædan (§ 126), *extend, spread* [**brād**].

brædra, see **brād**.

brægd, see **bregdan**.

brēac, see **brūcan**.

breahm, m., *noise, revelry*;

burgwara breahma lēase 152, 10 = *bereft of the revelries of citizens*.

bregdan (§ 110), *brandish, draw* [braid]; pret. ind. 3d sing., **brægd**.

brenting, m., *high ship*.

brēost, n., *breast* (the pl. has the same meaning as the sing.).

brēost-cofa, m., *breast-chamber, heart, mind*.

brēost-gehygd, n., *breast-thought, thought of the heart, emotion*.

brim, n., *sea, ocean*.

brimfugol, m., *sea-fowl*.

bringan (§ 128), *bring*.

brōhte, **brōhton**, see **bringan**.

brōðor (**brōður**) (§ 68, (2)), m., *brother*.

brūcan (§ 109, Note 1), *use, enjoy* (§ 62, Note 1; but Alfred frequently employs the acc. with **brūcan**).

brycg, f., *bridge*.

brȳcð, see **brūcan**.

brytta, m., *distributor, dispenser* [**brēotan** = *break in pieces*].

būan (§ 126, Note 2), *dwell, cultivate* [bower].

būde, see **būan**.

bufan, prep. with dat. and acc., *above*.

būgan (§ 109, Note 1), *bow, bend, turn*.

bune, f., *cup*.

burg (**burh**) (§ 68, (1), Note), f., *city, borough*; dat. sing., **byrig**.

Burgenda, m. gen. pl., *of the Burgundians*;

Burgenda land, *Bornholm*.

burgware (§ 47), m. pl., *burghers, citizens*.

burh, see **burg**.

būtan (**būton**), prep. (§ 94, (1)), *without, except, except for, but*.

būtan (**būton**), conj., *except that, unless*.

būtū, *both* (= *both—two*).

The word is compounded of the combined neuters of **bēgen** and **twēgen**, but is m. and f. as well as n.).

bȳn (§ 126, Note 2), *cultivated*.

byrde, adj., *of high rank, aristocratic*.

byrig, see **burg**.

byrne, f., *byrnie, corselet, coat of mail*.

byrnwiga, m., *byrnie-warrior, mailed soldier*.

byrð, see **beran**.

C.

canōn, m., *sacred canon, Bible* [Lat. canon, Gr. κανών].

cearu (**cearo**), f., *care*.

ceaster-būend, m., *castle-dweller*.

cēne, *keen, bold, brave*.

cēosan (§ 109), *choose, accept, encounter*.

cild, n., *child*.

cirice, f., *church*; nom. pl., **ciricean**.

cirr (**cierr**), m., *turn, time, occasion* [char, chore, ajar = on char, on the turn].

cirran (§ 127), *turn*.

clāne, *clean, pure*.

clāne, adv., *entirely* [“clean out of the way,” Shaks.].

clūdig, *rocky* [having boulders or masses like *clouds*].

clyppan (§ 127), *embrace, accept* [clip = clasp for letters, papers, etc.].

cnapa, m., *boy* [knave].

cnēo (**cnēow**), n., *knee*; acc. pl., **cnēo**.

cniht, m., *knight, warrior*.

cnyssan (§ 125), *beat*.

collenferð (**-ferhð**), *proud-minded, fierce*.

costnung, f., *temptation*.

Crēcas (**Crēacas**), m. pl., *Greeks*.

cringan (§ 110), *cringe, fall*.

Crīst, m., *Christ*.

Crīsten, *Christian*; nom. pl. m., **Crīstene**, **Crīstne**.

cuma, m., *new-comer, stranger*.

cuman (§ 114), *come*. (See p. 138, Note on ll. 2-6.)

cunnan (§ 137), *know, can, understand*.

cunnian (§ 130), *make trial of, experience* [**cunnan**].

cure, see **cēosan**.

cūð, *well-known, familiar* [past part. of **cunnan**: cf. *uncouth*].

cūðe, **cūðen**, **cūðon**, see **cunnan**.

cwæden, **cwædon**, see **cweðan**.

cwalu, f., *death, murder* [**cwelan**].

cwealm-cuma, m., *murderous comer*.

cwelan (§ 114), *die* [to quail].

cwēn, f., *queen*.

Cwēnas, m. pl., *a Finnish tribe*.

cweðan (§ 115), *say, speak* [quoth, bequeath].

cwic, *living, alive* [quicksilver; the quick and the dead].

cwidegiedd, n., *word, utterance* [**cweðan** and **gieddian**, both meaning to *speak*].

cwīðan (§ 126), *bewail* (trans.).

cwōm, see **cuman**.

cyle (**ciele**), m., *cold* [chill];

cyle gewyrca 110, 7 = *produce cold, freeze*.

cyme, m., *coming* [**cuman**].

cyn(n), n., *kin, race*.

cyn(n), adj. (used only in pl.), *fitting things, etiquette, proprieties, courtesies*;

cynna gemyndig 136, 3 = *mindful of courtesies*.

cynerīce, n., *kingdom*.

cyning, m., *king*.

cyssan (§ 125), *kiss*.

cyst, f., *the choice, the pick, the best* [cēosan].

cȳðan (§ 126), *make known, display*, [cūð];

2d sing. imperative, **cȳð**.

D.

dæd, f., *deed*.

dæg, m., *day*.

dæg-hwīl, f., *day-while, day*;

hē dæg-hwīla gedrogen hæfde eorðan wynne 145, 2 = *he had spent his days of earth's joy*.

dæg-rīm, n., **number of days** [day-rime];

dōgera daeg-rīm 143, 7 = *the number of his days*.

dæl, n., *dale*.

dæl, m., *part, deal, division*.

dēad, *dead*.

dēað, m., *death*.

dēman (§ 126), *deem, judge*.

Denamearc, see **Denemearc**.

Dene (§ 47), m. pl., *Danes*.

Denemearc (**Denemearce**), f., *Denmark*; dat. sing., **Denemearce** (strong),
Denemearcan (weak).

Denisc, *Danish*;

ðā Deniscan, *the Danes*.

dēofol, m., n., *devil*; gen. sing., **dēofles** (§ 27, (4)).

dēope, *deeply, profoundly* [**dēop**].

dēor, n., *wild animal* [deer].

deorc, *dark, gloomy*.

dōgor, n., *day*; gen. pl., **dōgora, dōgera, dōgra**.

dōgor-gerīm, n., *number of days, lifetime*.

dōm, m., *doom, judgment, glory*.

dōmgeorn, adj., *eager for glory* [doom-yearning].
dōn (§ 135), *do, cause, place, promote, remove*.
dorste, dorston, see **durran**.
drēam, m., *joy, mirth* [dream].
drēogan (§ 109), *endure, enjoy, spend* [Scotch dree].
drēorig, *dreary, sad*.
drēorighlēor, adj., *with sad face* [**hlēor** = *cheek, face, leer*].
drēosan (§ 109), *fall, perish* [dross].
drīfan (§ 102), *drive*.
drihten, see **dryhten**.
drincan (§ 110), *drink*.
drohtoð (-að), m., *mode of living, occupation* [**drēogan**].
drugon, see **drēogan**.
dryhten (drihten), m., *lord, Lord*; dat. sing., **dryhtne**.
dryht-sele, m., *lordly hall*.
duguð, f., *warrior-band, host, retainers* [**doughtiness**].
 In **duguð** and **geogoð**, the higher (older) and lower (younger) ranks are represented, the distinction corresponding roughly to the mediæval distinction between knights and squires.
durran (§ 137), *dare*.
duru, f., *door*.
dyde, see **dōn**.
dynnan (§ 125), *resound* [din].
dýre (dīere, dēore, dīore), *dear, costly*.

E.

ēa, f., *river*; gen. sing., **ēas**; dat. and acc. sing., **ēa**.
ēac, *also, likewise* [a nickname = an eek-name. See § 65, Note 2];
ēac swilce (swelce) 112, 3 = *also*.
ēaca, m., *addition* [**ēac**];
tō ēacan = *in addition to* (§ 94, (4)).

ēage, n., *eye*.

eahta, *eight*.

ēalā, *oh! alas!*

ealað, see **ealu**.

eald (§ 96, (2)), *old*.

ealdor (**aldor**), n., *life*;

gif ðū ðæt ellenweorc aldre gedigest 138, 17 = *if thou survivest that feat with thy life* (instr.).

ealdor-dæg (**aldor-**, **ealder-**), m., *day of life*.

ealdor-gedāl (**aldor-**), n., *death* [life-deal].

ealdormōn, m., *alderman, chief, magistrate*.

ealgian, (§ 130), *protect, defend*.

eall (**eal**), *all*;

ealne weg, *all the way* (§ 98, (1));

ealneg (< **ealne weg**), *always*;

ealles (§ 98, (3)), adv., *altogether, entirely*.

Eall (**eal**) is frequently used with partitive gen. = *all of*: 143, 19; 145, 3.

ealu (**ealo**) (§ 68), n., *ale*; gen. sing., **ealað**.

ealu-scerwen, f., *mortal panic* [ale-spilling].

eard, m., *country, home* [**eorðe**].

eardgeard, m. *earth* [earth-yard].

eardian (§ 130), *dwell* [**eard**].

eardstapa, m., *wanderer* [earth-stepper].

ēare, n., *ear*.

earfoð (**earfeð**), n. *hardship, toil*; gen. pl., **earfeða**.

earfoðlic, adj., *full of hardship, arduous*.

earm, m., *arm*.

earm, adj., *poor, wretched*.

earmcearig, *wretched, miserable*.

earmlic, *wretched, miserable*.

earnung, f., *merit* [earning].

ēast, *east*.

ēastan (§ 93, (5)), *from the east*.

Ēast-Dēne (§ 47), *East-Danes*.

ēasteward, *eastward*.

ēastrihte (**ēastryhte**) (§ 93, (6)), *eastward*.

Ēastron, pl., *Easter*.

ēaðe, *easily*.

ēaðmōdlīce, *humbly*.

eaxl, f., *shoulder* [axle].

Ebrēisc, adj., *Hebrew*.

ēce, *eternal, everlasting*.

ęcg, f., *sword* [edge].

edor, m., *enclosure, dwelling*; nom. pl., **ederas**.

ēdrum, see **ædre**.

efne, adv., *just, only* [evenly].

eft, adv., *again, afterwards* [aft].

ęgesa, m., *fear, terror* [awe].

ellen, n., *strength, courage*;

mid ęlne = *boldly*;

on ęlne 147, 17 = *mightily, suddenly, or in their (earls') strength (prime)*.

ellen-mærðu, f. *fame for strength, feat of strength*.

ellen-weorc, n., *feat of strength*.

ellenwōdnis, f., *zeal, fervor*.

ęllor-gāst, m., *inhuman monster* [alien ghost].

ęln, f., *ell* [el-bow].

ęlne, see **ellen**.

ęlra, adj. comparative, *another* [***ęle** cognate with Lat. *alius*];

on ęlran męn 139, 14 = *in another man*.

emnlong (-lang), *equally long*;

on emnlange = *along* (§ 94, (4)).

ęnde, m., *end*.

endebyrdnes, f., *order*.

ende-dæg, m., *end-day, day of death*.

ende-lāf, f., *last remnant* [end-leaving].

engel, m., *angel* [Lat. *angelus*].

Englafeld (§ 51), m., *Englefield* (in Berkshire).

Engle (§ 47), m. pl., *Angles*.

Englisc, adj., *English*;

on **Englisc** 117, 18 and 19 = *in English, into English*.

Engliscgereord, n., *English language*.

ent, m., *giant*.

ēode, see **gān**.

eodorcan (§ 130), *ruminate*.

eorl, m., *earl, warrior, chieftain*.

eorlīc, *earl-like, noble*.

eorð-draca, m., **dragon** [earth-drake].

eorðe, f., *earth*.

eorð-reċed, n., *earth-hall*.

eorðscræf, n., *earth-cave, grave*.

eoten, m., *giant, monster*.

ēow, see **ðū**.

Ēowland, n., *Öland* (an island in the Baltic Sea).

erian (§ 125), *plow* [to ear].

Estland, n., *land of the Estas* (on the eastern coast of the Baltic Sea).

Estmere, m., *Frische Haff*.

Estum, dat. pl., *the Estas*.

etan (§ 115), *eat* [**ort**].

ettan (§ 127), *graze* [**etan**].

ēðel, m., *territory, native land* [allodial].

ēðel-weard, m., *guardian of his country*.

F.

fæc, n., *interval, space*.

fæder (§ 68, (2)), m., *father*.

fægen, *fain, glad, exultant*.

fæger (**fæger**), *fair, beautiful*.

fælsian (§ 130), *cleanse*.

færlīce, *suddenly* [**fær** = *fear*].

fæst, *fast, held fast*.

fæste, adv., *fast, firmly*.

fæstnung, f., *security, safety*.

fæt, n., *vessel* [wine-fat, vat].

fætels, m., *vessel*; acc. pl., **fætels**.

fæðm, m., *embrace, bosom* [fathom = the space *embraced* by the extended arms].

fāg (**fāh**), *hostile*;

hē wæs fāg wið God 142, 18 = *he was hostile to God*.

fāh (**fāg**), *variegated, ornamented*.

Falster, *Falster* (island in the Baltic Sea).

fandian (§ 130), *try, investigate* [**findan**].

faran (§ 116), *go* [fare].

feallan (§ 117), *fall, flow*.

fealu, *fallow, pale, dark*; nom. pl. m., **fealwe**.

fēawe (**fēa**, **fēawa**), pl., *few*.

fela (indeclinable), *much, many* (with gen.).

feld (§ 51), m., *field*.

fell (**fel**), n., *fell, skin, hide*.

fēng, see **fōn**.

fęn-hlið, n., *fen-slope*.

fęn-hop, n., *fen-retreat*.

feoh, n., *cattle, property* [fee]; gen. and dat. sing., **fēos**, **fēo**.

feohgīfre, *greedy of property, avaricious*.

feohtan (§ 110), *fight*.

fēol, see **feallan**.

fēond (§ 68, (3)), m., *enemy, fiend*.

fēond-grāp, f., *fiend-grip*.

feor (§ 96, (4)), adj., *far, far from* (with dat.).

feor, adv., *far, far back* (time).

feorh, m., n., *life*.

feorh-benn, f., *life-wound, mortal wound*.

feorh-leġu, f., *laying down of life*. (See p. 146, Note on l. 13.)

feorh-sēoc, *life-sick, mortally wounded*.

feorm (fiorm), f., *use, benefit (food, provisions)* [farm].

feormian (§ 130), *eat, devour*.

feorran, *from afar*.

fēowertig, *forty*; gen., **fēowertiges** (§ 91, Note 1).

ferhō (ferð), m., *heart, mind, spirit*.

ferian (§ 125), *carry, transport* [to ferry];

ferede in forðwege 152, 5 = *carried away*.

fers, n., *verse* [Lat. *versus*].

fersc, *fresh*.

ferðloca (ferhō-), m., *heart, mind, spirit* [heart-locker].

fēt, see **fōt**.

fetor, f., *fetter* [**fōt**]; instr. pl., **feterum**.

feðer, f., *feather*; acc. pl., **feðra**.

fierd, f., *English army* [**faran**].

fif, *five*.

fiftiēne, *fifteen*.

fiftig, *fifty*; gen. sing., **fiftiges** (§ 91, Note 1); dat. pl., **fiftegum** (§ 91, Note 3).

findan (§ 110), *find*.

finger, m., *finger*.

Finna, m. pl., *Fins*.

fiorm, see **feorm**.

fīras, m. pl., *men* [**feorh**]; gen. pl., **fīra**; dat. pl., **fīrum**.

firrest (**fierrest**), see **feor** (§ 96, (4)).

first, m., *time, period*.

fiscað (**fiscnað**), m., *fishing*.

fiscere, m., *fisherman*.

fiscnað, see **fiscað**.

flēon (§ 118, II.), *flee*.

flēotan (§ 109), *float*.

flēt, n., *floor of the hall*.

flōd, m., *flood, wave*.

folc, n., *folk, people*.

folc-cwēn, f., *folk-queen*.

folc-cyning, m., *folk-king*.

folcgefeoht, n., *folk-fight, battle, general engagement*.

fold-bold, n., *earth-building, hall*.

folde, f., *earth, land, country* [**feld**].

folm, f., *hand* [**fēlan** = *feel*].

fōn (§ 118), *seize, capture, take* [*fang*];

tō rīce fōn = *come to (ascend) the throne*.

for (§ 94, (1)), *for, on account of*;

for ðāem (**ðe**), **for ðon** (**ðe**), *because*;

for ðon, **for ðȳ**, **for ðāem** (**for-ðām**), *therefore*.

fōr, see **faran**.

forbærnan (§ 127), *burn thoroughly* [**for** is intensive, like Lat. *per*].

forgiefan (**-gifan**) (§ 115), *give, grant*.

forhęrgian (§ 130), *harry, lay waste*.

forhogdnis, f., *contempt*.

forht, *fearful, afraid*.

forhwæga, *about, at least*.

forlātan (§ 117), *abandon, leave*.

forlēt, **forlēton**, see **forlātan**.

forma, *first*;

forman sīðe, *the first time* (instr.).

forniman (§ 114), *take off, destroy*.

forspendan (§ 127), *spend, squander*.

forstondan (-standan) (§ 116), *understand*.

forswāpan (§ 117), *sweep away*; pret. 3d sing. indic., **forswēop**.

forswerian (§ 116), *for swear* (with dat.); past part., **forsworen**.

forð, *forth, forward*.

forðolian (§ 130), *miss, go without* (with dat.) [not to *thole* or experience].

forðweg, m., *way forth*;

in forðwege, *away*.

fōt (§ 68, (1)), m. *foot*.

Fræna, m., *Frene*.

frætwe, f. pl., *fretted armor, jewels* [fret].

fram, see **frōm**.

frēa, m., *lord, Lord*.

frēa-drihten, m., *lord, master*.

frēfran (§ 130), *console, cheer* [**frōfor**].

frēnde, *strange, foreign*;

ðā frēmdan, *the strangers*.

frēmman (§ 125), *accomplish, perform, support* [to frame].

frēmsumnes (-nis), f., *kindness, benefit*.

frēo (**frīo**), *free*; gen. pl., **frēora** (**frīora**).

frēodōm, m., *freedom*.

frēolīc, *noble* [free-like].

frēomæg, m., *free kinsman*.

frēond (§ 68, (3)), m., *friend*.

frēondlēas, *friendless*.

frēondlice, *in a friendly manner*.

frēorig, *cold, chill* [**frēoran**].

frīora, see **frēo**.

frið, m., n., *peace, security* [bel-fry].
frōd, *old, sage, prudent*.
frōfor, f., *comfort, consolation, alleviation*;
fyrena frōfre 137, 7 = *as an alleviation of outrages* (dat.).
frōm (fram) (§ 94, (1)), *from, by*.
frōm, adv., *away, forth*.
fruma, m., *origin, beginning* [frōm].
frumsceaft, f., *creation*.
fugela, see **fugol**.
fugelere, m., *fowler*.
fugol (fugel), m., *fowl, bird*; gen. pl., **fugela**.
ful, n., *cup, beaker*.
fūl, *foul*.
fūlian (§ 130), *grow foul, decompose*.
full (ful), adj., *full* (with gen.);
be fullan, *fully, perfectly*.
full (ful) adv., *fully, very*.
fultum, m., *help*.
furðor (furður), adv., *further*.
furðum, adv., *even*.
fylð, see **feallan**.
fyren (firen), f., *crime, violence, outrage*.
fyrhtu, f., *fright, terror*; dat. sing., **fyrhtu**.
fyrst, adj., *superlative, first, chief*.
fȳsan (§ 126), *make ready, prepare* [fūs = ready];
gūðe gefȳsed 137, 9 = *ready for battle*.

G.

gād, n., *lack*.
gāest, see **gāst**.
gafol, n., *tax, tribute*.

galan (§ 116), *sing* [nightingale].

gālnes, f., *lust, impurity*.

gān (§ 134), *go*.

gār, m., *spear* [gore, gar-fish].

gār-wiga, m., *spear-warrior*.

gāst (**gæst**), m., *spirit, ghost*.

gāstlīc (**gæstlīc**), *ghastly, terrible*.

ge, *and*; see **ægðer**.

gē, *ye*; see **ðū**.

geador, *together*.

geæmetigian (§ 130), *disengage from* (with acc. of person and gen. of thing) [empty].

geærnan (§ 127), *gain by running* [**iernan**].

gēap, *spacious*.

gēar, n., *year*; gen. pl., **gēara**, is used adverbially = *of yore, formerly*.

gēardæg, m., *day of yore*.

geare (**gearo**, **gearwe**), *readily, well, clearly* [yarely].

Gēat, m., *a Geat, the Geat* (i.e. Beowulf).

Gēatas, m. pl., *the Geats* (a people of South Sweden).

Gēat-mecgas, m. pl., *Geat men* (= the fourteen who accompanied Beowulf to Heorot).

gebēorscipe, m., *banquet, entertainment*.

gebētan (§ 126), *make amends for* [**bōt**].

gebīdan (§ 102), *wait, bide one's time* (intrans.); *endure, experience* (trans., with acc.).

gebīnd, n., *commingling*.

gebīndan (§ 110), *bind*.

gebrēowan (§ 109), *brew*.

gebrowen, see **gebrēowan**.

gebūd, **gebūn**, see **būan** (§ 126, Note 2).

gebyrd, n., *rank, social distinction*.

gecēosan (§ 109), *choose, decide*.

gecnāwan (§ 117), *know, understand*.

gecoren, see **gecēosan**.

gecringan (§ 110), *fall, die* [cringe].

gedāelan (§ 126), *deal out, give*;

dēaðe gedælde 152, 7 = *apportioned to death* (dat.), or, *tore (?) in death* (instr.).

gedafenian (§ 130), *become, befit, suit* (impersonal, usually with dat., but with acc. 112, 10).

gedīgan (§ 126), *endure, survive*.

gedōn (§ 135), *do, cause, effect*.

gedræg, n., *company*.

gedrēosan (§ 109), *fall, fail*.

gedriht (**gedryht**), n., *band, troop*.

gedrogen, see **drēogan**.

gedrync, n., *drinking*.

geęndian (§ 130), *end, finish*.

gefaran (§ 116), *go, die*.

gefēa, m., *joy*.

gefeah, see **gefeohtan**.

gefeh, see **gefēon**.

gefēng, see **gefōn**.

gefeoht, n., *fight, battle*.

gefeohtan (§ 110), *fight*.

gefēon (§ 118, v.), *rejoice at* (with dat.); pret. 3d sing., **gefeah**, **gefeh**.

gefēra, m., *companion, comrade* [co-farer].

geflīeman (§ 126), *put to flight* [**flēon**].

gefohten, see **gefeohtan**.

gefōn (§ 118, vii.), *seize*.

gefōr, see **gefaran**.

gefræge, n., *hearsay, report*;

mīne gefræge (instr.) 141, 7 = *as I have heard say, according to my information.*

gefreman (§ 125), *perform, accomplish, effect.*

gefultumian (§ 130), *help* [**fultum**].

gefylce, n., *troop, division* [**folc**]; dat. pl., **gefylcum**, **gefylcium**.

gefyllan (§ 127), *fill* (with gen.); past part. pl., f., **gefylda**.

geglengan (§ 127), *adorn.*

gehātland, n., *promised land* [**gehātan** = *to promise*].

gehealdan (§ 117), *hold, maintain.*

gehieran (**gehýran**) (§ 126), *hear.*

gehiersumnes, f., *obedience.*

gehola, m., *protector* [**helan**].

gehwā (§ 77, Note), *each*;

on healfa gehwone 142, 7 (see Note 140, 15. Observe that the pron. may, as here, be masc. and the gen. fem.).

gehwæðer (§ 77, Note), *each, either, both.*

gehwylc (**gehwilc**) (§ 77, Note), *each* (with gen. pl. See Note 140, 15).

gehwyrfan (§ 127), *convert, change.*

gehýdan (§ 126), *hide, conceal, consign.*

gehygd, f., n., *thought, purpose.*

gehýran, see **gehieran**.

gehýrnes, f., *hearing*;

eal ðā hē in gehýrnesse geleornian meahte 115, 14 = *all things that he could learn by hearing.*

gelædan (§ 126), *lead.*

gelæred, part.-adj., *learned*; superlative, **gelæredest**.

gelafian (§ 130), *lave.*

gelenge, *along of, belonging to* (with dat.).

geleornian (**-liornian**) (§ 130), *learn.*

gelīce, *likewise; in like manner to* (with dat.).

geliefan (**gelyfan**) (§ 126), *believe*;

ðæt hēo on ænigne eorl gelyfde 137, 6 = *that she believed in any earl.*
gelimpan (§ 110), *happen, be fulfilled.*
gelimplic, *proper, fitting.*
gelyfan, see **geliefan**.
gelyfed, *weak, infirm [left (hand)].*
gēmdē, see **gīeman**.
gemet, n., *meter, measure, ability.*
gemētan (§ 126), *meet.*
gemōn, see **gemunan**.
gemunan (§ 136), *remember*; indic. pres. 1st and 3d sing., **gemōn**; pret. sing., **gemunde**.
gemynd, n., *memory, memorial*;
tō gemyndum 147, 5 = *as a memorial.*
gemyndgian (-mynian) (§ 130), *remember*;
mid hine gemyndgade 115, 15 = *he treasured in his memory*;
gemyne mārðo 138, 15 = *be mindful of glory* (imperative 2d sing.).
gemyndig, *mindful of* (with gen.).
genāp, see **genīpan**.
geneahhe, *enough, often*;
genehost, *superlative, very often.*
genip, n., *mist, darkness.*
genīpan (§ 102), *grow dark.*
genīwian (§ 130), *renew.*
genōh, *enough.*
genumen, see **niman**.
geoc, n., *yoke.*
gēocor, *dire, sad.*
geogoð, f., *youth, young people, young warriors.* (See **duguð**.)
geond (giond) (§ 94, (2)), *throughout [yond].*
geondhweorfan (§ 110), *pass over, traverse, recall*;
ðonne māga gemynd mōd geondhweorfeð 150, 15 = *then his mind recalls the memory of kinsmen.*

geondscēawian (§ 130), survey, review;
 georne geondscēawað 150, 16 = *eagerly surveys them*.
geondðenc(e)an (§ 128), *think over, consider*.
geong (§ 96, (2)), *young*;
 giengest, (gingest), superlative, *youngest, latest, last*.
geong = **gong**, see **gongan** (imperative 2d sing.).
gēong (gīong), see **gongan** (pret. 3d sing.).
georn (giorn), *eager, desirous, zealous, sure* [yearn].
georne, *eagerly, certainly*;
 wiste ðē geornor 143, 5 = *knew the more certainly*.
geornfulnes, f., *eagerness, zeal*.
geornlice, *eagerly, attentively*.
geornor, see **georne**.
geræcednes, f., *narration* [ræccan].
gerisenlic, *suitable, becoming*.
gerȳman (§ 126), *extend, (trans.)* [rūm].
gesæliglic, *happy, blessed* [silly].
gesamnode, see **gesomnian**.
gesceaft, f., *creature, creation, destiny* [scieppan].
gesceap, n., *shape, creation, destiny* [scieppan].
gescieldan (§ 127), *shield, defend*.
gesealde, see **gesellan**.
geseglian (§ 130), *sail*.
geselda, m., *comrade*.
gesellan (§ 128), *give*.
gesēon (gesīon) (§ 118), see, **observe**; pres. indic. 3d sing., **gesihð**.
geset, n., *habitation, seat*.
gesettan (§ 127), *set, place, establish*.
gesewen, see **sēon, gesēon** (past part.).
gesewenlic, *seen, visible* [seen-like].
gesiglan (§ 127), *sail*.

gesihð, see **gesēon**.

gesittan (§ 115, Note 2), *sit* (trans., as *to sit a horse, to sit a boat, etc.*); *sit, sit down* (intrans.).

geslægen, see **slēan** (§ 118).

gesomnian (§ 130), *assemble, collect*.

gesomnung, f., *collection, assembly*.

gestāh, see **gestīgan**.

gestaðelian (§ 130), *establish, restore* [**standan**].

gesteal, n., *establishment, foundation* [stall].

gestīgan (§ 102), *ascend, go* [stīle, stirrup, sty (= a *rising* on the eye)].

gestrangian (§ 130), *strengthen*.

gestrēon, n., *property*.

gestrȳnan (§ 126), *obtain, acquire* [**gestrēon**].

gesweorcan (§ 110), *grow dark, become sad*;

For ðon ic geðencan ne mæg geond ðās woruld for hwan mōdsefa
mīn ne gesweorce 151, 3-4 = *Therefore in this world I may not
understand wherefore my mind does not grow “black as night.”*
(Brooke.)

geswīcan (§ 102), *cease, cease from* (with gen.).

getæl, n., *something told, narrative*.

getruma, m., *troop, division*.

geðanc, m., n., *thought*.

geðeah, see **geðicgan**.

geðenc(e)an (§ 128), *think, remember, understand, consider*.

geðēodan (§ 126), *join*.

geðēode (-ðīode), n., *language, tribe*.

geðēodnis, f., *association*;

but in 112, 2 this word is used to render the Lat. *appetitus* = *desire*.

geðicg(e)an (§ 115, Note 2), *take, receive*; pret. indic. 3d sing., **geðeah**.

geðungen, part.-adj., *distinguished, excellent* [**ðēon**, *to thrive*].

geðyldig, *patient* [**ðolian**].

geweald (gewald), n., *control, possession, power* [wield].
geweorc, n., *work, labor*.
geweorðian (§ 130), *honor* [to attribute worth to].
gewīcian (§ 130), *dwell*.
gewin(n), n., *strife, struggle*.
gewindan (§ 110), *flee* [wend].
gewissian (§ 130), *guide, direct*.
gewītan (§ 102), *go, depart*.
geworht, see **gewyrcean**.
gewrit, n., *writing, Scripture*.
gewunian (§ 130), *be accustomed, be wont*.
gewyrc(e)an (§ 128), *work, create, make, produce*.
gid(d), n., *word, speech*.
giefan (§ 115), *give*.
giefstōl, m., *gift-stool, throne*.
giefu (gifu), f., *gift*.
gielp (gilp), m., n., *boast* [yelp].
gīeman (gēman) (§ 126), *endeavor, strive*.
gīet (gīt, gýt), *yet, still*.
gif (gyf), *if* [not related to *give*].
gifeðe (gyfeðe), *given, granted*.
gilp, see **gielp**.
gilp-cwide, m., *boasting speech* [yelp-speech].
gingest, see **geong** (adj.).
gιοhðo (gehðu), f., *care, sorrow, grief*.
giū (iū), *formerly, of old*.
glæd (glæd), *glad*.
glēaw, *wise, prudent*.
glīwstæf, m., *glee, joy*; instr. pl. (used adverbially), **glīwstafum** 150, 16 = *joyfully*.
God, m., *God*.

gōd (§ 96, (3)), *good*;

mid his gōdum 115, 12 = *with his possessions (goods)*.

godcund, *divine* [**God**].

godcundlice, *divinely*.

gold, n., *gold*.

gold-æht, f., *gold treasure*.

gold-fāh, *gold-adorned*.

gold-hroden, part.-adj., *gold-adorned*.

goldwine, m., *prince, giver of gold, lord* [gold-friend].

gomel (**gomol**), *old, old man*.

gongan (**gangan**) (§ 117), *go* [gang]; imperative 2d sing., **geong**; pret.

sing., **gēong**, **gīong**, **gēng**; past part., **gegongen**, **gegangen**.

The most commonly used pret. is **ēode**, which belongs to **gān** (§ 134).

Gotland, n., *Jutland* (in *Ohthere's Second Voyage*), *Gothland* (in *Wulfstan's Voyage*).

gram, *grim, angry, fierce, the angry one*.

grāp, f., *grasp, clutch, claw*.

grētan (§ 126), *greet, attack, touch*.

grōwan (§ 117, (2)), *grow*.

gryre-lēoð, n., *terrible song* [grisly lay].

guma, m., *man, hero* [groom; see § 65, Note 1].

gūð, f., *war, battle*.

gūð-bill, n., *sword* [war-bill].

gūð-gewæde, n., *armor* [war-weeds].

gūð-hrēð, f., *war-fame*.

gūð-wine, m., *sword* [war-friend].

gyddian (§ 130), *speak formally*, **chant** [giddy; the original meaning of *giddy* was *mirthful*, as when one sings].

gyf, see **gif**.

gyfeðe, see **gifeðe**.

gyldan (**gielðan**) (§ 110), *pay*; indic. 3d sing., **gylt**.

gylden, *golden* [**gold**].

H.

habban (§ 133), *have*.

hād, m., *order, rank, office, degree* [-hood, -head].

hæfta, m., *captive*.

hægel (**hagol**), m., *hail*; instr. sing., **hagle**.

hæglfaru, f., *hail-storm* [hail-faring].

hæle, see **hæleð**.

hæl, f., *hail, health, good luck*.

hæleð (**hæle**), m., *hero, warrior*.

hæt, see **hātan**.

hæðen, *heathen*.

Hæðum (**æt Hæðum**), *Haddeby* (= Schleswig).

hāl, *hale, whole*.

hālettan (§ 127), *greet, salute* [to hail].

Halfdene, *Halfdane* (proper name).

hālga, m., *saint*.

Hālgoland, *Halgoland* (in ancient Norway).

hālig, *holy*.

hālignes, f., *holiness*.

hām, m., *home*; dat. sing., **hāme**, **hām** (p. 104, Note);

used adverbially in **hām ēode** 112, 18 = *went home*.

hand, see **hond**.

hār, *hoary, gray*.

hāt, *hot*.

hātan (§ 117, Note 2), *call, name, command*; pret. sing., **heht**, **hēt**.

hātheort, *hot-hearted*.

hätte, see **hātan**.

hē, **hēo**, **hit** (§ 53), *he, she, it*.

hēafod, n., *head*.

hēah (§ 96, (2)), *high*; acc. sing, m., **hēanne**.

hēah-sele, m., *high hall*.

hēahðungen, *highly prosperous, aristocratic* [**hēah** + past part. of **ðeon** (§ 118)].

healdan (§ 117), *hold, govern, possess*;

144, 9 = *hold up, sustain*.

healf, adj., *half*.

healf, f., *half, side, shore*.

heall, f., *hall*.

heals, m., *neck*.

hēan, *abject, miserable*.

hēanne, see **hēah**.

heard, *hard*.

heard-hicgende, *brave-minded* [hard-thinking].

hearm-scaða, m., *harmful foe* [harm-scather].

hearpe, f., *harp*.

heaðo-dēor, *battle-brave*.

heaðo-mære, *famous in battle*.

heaðo-wylm, m., *flame-surge, surging of fire* [battle-welling].

hēawan (§ 117), *hew, cut*.

hebban, **hōf**, **hōfon**, **gehafen** (§ 117), *heave, lift, raise*.

hefig, *heavy, oppressive*.

heht, see **hātan**.

helan (§ 114), *conceal*.

hell, f., *hell*.

helm, m., *helmet*.

Helmingas, m. pl., *Helmings* (Wealtheow, Hrothgar's queen, is a Helming).

help, f., *help*.

helpan (§ 110), *help* (with dat.).

heofon, m., *heaven*.

heofonlīc, *heavenly*.

heofonrīce, n., *kingdom of heaven*.

hēold, see **healdan**.

heolstor (-ster), n., *darkness, concealment, cover* [holster].

heora (hiera), see **hē**.

heord, f., *care, guardianship* [hoard].

heoro-drēorig, *bloody* [sword-dreary].

Heorot, *Heorot, Hart* (the famous hall which Hrothgar built).

heorte, f., *heart*.

hēr, *here, hither*;

in the *Chronicle* the meaning frequently is *at this date, in this year*: [99](#), [1](#).

here, m., *Danish army*.

herenis, f., *praise*.

hergian (§ [130](#)), *raid, harry, ravage* [**here**].

hergung, f., *harrying, plundering*.

herian (herigean) (§ [125](#)), *praise*.

hērsumedon, see **hērsumian**.

hēt, see **hātan**.

hider (hieder), *hither*.

hiera, see **hē**.

hīeran (hȳran) (§ [126](#)), *hear, belong*.

hierde, m., *shepherd, instigator* [keeper of a *herd*].

hierdebōc, f., *pastoral treatise* [shepherd-book, a translation of Lat. *Cura Pastoralis*].

hīerra, see **hēah**.

hērsumian (hȳr-, hēr-) (§ [130](#)), *obey* (with dat.).

hige (hyge), m., *mind, heart*.

hige-ðihtig, *bold-hearted*.

hild, f., *battle*.

hilde-dēor, *battle-brave*.

hilde-mecg, m., *warrior*.

hilde-sæd, *battle-sated*.

hin-fūs, *eager to be gone* [hence-ready].

hira, see **hē**.

hlǣw (**hlāw**), m., *mound, burial mound* [Ludlow and other place-names, low meaning *hill*].

hlāford, m., *lord, master* [loaf-ward?].

hleahtor, m., *laughter*.

hlēo, m., *refuge, protector* [lee].

hlīfian (§ 130), *rise, tower*.

hlyn, m., *din, noise*.

hlynsian (§ 130), *resound*.

hof, n., *court, abode*.

hogode, see **hycgan**.

holm, m., *sea, ocean*.

hƿond (**hand**), f., *hand*;

on gehwæðre hƿond, *on both sides*.

hord, m., n., *hoard, treasure*.

hordcofa, m., *breast, heart* [hoard-chamber]

hors, n., *horse*.

horshwæl, m., *walrus*.

hrædwyrde, *hasty of speech* [**hræd** = *quick*].

hrægel, n., *garment*; dat. sing., **hrægle**.

hrān, m., *reindeer*.

hraðe, *quickly, soon* [*rath-er*].

hrēo (**hrēoh**), *rough, cruel, sad*.

hrēosan (§ 109), *fall*.

hrēran (§ 126), *stir*.

hreðer, m., n., *breast, purpose*; dat. sing., **hreðre**.

hrīm, m., *rime, hoarfrost*.

hrīmceald, *rime-cold*.

hring, m., *ring, ring-mail*.

hrīð, f. (?), *snow-storm*.

hrōf, m., *roof*.

Hrones næss, literally *Whale's Ness, whale's promontory*;
see **næss**.

hrūse, f., *earth* [**hrēosan**: deposit].

hryre, m., *fall, death* [**hrēosan**].

hryðer, n., *cattle* [rinder-pest].

hryðig, *ruined (?)*, *storm-beaten*; nom. pl. m., **hryðge**.

hū, *how*.

Humbre, f., *river Humber*.

hund, *hundred*.

hunig, n., *honey*.

hunta, m., *hunter*.

huntoð (-tað), m., *hunting*.

hūru, adv., *about*.

hūs, n., *house*.

hwā, **hwæt** (§ 74), *who? what?* **swā hwæt swā** (§ 77, Note), *whatsoever*;
indefinite, *any one, anything*;
for **hwan** (instr.), *wherefore*.

hwæl, m., *whale*.

hwælhunta, m., *whale-hunter*.

hwælhuntað, m., *whale-fishing*.

hwær, *where?* **hwær ... swā**, *wheresoever*;
wel hwær, *nearly everywhere*.

hwæthwugu, *something*.

hwæðer, *whether, which of two?*

hwæðre, *however, nevertheless*.

hwēne, see **hwōn**.

hweorfan (§ 110), *turn, go*.

hwider, *whither*.

hwīl, f., *while, time*;

ealle ðā hwīle ðe, *all the while that*;

hwīlum (instr. pl.), *sometimes*.
hwilc (**hwylc**, **hwelc**) (§ 74, Note 1), *which? what?*
hwōn, n., *a trifle*;
 hwēne (instr. sing.), *somewhat, a little*.
hwōnan, *when*.
hȳ, see **hīe**.
hycgan (§ 132), *think, resolve*; pret. 3d sing., **hogode**.
hȳd, f., *hide, skin*.
hyge, see **hige**.
hyra (**hiera**), see **hē**.
hȳran, see **hīeran**.
hyrde, see **hierde**.
hys (**his**), see **hē**.
hyt (**hit**), see **hē**.

I.

ic (§ 72), *I*.
īdel, *idle, useless, desolate*.
ides, f., *woman, lady*.
ieldra, adj., see **eald**.
ieldra, m., *an elder, parent, ancestor*.
iernan (**yrnan**) (§ 112), *run*.
īglōnd (**īgland**), n., *island*.
ilca (**ylca**), *the same [of that ilk]*.
Ilfing, *the Elbing*.
in, *in, into* (with dat. and acc.);
 in on, *in on, to, toward*.
inbryrdnis (**-nes**), f., *inspiration, ardor*.
indryhten, *very noble*.
ingōng, m., *entrance*.
innan, adv., *within, inside*;

on innan, *within*.

innanbordes, adv.-gen., *within borders, at home*.

inne, adv., *within, inside*.

intinga, m., *cause, sake*.

inweardlice, *inwardly, fervently*.

inwid-sorg (inwit-sorh), f., *sorrow caused by an enemy*.

inwit-ðanc, m., *hostile intent*.

Īraland, n., *Ireland* (but in *Ohthere's Second Voyage*, *Iceland* is probably meant).

īren, n., *iron, sword*; gen. pl., **īrenna**, **īrena**.

īren-bēnd, m., f., *iron-band*.

īu, see **gīu**.

K.

kynerīce, see **cynerīce**.

kyning, see **cyning**.

kyrtel, m., *kirtle, coat*.

L.

Lǣden, *Latin*.

Lǣdengeðēode (-ðīode), n., *Latin language*.

Lǣdenware (§ 47), m. pl., *Latin people, Romans*.

lǣfan (§ 126), *leave*.

lǣge, see **licgan**.

Lǣland, n., *Laaland* (in Denmark).

lǣn, n., *loan*;

tō lǣne 121, 2 = *as a loan*.

lǣne, adj., *as a loan, transitory, perishable*.

lǣran (§ 126), *teach, advise, exhort* [**lār**].

lǣssa, **lǣsta**, see **lȳtel**.

lǣstan (§ 127), *last, hold out* (intrans.); *perform, achieve* (trans.).

lāetan (§ 117), *let, leave*.

lāf, f., *something left, remnant, heirloom* (often a sword);

tō lāfe, *as a remnant, remaining*.

lagulād, f., *sea* [lake-way, **lād** = *leading, direction, way*].

land, see **lōnd**.

lang, see **lōng**.

Langaland, n., *Langeland* (in Denmark).

lār, f., *lore, teaching*.

lārcwide, m., *precept, instruction*, [**cwide** < **cweðan**].

lārēow, m., *teacher* [**lār** + **ðēow**].

lāst, m., *track, footprint* [shoemaker's last];

on lāst(e), *in the track of, behind* (with dat.).

lāð, *loathsome, hateful*.

lēas, *loose, free from, bereft of* (with gen.).

lēasung, f., *leasing, deception, falsehood*.

lēcgan (§ 125, Note), *lay*.

lēfdon, see **lēfan**.

leger, n., *lying in, illness* [**licgan**].

lēng, see **lōnge**.

lēngra, see **lōng**.

lēod, m., *prince, chief*.

lēod, f., *people, nation* (the plural has the same meaning).

lēod-scipe, m., *nation* [people-ship].

lēof, *dear* [lief].

leoht, adj., *light*.

lēoht, n., *light, brightness*.

leornere, m., *learner, disciple*.

leornian (§ 130), *learn*.

leornung (**liornung**), f., *learning*.

lēoð, n., *song* [lay?].

lēoðcræft, m., *poetic skill* [lay-craft].

lēoðsong, n., *song, poem*.

lēt, see **lāetan**.

libban (§ 133), *live*; pres. part., **lifigende**, *living, alive*.

lic, n., *body, corpse* [lich-gate, Lichfield].

licgan (§ 115, Note 2), *lie, extend, flow, lie dead*;

3d sing. indic. pres., **ligeð**, **līð**.

lichama (-**hōma**), m., *body* [body-covering].

lician (§ 130), *please* (with dat.) [like].

lic-sār, n., *body-sore, wound in the body*.

liefan (**lēfan**) (§ 126), *permit, allow* (with dat.) [grant leave to].

līf, n., *life*.

līf-dagas, m. pl., *life-days*.

lifigende, see **libban**.

līg, m., *flame, fire*.

ligeð, see **licgan**.

lim, n., *limb*.

list, f., *cunning*; dat. pl., **listum**, is used adverbially = *cunningly*.

līð, see **licgan**.

lof, m., *praise, glory*.

lond (**land**), n., *land, country*.

long (**lang**) (§ 96, (2)), *long*.

longe (**lange**) (§ 97, (2)), *long*;

longe on dæg, *late in the day*.

lufan, see **lufu**.

lufian (**lufigean**) (§ 131), *love*.

luflice, *lovingly*.

lufu, f., *love*; dat. sing. (weak), **lufan**.

lungre, *quickly*.

lust, m., *joy* [lust];

on lust, *joyfully*.

lȳt, indeclinable, *little, few* (with partitive gen.).

lȳtel (**lītel**) (§ 96, (2)), *little, small*.

M.

mā, see **micle** (§ 97, (2)).

mæg, see **magan**.

māeg, m., *kinsman*; nom. pl., **māgas** (§ 27, (2)).

mægen n., *strength, power* [might and *main*].

mægen-ellen, n., *main strength, mighty courage*.

mægð, f., *tribe*.

mægðhād, m., *maidenhood, virginity*.

mæl-gesceaft, f., *appointed time* [**mæl** = *meal, time*].

māeran (§ 126), *make famous, honor*.

māere, *famous, glorious, notorious*.

mārðo (**mārðo**, **mārð**), f., *glory, fame*.

mæsseprēost, m., *mass-priest*.

mæst, see **micel**.

magan (§ 137), *be able, may*.

māgas, see **māeg**.

magu (**mago**), m., *son, man*.

maguðegn, m., *vassal, retainer*.

man(n), see **mōn(n)**.

mancus, m., *mancus, half-crown*; gen. pl., **mancessa**.

māndæd, f., *evil deed*.

manig, see **mōnig**.

manigfeald, see **mōnigfeald**.

māra, see **micel**.

maðelian (§ 130), *harangue, speak*.

māðum (**māððum**), m., *gift, treasure, jewel*; gen. pl., **māðma**.

māððumgyfa, m., *treasure-giver, lord*.

māððum-wela, m., *wealth of treasure*.

mē, see **ic**.

meaht, f., *might, power*.

meahte, see **magan**.

mearc, f., *boundary, limit* [mark, march].

mearg (**mearh**), m., *horse*; nom. pl., **mēaras**.

mearð, m., *marten*.

mec, see **ic**.

medmicel, *moderately large, short, brief*.

medu (**medo**), m., *mead*.

medu-benc, f., *mead-bench*.

medu-ful, n., *mead-cup*.

medu-heall, f., *mead-hall*.

męn, see **męn(n)**.

męngan (§ 127), *mingle, mix*.

męnigu (**męnigeo**), f., *multitude* [many].

męnniscnes, f., *humanity, incarnation* [man].

meolc, f., *milk*.

Mēore, Möre (in Sweden).

męre, m., *lake, mere, sea* [mermaid].

Meretūn, m., *Merton* (in Surrey).

mētan (§ 126), *meet, find*.

Metod (**Meotod**, **Metud**), m., *Creator, God*.

metod-sceaft, f., *appointed doom, eternity*.

micel (§ 96, (3)), *great, mighty, strong, large* [mickle];

māra, *more, stronger, larger*.

micle (**micele**), *greatly, much*.

miclum, (§ 93, (4)), *greatly*.

mid, *with, amid, among* (with dat. and acc.).

middangeard, m., *earth, world* [middle-yard].

middeweard, *midward, toward the middle*.

Mierce, m. pl., *Mercians*.

mihte, see **magan**.

mīl, f., *mile* [Lat. mille].
mildheortnes, f., *mild-heartedness, mercy*.
milts, f., *mildness, mercy*.
mīn (§ 76), *my, mine*.
mislic, *various*.
missenlic, *various*.
mōd, n., *mood, mind, courage*.
mōdcearig, *sorrowful of mind*.
mōdega, **mōdga**, see **mōdig**.
mōdgeðanc, m., *purpose of mind*.
mōdig, *moody, brave, proud*.
mōdor, f., *mother*.
mōdsefa, m., *mind, heart*.
mōn(n) (**man, mann**) (§ 68; § 70, Note), m., *man, one, person, they*.
mōna, m., *moon*.
mōnað (§ 68, (1), Note), m., *month* [**mōna**]; dat. sing., **mōnðe**.
mōn(n)cynn, n., *mankind*.
mōndryhten, m., *liege lord*.
mōnian (**manian**) (§ 130), *admonish*.
mōnig (**manig, mōneg, mænig**), *many*.
mōnigfeald (**manig-**), *manifold, various*.
mōnðe, see **mōnað**.
mōr, m., *moor*.
morgen, m., *morning*; dat. sing., **morgen(n)e**.
morðor-bealu (**-bealo**), n., *murder* [murder-bale];
 see **ðurfan**.
mōste, see **mōtan**.
mōtan (§ 137), *may, be permitted, must*.
mund-gripe, m., *hand-grip*.
munuc, m., *monk* [Lat. monachus].
munuchād, m., *monkhood, monastic rank*.

mūð, m., *mouth*.

myntan (§ 127), *be minded, intend*; pret. indic. 3d sing., **mynte**.

mynster, n., *monastery* [Lat. *monasterium*]; dat. sing., **mynstre**.

mȳre, f., *mare* [**mearh**].

myrð, f., *joy, mirth*;

mōdes myrðe 142, 17 = *with joy of heart*.

N.

nā (**nō**), *not* [**ne ā** = *n-ever*];

nā ne, *not, not at all*.

nabban (p. 32, Note), *not to have*.

nædre, f., *serpent, adder*.

næfde, see **nabban**.

næfre, *never*.

nānig (§ 77), *no one, no, none*.

nāere, **nāeren**, **nāeron**, see § 40, Note 2.

næs = **ne wæs**, see § 40, Note 2.

næss, m., *ness, headland*.

nāht, see **nōht**.

nālæs (**nāles**), *not at all* [**nā ealles**].

nam, see **niman**.

nama, see **noma**.

nāmon, see **niman**.

nān, *not one, no, none* [**ne ān**].

nānwuht, n., *nothing* [no whit].

ne, *not*.

nē, *nor*;

nē ... nē, *neither ... nor*.

nēah (§ 96, (4)), *near*.

nēah, adv., *nigh, near, nearly, almost*; comparative, **nēar**, *nearer*.

neaht, see **niht**.

nēalēcan (-lācan) (§ 126), *draw near to, approach* (with dat.).

nēar, see **nēah**, adv.

nēat, n., *neat, cattle*.

nemnan (§ 127), *name*.

nemðe, (**nymðe**), *except, unless*.

neṛian (§ 125), *save, preserve*.

nēten, see **nīten**.

nīedbeðearf, *needful, necessary*.

nīehst, see **nēah** (§ 96, (4)).

nīeten (**nēten**), n., *neat, beast, cattle*.

nigontīene, *nineteen*.

niht (**neaht**) (§ 68, (1), Note), *night*.

nihthelm, m., *night-helm, shade of night*.

nihtscūa, m., *shadow of night*.

niht-weorc, n., *night-work*.

niman (§ 114), *take, gain* [nimble, numb].

nīpan (§ 102), *grow dark, darken*.

nis, see § 40, Note 2.

nīð, m., *malice, violence*.

nīwe, *new, novel, startling*.

nō, see **nā**.

nōht (**nāht**, **nā-wiht**), n., *not a whit, naught, nothing; not, not at all*.

nōhwæðer (**nāhwæðer**), *neither*;

nōhwæðer nē ... ne ... nē ... ne 118, 8 = *neither ... nor*.

noalde, **noldon** = **ne wolde**, **ne woldon**, see **willan**.

noma (**nama**), m., *name*.

norð (§ 97, (1)), *north, in the north, northwards*.

norðan (§ 93, (5)), *from the north*;

be norðan, see § 94, (4).

Norð-Dene, m. pl., *North-Danes*.

norðeward, *northward*.

Norðhymbre, m. pl., *Northumbrians*.
Norðmanna, see **Norðmōn**.
Norðmęn, see **Norðmōn**.
norðmest, see **norð**.
Norðmōn (-man) (§ 68, (1)), *Norwegian*.
norðor, see **norð**.
norðryhte, *northward*.
norðweard, *northward*.
Norðweg, *Norway*.
nose, f., *cape, naze* [ness, nose].
notu, f., *office, employment*.
nū, *now; now that, seeing that*;
 nū ðā 138, 13 = *now then*.
nȳhst (**nīehst**), see **nēah**.
nymðe, see **nemðe**.
nysse, see **nytan**.
nyste, see **nytan**.
nyt(t), *useful, profitable*.
nytan (**nitan** < **ne witan**, § 136), *not to know*;
 3d sing. pret., **nysse**, **nyste**.

O.

of (§ 94, (1)), *of, from, concerning*.
ofer (§ 94, (2)), *over, across, after, in spite of* (see 144, 14);
 ofer eorðan 142, 9 = *on earth*.
ofer, adv., *over, across*.
oferfēran (§ 126), *go over, traverse*.
oferfrēosan (§ 109), *freeze over*.
oferfroren, see **oferfrēosan**.
ofgiefan (§ 115), *give up, relinquish*.
ofost, f., *haste*.

ofslægen, see **ofslēan**.

ofslēan (§ 118), *slay off, slay*.

ofslōge, see **ofslēan**.

oft, *oft, often*; superlative, **oftost**.

on (§ 94, (3)), *in, into, on, against, to, among, during*;

on fif oððe syx 109, 6 = *into five or six parts*;

on weg 140, 10 = *away*;

on innan 144, 5 = *within*;

on unriht 145, 15 = *falsely*.

onbærnan (§ 126), *kindle, inspire*.

oncȳðð, f., *distress, suffering*.

ond (**and**), *and*.

ondsaca, m., *adversary*.

ondswarian (§ 130), *answer*.

ondweard, adj., *present*.

onfēng, see **onfōn**.

onfeohtan (§ 110), *fight*.

onfindan (§ 110), *find out, discover*; pret. indic. 3d sing., **onfunde**.

onfōn (§ 118), *receive, seize violently*.

onfunde, see **onfindan**.

ongēan, prep., *against, towards* (with dat. and acc.).

ongēan, adv., *just across, opposite*.

Qngelcynn (**Angel-**), n., *Angle kin, English people, England*.

Qngelðēod (**Angel-**), f., *the English people or nation*.

ongemang (**-mōng**), *among* (with dat.).

ongietan (**-gitan**) (§ 115), *perceive, see, understand*.

onginnan (§ 110), *begin, attempt*.

onlūtan (§ 109), *bow, incline* (intrans.) [lout = a stooper].

onrīdan (§ 102), *ride against, make a raid on*.

onsendan (§ 127), *send*.

onslæpan (**onslēpan**) (§ 126), *fall asleep, sleep*.

onspōnnan (§ 117), *loosen* [unspan]; pret. 3d sing. indic., **onspēon**.

onspringan (§ 110), *spring apart, unspring*.

onstāl, m., *institution, supply*.

onstēllan (§ 128), *establish*; pret. 3d sing. indic., **onstealde**.

onwæcnan (§ 127), *awake* (intrans.).

onweald (-wald), m., *power, authority* [wield].

onwēndan (§ 127), *change, overturn* [to wind].

ōr, n., *beginning*.

oð (§ 94, (2)), *until, as far as* (of time and place);

oð ðæt, oð ðe, *until*.

oðberan (§ 114), *bear away*.

ōðer, *other, second*;

ōðer ... oðer, *the one ... the other*.

oðfæstan (§ 127), *set to* (a task).

oðfeallan (§ 117) *fall off, decline*.

oððe, *or*;

oððe ... oððe, *either ... or*.

P.

plega, m., *play, festivity*.

port, m., *port* [Lat. portus].

R.

rād, f., *raid*.

rācan (§ 126), *reach*; pret. 3d sing., **rāhte**.

ræst, see **ręst**.

Rēadingas, m. pl., *Reading* (in Berkshire).

ręccan (§ 128), *narrate, tell*; pret. pl. indic., **ręhton, reahton**.

ręccelēas, *reckless, careless*.

ręced, n., *house, hall*.

regnian (**rēnian**) (§ 130), *adorn, prepare*; past part., **geregnad**.

regollīc (-lec), *according to rule, regular.*
rēn-weard, m., *mighty warden, guard, champion.*
ręst (ręst), f., *rest, resting-place, bed.*
rēðe, *fierce, furious.*
rīce, *rich, powerful, aristocratic.*
rīce, n., *realm, kingdom [bishopric].*
rīcsian (§ 130), *rule.*
rīdan (§ 102), *ride.*
rīman (§ 126), *count [rime].*
rīnc, m., *man, warrior.*
rōd, f., *rood, cross;*
 rōde tācen, *sign of the cross.*
Rōmware, m. pl., *Romans.*
rōnd (rand), m., *shield.*
rūn, f., *rune, secret meditation [to round = to whisper].*
rycene (ricene), *quickly, rashly.*
ryhtnorðanwind, m., *straight north-wind.*

S.

sǣ, f., *sea.*
sǣ-bāt, m., *sea-boat.*
sǣd, n., *seed.*
sǣde, see **sęcgan**.
sǣl, m., f., *time, happiness [sil-ly];*
 on sǣlum 137, 22 = *joyous, merry.*
sǣlan (§ 126), *bind.*
sǣ-līðend (§ 68, (3)), m., *seafarer* (nom. and acc. pl. same as nom. and acc. sing.).
sam ... sam, *whether ... or.*
same, *similarly;*
 swā same, *just the same, in like manner.*

samod, see **somod**.

sanct, m., f., *saint* [Lat. *sanctus*]; gen. sing., **sanctæ**, f., **sancti**, m.

sang, see **song**.

sār, f., n., *sore, pain, wound*.

sār, adj., *sore, grievous*.

sāre, *sorely*.

sāwan (§ 117,) *sow*.

sāwol, f., *soul*; oblique cases, sing., **sāwle** (§ 39, Note).

scacan (**sceacan**) (§ 116), *shake, go, depart*; past part., **scacen**, **sceacen**.

scadu-helm, m., *cover of night, shadow-covering* [shadow-helm];

scadu-helma gesceapu, see Note on 138, 2-6.

sceal, see **sculan**.

scēap, n., *sheep*.

scēat, m., *corner, region, quarter* [sheet];

eorðan scēatta 139, 14 = *in the regions of earth* (gen. used as locative).

scēawi(g)an (§ 130), *view, see* [shew].

scēawung, f., *seeing*.

sceolde, see **sculan**.

scēop (**scōp**), see **scieppan**.

scēowyrhta, m., *shoe-maker*.

scēoððan (§ 116), *injure, scathe* (with dat.).

scieppan (§ 116), *create*.

Scieppend, m., *Creator*.

scīnan (§ 102), *shine*.

scip (**scyp**), n., *ship*.

scipen, n., *stall*.

sciprāp, m., *ship-rope, cable*.

scīr, f., *shire, district*.

Sciringeshēal, m., *Sciringesheal* (in Norway).

scolde, see **sculan**.

scōmu, f., *shame, dishonor*.

Scōnēg, f., *Skaane* (southern district of the Scandinavian peninsula).

scopgereord, n., *poetic language*.

scriðan (§ 102), *stride, stalk*.

sculan (§ 136; § 137, Note 2), *shall, have to, ought*.

Scyldingas, m. pl., *Scyldings, Danes*.

scyp, see **scip**.

Scyppend, see **Scieppend**.

sē, sēo, ðæt (§ 28; § 28, Note 3), *the; that; he, she, it; who, which, that*;

ðæs, *from then, afterwards, therefore*;

ðæs ðe (p. 110, l. 2), *with what*;

ðȳ ... ðæt (p. 110, ll. 7-8), *for this reason ... because*;

tō ðāem ... swā, *to such an extent ... as*;

ðy (ðē), *the* (adverbial, with comparatives);

ðȳ ... ðȳ, *the ... the*.

seah, see **sēon**.

sealde, see **sellan**.

searo-gimm, m., *artistic gem, jewel*.

searo-nið, m., *cunning hatred, plot*.

searo-ðonc, m., *cunning thought, device*.

Seaxe, m. pl., *Saxons, Saxony*.

sēc(e)an (§ 128), *to seek, visit, meet*.

sēcg, m., *man, warrior*.

sēcgan (§ 132), *say, tell*.

sefa, m., *mind, spirit*.

sēfte, *more easily* (comparative of **sōfte**).

segel, m., n., *sail*; dat. sing. = **segle**.

seglian (§ 130), *sail*.

sēle, m., *hall*.

sēledrēam, m., *hall joy, festivity*.

sēle-ful, n., *hall cup*.

sēlesēcg, m., *hall warrior, retainer*.

sēlest, *best* (no positive).

self (**sylf**), *self, himself* (declined as strong or weak adjective).

sellan (**syllan**) (§ 128), *give* [sell, han(d)sel].

semninga, *forthwith, straightway*.

sendan (§ 127), *send*.

sēo, see **sē**.

sēoc, *sick*.

seofon (**syfan**), *seven*.

seolh, m., *seal*; gen. sing. = **sēoles** (§ 27, (3)).

sēon (§ 118), *see, look*.

seonu, f., *sinew*; nom. pl., **seonowe**.

sess, m., *seat*.

sibb, f., *friendship, peace* [gossip].

sidu (**siodu**), m., *custom, morality, good conduct*.

sīe, see **bēon**.

siex, *six*;

syxa (**siexa**) **sum**, see **sum**.

siextig, *sixty*.

sige, m., *victory*.

sige-folc, n., *victorious people*.

sige-lēas, *victory-less, of defeat*.

sige-rōf, **victory-famed**, *victorious*.

sige-wāpen, n., *victory-weapon*.

siglan (§ 127), *sail*.

Sillende, *Zealand*.

sinc, n., *treasure, prize*.

sinc-fæt, n., see 137, 1 [treasure-vat].

sinc-ðegu, f., *receiving of treasure* [ðicgan].

sind, **sint**, **sindon**, see **bēon**.

singan (§ 110), *sing*.

sittan (§ 115, Note 2), *sit, take position*.

sīð, m., *journey, time*;

forman sīðe 139, 2 = *the first time* (instr. sing.).

sīðian (§ 130), *journey*.

siððan, *after that, afterwards, after*.

slæp, m., *sleep*.

slæpan (§ 117), *sleep*.

slēan (§ 118), *slay* [slow-worm].

slītan (§ 102), *slit, tear to pieces*.

slīðen, *savage, perilous*.

smæl, *narrow*.

smalost, see **smæl**.

snāw, m., *snow*.

snot(t)or, *wise, prudent*.

sōhte, see **sēcan**.

somod (**samod**), *together*.

sōna, *soon*.

song, m., n., *song, poem*.

songcræft, m., *art of song and poetry*.

sorg (**sorh**), f., *sorrow*.

sōð, *true*.

sōð, n., *truth*;

tō sōðe, *for a truth, truly, verily*.

sōð-fæst, *truthful, just*.

sōðlice, *truly*.

spēd, f., *possessions, success, riches* [speed].

spēdig, *rich, prosperous*.

spell, n., *story, tale* [gospel].

spēow, see **spōwan**.

spere, n., *spear*.

spor, n., *track, footprint*.

spōwan (§ 117), *succeed* (impersonal with dat.).

spræc, f., *speech, language*.

sprecan (§ 115), *speak*.

spyrian (**spyrigean**) (§ 130), *follow* (intrans.) [**spor**].

stæf, *staff, rod*; pl. = *literature, learning*.

stæhrān, m., *decoy-reindeer*.

stælwierðe, *serviceable* (see p. 56, Note 2).

stær, n., *story, narrative* [Lat. *historia*].

stæð, n., *shore*.

stān, m., *stone, rock*.

stān-boga, m., *stone-arch* [stone-bow].

standan, see **stōndan**.

stānhlið (**-hleoð**), n., *stone-cliff*.

stapol, m., *column* [staple].

starian (§ 125), *stare, gaze*.

stede, m., *place*.

stelan (§ 114), *steal*.

stent, see **stōndan**.

stēorbord, n., *starboard, right side of a ship*.

steppan (§ 116), *step, advance*; pret. indic. 3d sing., **stōp**.

stilnes, f., *stillness, quiet*.

stōndan (§ 116), *stand*.

stōp, see **steppan**.

storm, m., *storm*.

stōw, f., *place* [stow, and in names of places].

strang, see **strōng**.

strengest, see **strōng**.

strōng (§ 96, (2)), *strong*.

styccemælum, *here and there*.

sum (§ 91, Note 2), *some, certain, a certain one*;

hē syxa sum 104, 25 = *he with five others*.

sumera, see **sumor**.

sumor, m., *summer*; dat. sing. = **sumera**.
sumorlida, m., *summer-army*.
sundor, *apart*.
sunne, f., *sun*.
sunu, m., *son*.
sūð, *south, southwards*.
sūðan (§ 93, (5)), *from the south*;
 be sūðan, *south of* (§ 94, (4)).
sūðeweard, *southward*.
sūðryhte, *southward*.
swā (swǣ), *so, as, how, as if*;
 swā swā, *just as, as far as*;
 swā ... swā, *the ... the, as ... as*;
 swā hwæt swā, *whatsoever* (§ 77, Note).
swæs, *beloved, own*.
swæð, n., *track, footprint* [swath].
swaðul, m.? n.?, *smoke*.
swealh, see **swelgan**.
swefan (§ 115), *sleep, sleep the sleep of death*.
swefn, n., *sleep, dream*.
swēg, m., *sound, noise*.
swegle, *bright, clear*.
swēlan (§ 126), *burn* [sweal].
swelgan (§ 110), *swallow*; pret. indic. 3d sing., **swealh**; subj., **swulge**.
swellan (§ 110), *swell*.
Swēoland, n., *Sweden*.
Swēom, m., dat. pl., *the Swedes*.
sweotol, *clear*.
sweotole, *clearly*.
swęrian (§ 116), *swear*.
swēte, *sweet*.

swētnes (-nis), f., *sweetness*.
swift (swyft), *swift*.
swilc (swylc) (§ 77), *such*.
swilce, *in such manner, as, likewise; as if, as though* (with subj.).
swimman (§ 110), *swim*.
swīn (swȳn), n., *swine, hog*.
swīnsung, f., *melody, harmony*.
swīðe (swȳðe), *very, exceedingly, greatly*.
swīðost, *chiefly, almost*.
swōr, see **swerian**.
swulge, see **swelgan**.
swuster (§ 68, (2)), f., *sister*.
swylce (swelce), see **swilce**.
swȳn, see **swīn**.
swynsian (§ 130), *resound*.
swȳðe, see **swīðe**.
swȳð-ferhð, *strong-souled*.
sylf, see **self**.
syll, f., *sill, floor*.
syllan, see **sellan**.
symbol, n., *feast, banquet*.
symle, *always*.
synd, see **bēon**.
syn-dolh, n., *ceaseless wound, incurable wound*.
syndriglice, *specially*.
synn, f., *sin*.
syn-scaða, m., *ceaseless scather, perpetual foe*.
syn-snæd, f., *huge bit* [ceaseless bit].
syððan, see **siððan**.
syx, see **siex**.
syxtig, see **siextig**.

T.

tācen, n., *sign, token*; dat. sing., **tācne** (§ 33, Note).

tācan (§ 128), *teach*.

tam, *tame*.

tela, *properly, well* [til].

tellan (§ 128), *count, deem* [tell]; pret. 3d sing., **tealde**.

Temes, f., *the Thames*.

tēon, *arrange, create*; pret. sing., **tēode**.

Terfinna, m., gen. pl., *the Terfins*.

tēð, see **tōð**.

tīd, f., *tide, time, hour*.

tīen (**tȳn**), *ten*.

til(l), *good*.

tīma, m., *time*.

tintreglīc, *full of torment*.

tō (§ 94, (1)), *to, for, according to, as*;

tō hrōfe 114, 2 = *for (as) a roof* [cf. Biblical *to wife*, modern *to boot*].

tō, adv., *too*.

tōbrecan (p. 81, Note 2), *break to pieces, knock about*.

tōdāelan (§ 126), *divide*.

tōemnes (**tō emnes**) (§ 94, (4)), *along, alongside*.

tōforan (§ 94, (1)), *before*.

tōgeðēodan (§ 126), *join*.

tōhopa, m., *hope*.

tōlicgan (§ 115, Note 2), *separate, lie between*;

3d sing, indic. = **tōlīð**.

tōlīð, see **tōlicgan**.

tolūcan (§ 109, Note 1), *destroy* [the prefix **tō** reverses the meaning of **lūcan**, *to lock*].

torn, m., *anger, insult*.

tōð (§ 68, (1)), m., *tooth*.

tōweard (§ 94, (1)), *toward*.

tōweard, adj., *approaching, future*.

trēow, f., *pledge, troth*.

trēownes, f., *trust*.

Trūsō, *Drausen* (a city on the Drausensea).

tūn, m., *town, village*.

tunge, f., *tongue*.

tūngerēfa, m., *bailiff* [town-reeve; so sheriff = shire-reeve].

tungol, n., *star*.

twā, see **twēgen**.

twēgen, (§ 89), *two, twain*.

twēntig, *twenty*.

tȳn, see **tīen**.

Ð.

ðā, *then, when*;

ðā ... ðā, *when ... then*;

ðā ðā, *then when = when*.

ðā, see **sē**.

ðær, *there, where*;

ðær ðær, *there where = where*;

ðær ... swā 142, 4 = *wheresoever*; 145, 6 = *if so be that*.

ðæs, *afterwards, therefore, thus, because*;

 see **sē**.

ðæt (**ðætte** = **ðæt ðe**), *that, so that*.

ðafian (§ 130), *consent to*.

ðanc, see **ðqnc**.

ðancian (**ðqncian**) (§ 130), *thank*.

ðanon, see **ðqnan**.

ðās, see **ðēs**.

ðē, see **sē** (instr. sing.) and **ðū**.

ðe (§ 75), *who, whom, which, that*.

ðēah, *though, although*;

ðēah ðe, *though, although*.

ðearf, see **ðurfan**.

ðearf, f., *need, benefit*.

ðēaw, m., *habit, custom* [thews].

ðegn (**ðegen**), m., *servant, thane, warrior*.

ðenc(e)an (§ 128), *think, intend*.

ðening (-ung), f., *service*;

the pl. may mean *book of service* (117, 17).

ðēod, f., *people, nation*.

ðēoden, m., *prince, lord*.

ðēodscipe, m., *discipline*.

ðēon (**ðȳwan**) (§ 126), *oppress* [ðēow].

ðēow, m., *servant*.

ðēowa, m., *servant*.

ðēowotdōm (**ðīowot-**), m., *service*.

ðēs (§ 73), *this*.

ðider, *thither*.

ðiderweard, *thitherward*.

ðīn (§ 76), *thine*.

ðing, n., *thing*;

ænige ðinga, see 140, 15, Note.

ðingan (§ 127), *arrange, appoint*.

ðis, see **ðēs**.

ðissum, see **ðēs**.

ðōhte, **ðōhton**, see **ðencean**.

ðolian (§ 130), *endure* [thole].

ðqnan, *thence*.

ðqnc, m., *thanks*.

ðone, see **sē**.

ðonne, *than, then, when*;

ðonne ... ðonne, *when ... then*.

ðrāg, f., *time*.

ðrēa-nȳd, f., *compulsion, oppression, misery* [throe-need].

ðrēora, see **ðrīe**.

ðridda, *third*.

ðrie (**ðrȳ**) (§ 89), *three*.

ðrīm, see **ðrīe**.

ðrīst-hȳdig, *bold-minded*.

ðrītīg, *thirty*.

ðrōwung, f., *suffering*.

ðrȳ, see **ðrīe**.

ðrym(m), m., *renown, glory, strength*.

ðrȳð, f., *power, multitude* (pl. used in sense of sing.);

asca ðrȳðe 152, 23 = *the might of spears*.

ðrȳð-ærn, n., *mighty house, noble hall*.

ðrȳð-word, n., *mighty word, excellent discourse*.

ðū (§ 72), *thou*.

ðūhte, see **ðyncan**.

ðurfan (§ 136), *need*; pres. indic. 3d sing., **ðearf**; pret. 3d sing., **ðorfte**;

for-ðām mē wītan ne ðearf Waldend fīra morðor-bealo māga 145, 17
= *therefore the Ruler of men need not charge me with the murder of kinsmen*.

ðurh (§ 94, (2)), *through*.

ðus, *thus*.

ðūsend, *thousand*.

ðȳ, see **sē**.

ðyder, see **ðider**.

ðyncan (§ 128), *seem, appear* (impersonal);

mē ðyncð, *methinks, it seems to me*;

him ðūhte, *it seemed to him*.

U.

ūhta, m., *dawn*; gen. pl., **ūhtna**.

unbeboht, *unsold* [**bebycgan** = *to sell*].

uncūð, *unknown, uncertain* [uncouth].

under, *under* (with dat. and acc.).

understōndan (§ 116), *understand*.

underðēodan (-ðīedan) (§ 126), *subject to*; past part. **underðēoded** = *subjected to, obedient to* (with dat.).

unforbærned, *unburned*.

unfrið, m., *hostility*.

ungefōge, *excessively*.

ungemete, *immeasurably, very*.

ungesewenlīc, *invisible* [past part. of **sēon** + **līc**].

unlyfigend, *dead, dead man* [unliving].

unlȳtel, *no little, great*.

unriht, n., *wrong*;

on **unriht**, see **on**.

unrihtwīsnes, f., *unrighteousness*.

unspēdig, *poor*.

unwearnum, *unawares*.

ūp (ūpp), *up*.

ūpāstīgnes, f., *ascension* [**stīgan**].

ūp-lang, *upright*.

ūre (§ 76), *our*.

usses = gen. sing. neut. of **ūser**, see **ic**.

ūt, *out, outside*.

ūtan, *from without, outside*.

ūtanbordes, *abroad*.

ūtgoṅg, m., *exodus*.

uton, *let us* (with infin.) [literally *let us go* with infin. of purpose (see 137, 19-20, Note); **uton** = **wuton**, corrupted form of 1st pl. subj. of **wītan**,

to go].

ūt-weard, *outward bound, moving outwards*.

W.

wāc, *weak, insignificant*.

wacian (§ 130), *watch, be on guard*; imperative sing., **waca**.

wadan (§ 116), *go, tread* [wade].

wæg, m., *wave*.

Wægmundigas, m. *Wægmundings* (family to which Beowulf and Wiglaf belonged).

wæl, n., *slaughter, the slain*.

wæl-blēat, *deadly* [slaughter-pitiful].

wælgīfre, *greedy for slaughter*.

wæl-ræs, m., *mortal combat* [slaughter-race].

wæl-rēow, *fierce in strife*.

wælsliht (-sleaht), m., *slaughter*.

wælstōw, f., *battle-field* [slaughter-place];

wælstōwe gewald, *possession of the battle-field*.

wæpen, n., *weapon*.

wære, see **bēon**.

wæs, see **bēon**.

wæter, n., *water*.

waldend, see *wealdend*.

wan (wōn), *wan, dark*.

wanhȳdig, *heedless, rash*.

wānigean (**wānian**) (§ 130), *bewail, lament* (trans.) [whine].

warian (§ 130), *attend, accompany*.

wāt, see **witan**.

waðum, m., *wave*; gen. pl., **waðema**.

weal(l), m., *wall, rampart*.

wealdend (§ 68, (3)), *wielder, ruler, lord*.

wealh, m., *foreigner, Welshman*.

wealhstōd, m., *interpreter, translator*.

weallan (§ 117), *well up, boil, be agitated*; pret. 3d. sing. indic., **wēoll**.

wealsteal(l), m., *wall-place, foundation*.

weard, m., *ward, keeper*.

wearð, see **weorðan**.

weaxan (§ 117), *wax, grow*.

weg, m., *way*;

hys weges, see § 93, (3);

on weg, see **on**.

wel(l), *well, readily*.

wela, m., *weal, prosperity, riches*.

welm, see **wielm**.

wēnan (§ 126), *ween, think, expect*.

węndan (§ 127), *change, translate* [wend, **windan**].

węnian (§ 130), *entertain*;

węnian mid wynnum 149, 20 = *entertain joyfully*;

węnede tō wiste 149, 27 = *feasted* (trans.).

Weonodland (Weonoðland), n., *Wendland*.

weorc, n., *work, deed*.

weorold (weoruld), see **woruld**.

weorpan (§ 110), *throw*.

weorðan (§ 110), *be, become*.

wer, m., *man* [werwulf].

wērig, *weary, dejected*.

werod, n., *army, band*.

wesan, see **bēon**.

Wesseaxe, m. pl., *West Saxons*; gen. pl. = **Wesseaxna**.

west, *west, westward*.

westanwind, m., *west wind*.

wēste, *waste*.

wēsten, n., *waste, desert*.
Westsæ, f., *West Sea* (west of Norway).
Westseaxe, m. pl., *West Saxons, Wessex*.
wīc, n., *dwelling* [bailiwick].
wīcian (§ 130), *stop, lodge, sojourn* [wīc].
wīdre, adv., *farther, more widely* (comparative of **wīde**).
wīdsæ, f., *open sea*.
wielm (**welm**), m., *welling, surging flood* [weallan].
wīf, n., *wife, woman*.
wīg, m., n., *war, battle*.
wiga, m., *warrior*.
wild, *wild*.
wildor, n., *wild beast, reindeer*; dat. pl. = **wildrum** (§ 33, Note).
willā, m., *will, pleasure*; gen. pl., **wilna** (138, 16).
willan (§ 134; § 137, Note 3), *will, intend, desire*.
wilnung, f., *wish, desire*;
 for ðære wilnunga 119, 4 = *purposely*.
Wiltūn, m., *Wilton* (in Wiltshire).
wīn, n., *wine*.
wīn-ærn, n., *wine-hall*.
Wīnburne, f., *Wimborne* (in Dorsetshire).
wind, m., *wind*.
wine, m., *friend*.
Winedas, m. pl., *the Wends, the Wend country*.
wine-dryhten, m., *friendly lord*.
winelēas, *friendless*.
winemæg, m., *friendly kinsman*.
wīngeard, m., *vineyard*.
winnan (§ 110), *strive, fight* [win].
wīnsæl, n., *wine-hall*.
wīn-sele, m., *wine-hall*.

winter, m., *winter*; dat. sing. = **wintra**.

wintercearig, *winter-sad, winter-worn*.

wīs, *wise*.

wīsdōm, m., *wisdom*.

wīse, *wisely*.

wīse, f., *manner, matter, affair* [in this wise].

wīs-fæst, *wise* [wise-fast; cf. shame-faced = shamefast].

wīs-hycgende, *wise-thinking*.

Wīse, f., *the Vistula*.

Wīsemūða, m., *the mouth of the Vistula*.

wisse, see **witan**.

wist, f., *food, feast*.

wita, m., *wise man, councillor*.

witan (§ 136), *know, show, experience*.

wītan (§ 102), *reproach, blame* (with acc. of thing, dat. of person).

wīte, n., *punishment*.

Witland, n., *Witland* (in Prussia).

wið (§ 94, (3)), *against, toward, with*;

wið ēastan and wið ūpp on emnlange ðæm bȳnum lande, *toward the east, and upwards along the cultivated land*;

wið earm gesæt 139, 11 = *supported himself on his arm*;

genēred wið nīðe (dat.) **143, 11** = *had preserved it from (against) violence*.

wiðerwinna, m., *adversary*.

wiðfōn (§ 118), *grapple with* (with dat.).

wiðhabban (§ 133), *withstand, resist* (with dat.).

wiðstōndan (§ 116), *withstand, resist* (with dat.).

wlōnc, *proud*.

wōd, see **wadan**.

wolcen, n., *cloud* [welkin]; dat. pl., **wolcnum**.

wolde, see **willan**.

wōma, m., *noise, alarm, terror*.

wōn, see **wan**.

wōp, n., *weeping*.

word, n., *word*.

wōrian (§ 130), *totter, crumble*.

worn, m., *large number, multitude*.

woruld, f., *world*;

tō worulde būtan æghwīlcum ende 102, 18 = *world without end*.

woruldcund, *worldly, secular*.

woruldhād, m., *secular life* [world-hood].

woruldrīce, n., *world-kingdom, world*.

woruldðing, n., *worldly affair*.

wræclāst, m., *track or path of an exile*.

wrāð, *wroth, angry; foe, enemy*.

wrītan (§ 102), *write*.

wucu, f., *week*.

wudu, m., *wood, forest*.

wuldor, n., *glory*.

Wuldorfæder (§ 68, (2)), m., *Father of glory*; gen. sing., **Wuldorfæder**.

Wuldur-cyning, m., *King of glory*.

wulf, m., *wolf*.

wund, f., *wound*.

wund, *wounded*.

wunden, *twisted, woven, convolute* (past part. of **windan**).

wundor, n., *wonder, marvel*.

wundrian (§ 130), *wonder at* (with gen.).

wurdon, see **weorðan**.

wurðan, see **weorðan**.

wylf, f., *she wolf*.

wyllað, see **willan**.

wyn-lēas, *joyless*.

wynn, f., *joy, delight*.
wynsum, *winsome, delightful*.
wyrc(e)an (§ 128), *work, make, compose*.
wyrd, f., *weird, fate, destiny*.
wyrhta, m., *worker, creator* [-wright].
wyrm, m., *worm, dragon, serpent*.
wyrmlica, m., *serpentine ornamentation*.
wyrð (**weorð**), *worthy*; see 114, 7-9, Note.

Y.

ylca, see **ilca**.
yldan (§ 127), *delay, postpone* [**eald**].
yldu, f., *age* [eld].
ymbe (**ymb**) (§ 94, (2)), *about, around, concerning* [umwhile];
 ðæs ymb iii niht 99, 2 = *about three nights afterwards*.
ymb-ēode, see **ymb-gān**.
ymbe-sittend, *one who sits (dwells) round about another, neighbor*.
ymb-gān (§ 134), *go about, go around, circle* (with acc.).
yrfe-weard, m., *heir*.
yrnan, see **iernan**.
yrre, *ireful, angry*.
yteren, *of an otter* [otor].
ȳðan (§ 126), *lay waste* (as by a deluge) [ȳð = wave].

II. GLOSSARY.



MODERN ENGLISH—OLD ENGLISH.

A B C D E F G H I K L
M N O P Q R S T V W Y

A.

a, *ān* (§ 77).

abide, *bīdan* (§ 102), *ābīdan*.

about, *be* (§ 94, (1)), *ymbe* (§ 94, (2));

to write about, *wrītan be*;

to speak about (= **of**), *sprecan ymbe*;

about two days afterwards, *ðæs ymbe twēgen dagas*.

adder, *nādre* (§ 64).

afterwards, *ðæs* (§ 93, (3)).

against, *wið* (§ 94, (3)), *on* (§ 94, (3)).

Alfred, *Ælfred* (§ 26).

all, *eall* (§ 80).

also, *ēac*.

although, *ðēah* (§ 105, 2).

always, *ā*; *ealne weg* (§ 98, (1)).

am, *eom* (§ 40).

an, see **a**.

and, *ꝥnd* (*and*).

angel, *engel* (§ 26).

animal, *dēor* (§ 32).

are, *sind*, *sint*, *sindon* (§ 40).

army, *werod* (§ 32);

Danish army, *hære* (§ 26);

English army, *fierd* (§ 38).

art, *eart* (§ 40).

Ashdown, *Æscesdūn* (§ 38).

ask, *biddan* (§ 65, Note 3; § 115, Note 2).

away, *aweg*.

B.

battle-field, *wælstōw* (§ 38).
be, *bēon* (§ 40);
 not to be, see § 40, Note 2.
bear, *beran* (§ 114).
because, *for ðǣm (ðe), for ðon (ðe)*.
become, *weorðan* (§ 110).
before (temporal conjunction), *ǣr, ǣr ðǣm ðe* (§ 105, 2).
begin, *onginnan* (§ 107, (1); § 110).
belong to, *belimpan tō + dative* (§ 110).
best, see **good**.
better, see **good**.
bind, *bindan* (§ 110).
bird, *fugol* (§ 26).
bite, *bītan* (§ 102).
body, *līc* (§ 32).
bone, *bān* (§ 32).
book, *bōc* (§ 68).
both ... and, *ǣgðer ge ... ge*.
boundary, *mearc* (§ 38).
boy, *cnapa* (§ 64).
break, *brēotan* (§ 109), *brecan, ābrecan* (§ 114).
brother, *brōðor* (§ 68, (2)).
but, *ac*.
by, *frōm (fram)* (§ 94, (1); § 141, Note 1).

C.

Cædmon, *Cædmōn* (§ 68, (1)).
call, *hātan* (§ 117, (1)).
cease, **cease from**, *geswīcan* (§ 102).
child, *bearn* (§ 32).
choose, *cēosan* (§ 109).

Christ, *Crīst* (§ 26).
church, *cirice* (§ 64).
come, *cuman* (§ 114).
comfort, *frōfor* (§ 38).
companion, *gefēra* (§ 64).
consolation, *frōfor* (§ 38).
create, *gescieppan* (§ 116).

D.

Danes, *Dene* (§ 47).
day, *dæg* (§ 26).
dead, *dēad* (§ 80).
dear (= **beloved**), *lēof* (§ 80).
deed, *dēd* (§ 38).
die, *cwelan* (§ 114).
division (of troops), *gefylce* (§ 32), *getruma* (§ 64).
do, *dōn* (§ 134).
door, *dor* (§ 32), *duru* (§ 52).
drink, *drincan* (§ 110).
during, *on* (§ 94, (3)). See also § 98.
dwell in, *būan on* (§ 126, Note 2).

E.

earl, *eorl* (§ 26).
endure, *drēogan* (§ 109).
England, *Englaloŋd* (§ 32).
enjoy, *brūcan* (§ 62, Note 1; § 109, Note 1).
every, *ālc* (§ 77).
eye, *ēage* (§ 64).

F.

father, *fæder* (§ 68, (2)).
field, *feld* (§ 51).
fight, *feohtan*, *gefeohtan* (§ 110).
find, *findan* (§ 110).
finger, *finger* (§ 26).
fire, *fȳr* (§ 32).
fisherman, *fiscere* (§ 26).
foreigner, *wealh* (§ 26).
freedom, *frēodōm* (§ 26).
friend, *wine* (§ 45), *frēond* (§ 68, (3)).
friendship, *frēondscipe* (§ 45).
full, *full* (with genitive) (§ 80).

G.

gain the victory, *sige habban*, *sige niman*.
gift, *giefu* (§ 38).
give, *giefan* (with dative of indirect object) (§ 115).
glad, *glæd* (§ 81).
glove, *glōf* (§ 38).
go, *gān* (§ 134), *faran* (§ 116).
God, *God* (§ 26).
good, *gōd* (§ 80).

H.

Halgoland, *Hālgoland* (§ 32).
hall, *heall* (§ 38).
hand, *hƿond* (§ 52).
hard, *heard* (§ 80).
have, *habban* (§ 34);
 not to have, *nabban* (p. 32, Note).
he, *hē* (§ 53).

head, *hēafod* (§ 32).
hear, *hīeran* (§ 126).
heaven, *heofon* (§ 26).
help, *helpan* (with dative) (§ 110).
herdsman, *hierde* (§ 26).
here, *hēr*.
hither, *hider*.
hold, *healdan* (§ 117, (2)).
holy, *hālig* (§ 82).
horse, *mearh* (§ 26), *hors* (§ 32).
house, *hūs* (§ 32).

I.

I, *ic* (§ 72).
in, *on* (§ 94, (3)).
indeed, *sōðlīce*.
injure, *scęððan* (with dative) (§ 116).
it, *hit* (§ 53).

K.

king, *cyning* (§ 26).
kingdom, *rīce* (§ 32), *cynerīce* (§ 32).

L.

land, *lond* (§ 32).
language, *sprāc* (§ 38), *geðēode* (§ 32).
large, *micel* (§ 82).
leisure, *āmetta* (§ 64).
let us, *uton* (with infinitive).
limb, *lim* (§ 32).
little, *lytel* (§ 82).

live in, *būan on* (§ 126, Note 2).

lord, *hlāford* (§ 26).

love, *lufian* (§ 131).

love (noun), *lufu* (§ 38).

M.

make, *wyrca*n (§ 128).

man, *seċg* (§ 26), *mōn* (§ 68, (1)).

many, *mōnig* (§ 82).

mare, *mȳre* (§ 64).

mead, *medu* (§ 51).

Mercians, *Mierce* (§ 47).

milk, *meolc* (§ 38).

month, *mōnað* (§ 68, (1), Note 1).

mouth, *mūð* (§ 26).

much, *micel* (§ 96, (3)), *micle* (§ 97, (2)).

murderer, *bōna* (§ 64).

my, *mīn* (§ 76).

N.

natives, *lōndlēode* (§ 47).

nephew, *nefa* (§ 64).

new, *nīwe* (§ 82).

Northumbrians, *Norðymbre* (§ 47).

not, *ne*.

O.

of, see **about**.

on, *on* (§ 94, (3)), *ofer* (§ 94, (2)).

one, *ān* (§ 89);

the one ... the other, *ōðer ... oðer*.

other, *ōðer* (§ 77).

our, *ūre* (§ 76).

ox, *oxa* (§ 64).

P.

place, *stōw* (§ 38).

plundering, *hęrgung* (§ 38).

poor, *earm* (§ 80), *unspēdig* (§ 82).

prosperous, *spēdig* (§ 82).

Q.

queen, *cwēn* (§ 49).

R.

reindeer, *hrān* (§ 26).

remain, *bīdan* (§ 102), *ābīdan*.

retain possession of the battle-field, *āgan wælstōwe gewald*.

rich, *rīce* (§ 82), *spēdig* (§ 82).

ride, *rīdan* (§ 102).

S.

say, *cweðan* (§ 115), *sęcgan* (§ 133).

scribe, *bōcere* (§ 26).

seal, *seolh* (§ 26).

see, *sēon* (§ 118), *gesēon*.

serpent, *nādre* (§ 64).

servant, *ðēowa* (§ 64), *ðegn* (§ 26).

shall, *sculan* (§ 136; § 137, Note 2).

she, *hēo* (§ 53).

shepherd, *hierde* (§ 26).

ship, *scip* (§ 32).

shire, *scīr* (§ 38).
shoemaker, *scēowyrhta* (§ 64).
side, on both sides, *on gehwæðre hōnd*.
six, *siex* (§ 90).
slaughter, *wæl* (§ 32), *wælsliht* (§ 45).
small, *lȳtel* (§ 82).
son, *sunu* (§ 51).
soul, *sāwol* (§ 38).
speak, *sprecan* (§ 115).
spear, *gār* (§ 26), *spere* (§ 32).
stand, *stōndan* (§ 116).
stone, *stān* (§ 26).
stranger, *wealh* (§ 26), *cuma* (§ 64).
suffer, *drēogan* (§ 109).
sun, *sunne* (§ 64).
swift, *swift* (§ 80).

T.

take, *niman* (§ 110).
than, *ðonne* (§ 96, (6)).
thane, *ðegn* (§ 26).
that (conjunction), *ðæt*.
that (demonstrative), *sē, sēo, ðæt* (§ 28).
that (relative), *ðe* (§ 75).
the, *se, sēo, ðæt* (§ 28).
then, *ðā, ðonne*.
these, see **this**.
they, *hīe* (§ 53).
thing, *ðing* (§ 32).
thirty, *ðrītig*.
this, *ðēs, ðēos, ðis* (§ 73).

those, see **that** (demonstrative).
thou, *ðū* (§ 72).
though, *ðēah* (§ 105, 2).
three, *ðrīe* (§ 89).
throne, **ascend the throne**, *tō rīce fōn*.
throw, *weorpan* (§ 110).
to, *tō* (§ 94, (1)).
tongue, *tunge* (§ 64).
track, *spor* (§ 32).
true, *sōð* (§ 80).
truly, *sōðlice*.
two, *twēgen* (§ 89).

V.

very, *swīðe*.
vessel, *fæt* (§ 32).
victory, *sige* (§ 45).

W.

wall, *weall* (§ 26).
warrior, *sęcg* (§ 26), *eorl* (§ 26).
way, *weg* (§ 26).
weapon, *wāpen* (§ 32).
well, *wel* (§ 97, (2)).
Welshman, *Wealh* (§ 26).
went, see **go**.
westward, *west*, *westrihte*.
whale, *hwæl* (§ 26).
what? *hwæt* (§ 74).
when, *ðā*, *ðonne*.
where? *hwær*.

which, *ðe* (§ 75).
who? *hwā* (§ 74).
who (relative), *ðe* (§ 75).
whosoever, *swā hwā swā* (§ 77, Note).
will, *willan* (§ 134; § 137, Note 3).
Wilton, *Wiltūn* (§ 26).
win, see **gain**.
wine, *wīn* (§ 32).
wisdom, *wīsdōm* (§ 26).
wise, *wīs* (§ 80).
with, *mid* (§ 94, (1));
 to fight with (= **against**), *gefeohtan wið* (§ 94, (3)).
withstand, *wiðstōndan* (with dative) (§ 116).
wolf, *wulf* (§ 26), *wylf* (§ 38).
woman, *wīf* (§ 32).
word, *word* (§ 32).
worm, *wyrm* (§ 45).

Y.

ye, *gē* (§ 72).
year, *gēar* (§ 32).
yoke, *geoc* (§ 32).
you, *ðū* (singular), *gē* (plural) (§ 72).
your, *ðīn* (singular), *ēower* (plural) (§ 76).

Page 109,7: linenote

vi	v	iv	iii	ii	i

e _d_
Where the horsemen
assemble.

1	2	3	4	5	6
X					
XX	X	X			
XXX	XX	XX	X	X	
XXXX	XXX	XXX	XX	XX	X
c	_b_				_a_

The six parts of the property
placed within one mile.

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